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# T H E M E S

**Secondary Education**

Third Year

Sociology and Economics Section

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Center for Educational Research and Development



# Republic of Lebanon

Ministry of National Education, Youth and Sports

## T H E M E S

**Secondary Education**

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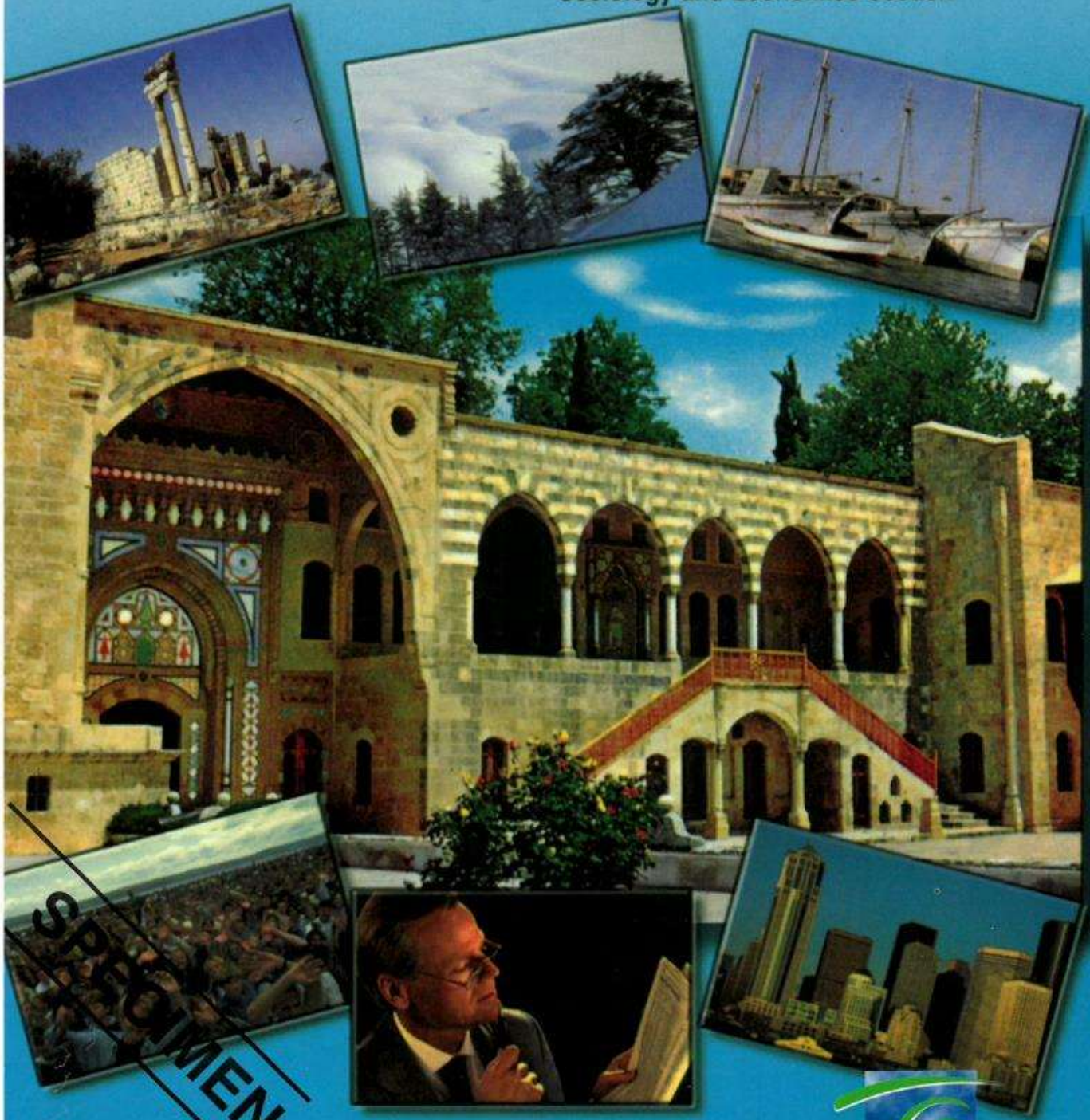
Center for Educational Research and Development



National  
Textbook  
New Curricula

# THEMES

Secondary Education  
Third Year  
Sociology and Economics Section



**SPECIMEN**

Center for Educational Research and Development



National  
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New Curricula



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# The National Textbook Project

By issuing the textbooks for the third year of each educational cycle, the Educational Center for Research and Development will have completed the third and last installment of books called for by the New Curricula. We are placing these books in the hands of students with the great hope that we are moving, step by step, toward the goal of acquiring sound learning, using sophisticated educational means and up-to-date methodology that encourage and reinforce individual thinking and research, acquisition of skills, development of ethical and national attitudes, the feeling of national belonging as well as the feeling of belonging to humanity at large.

The on-going revolution in information, communication and educational-aids technology has undoubtedly limited the role of the textbook and lowered the rank it used so recently to occupy. However, in our society and in many other societies, the textbook remains the basic means of education, and it is our duty to exert our utmost effort and care to come up with the best product as to form and content. Yet we should not lose sight of the fact that the textbook is not sufficient by itself but should rather be used as a stepping stone to access other sources of information. What is important is to keep a clear vision and maintain the right course toward our objective. The means should not turn into the end and the student should always remain the focus of the learning/teaching process.

No one ignores or denies the fact that textbook writing requires very high academic and educational qualifications and very wide field experience. The authors committees undeniably possess such qualities. Yet the textbooks of the last two years contained some negative aspects. Such is the nature of human work, no matter how good the intentions or how great the effort extended. Here constructive criticism constitutes a real contribution to raising the standard of authorship, minimizing errors and filling gaps. We say that, with all due appreciation and respect to all those who have contributed to the success of this project.

The Educational Center for Research and Development is embarking this year on a process of evaluating the New Curricula and related textbooks, teacher training courses and student achievement. This is a natural and necessary step now that the new system has been put into effect. This process aims at identifying the curricular objectives that have been achieved as well as those that have not been achieved, with a view to proceeding with the positive aspects and correcting the negative ones.

As part of this correction process, we plan to review the versions that have been issued in order to secure good textbooks for our students, who always deserve the best.

March 13, 2000

President, Educational Center for  
Research and Development

**Nemer FRAYHA**

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## Part One

### ACTIVITY

1

- A. Read the topic your teacher wrote on the board and say what you already know about it aloud so that your teacher can write it on the board.
- B. Think of what you want to know about the topic and say it aloud so that your teacher can write it.
- C. Group similar ideas together and organize the information on the board into at least two major topics, each of which has at least two subtopics. Then put the topics and subtopics into some kind of logical order (e.g. chronological, spatial, cause/effect, comparison/contrast, etc.). Work as a group.
- D. Share the outline you came up with in step C with the rest of the class.

### ACTIVITY

2

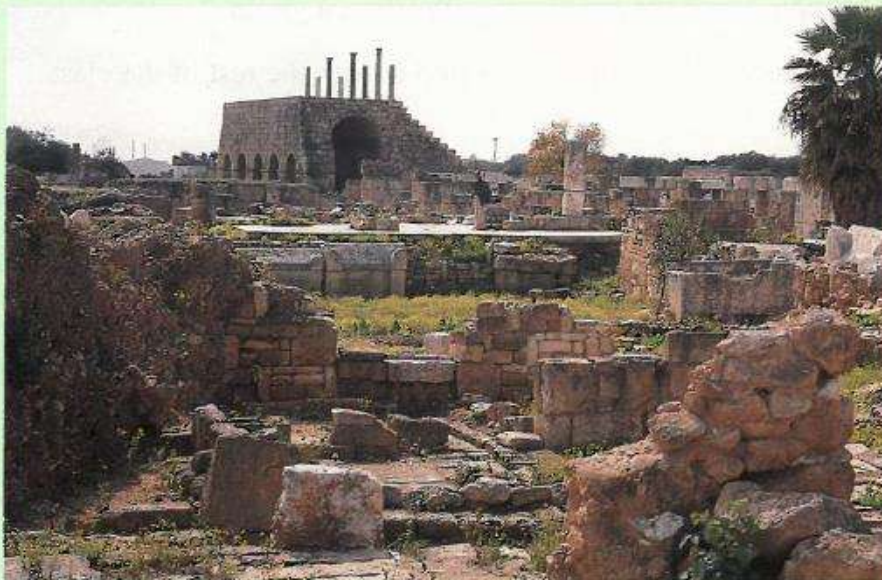
- A. Listen to your teacher's reading of the selection. Then write five questions about
  - a word, phrase, or sentence you do not understand in the selection.
  - the general meaning in the selection.
  - cultural, social or economic ideas which attracted your attention.
- B. The teacher will assign different questions (written by the class) to different groups. Work with your group to answer the questions assigned to you. If there are questions which you don't know how to answer, write them on a piece of paper. Exchange "unanswered" questions with another group.
- C. Take notes while the different groups are sharing their answers to the different questions.



## Historical Highlights: Personage and Archaeological Sites

*"All the world's a stage, And all the men and women merely players: They have their exits and their entrances: And one man in his time plays many parts."*

**William Shakespeare, *As You Like It***



*"... history ... is information about human social organization, which itself is identical with world civilization. It deals with such conditions affecting the nature of civilization as, for instance, savagery and sociability, group feelings, and the different ways by which one group of human beings achieves superiority over another ... Also with the different kinds of gainful occupations and ways of making a living, with the sciences and crafts that human beings pursue as part of their activities and efforts, and with all the other institutions that originate in civilization through its very nature".*

**Ibn Khaldun, *The Muqaddimah***

Themes is a series of textbooks based on the new curriculum and designed for students studying English as a foreign language. This is the third book for the Secondary Cycle, third year, Social Sciences and Economics Section.

The Themes series follows an integrated approach to language teaching, in which listening, speaking, reading, and writing skills are integrated to enhance and develop critical thinking, study skills, and cultural awareness. The approach is also theme-based. This approach, we believe, offers students the opportunity to develop their critical skills, gain cultural awareness, and master vocabulary and grammatical structures in context.

This book consists of three separate texts: the Student Book, the Workbook, and the Teacher's Guide.

The Student Book consists of nine topical units, all of which contain interesting and authentic reading selections on issues related to social sciences and economics. A variety of text types is presented to the students, who are requested to make connections between readings in every unit in order to view a given issue from a variety of perspectives, especially from a social and economic one, and become more skilled at perceiving relations among diverse topics. We have made an effort to focus on relevant and provocative issues which influence our daily lives. Each unit is divided into seven parts, each of which is to be covered during one session. The activities suggested in the different parts allow for cooperative learning and group work as well as for personal, creative, and imaginative responses.

The Workbook is to be used in conjunction with the Student Book. The activities and exercises, which are meant to be both instructive and fun, reinforce and allow for more thorough understanding of the content and skills covered in the chapters. The instructions provided state clearly whether a certain exercise is to be done in class or at home.

The Teacher's Guide explains the objectives of each chapter and suggests procedures for teachers to manage class activities. Answer keys are available where necessary. Also included are bibliographic data for extra thematically related passages which the teacher can use for intensive or extensive reading, depending on the level and pace of students. A style manual is provided as a reference for the teacher to use when he/she feels that students need more instruction or practice in grammar.

Listening materials are available on audio-cassettes. For reasons of practicality, titles of films which are thematically related to the content of the chapters are suggested in the teacher's guide.

**The authors**

## ACTIVITY

3

Scan the selection to double check all the answers. If you find an incorrect answer, be ready to share the correction with the class to clear any misunderstanding.

### Tyre Throughout History

Phoenician Tyre was queen of the seas, an island city of unprecedented splendor. She grew wealthy from her far-reaching colonies and her industries of purple-dyed textiles. But she also attracted the attention of jealous conquerors, among them the Babylonian King Nebuchadnezzar and Alexander the Great.

#### Five millennia of history

Founded at the start of the third millennium B.C., Tyre originally consisted of a mainland settlement and a modest island city that lay a short distance off shore. But it was not until the first millennium B.C. that the city experienced its golden age.



In the 10<sup>th</sup> century B.C. Hiram, King of Tyre, joined two islets by landfill. Later he extended the city further by reclaiming a considerable area from the sea. Phoenician expansion began about 815 B.C. when traders from Tyre founded Carthage in North Africa. Eventually its colonies spread around the Mediterranean and Atlantic, bringing to the city a flourishing maritime trade.

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prosper under its new rulers, exporting sugar as well as objects made of pearl and glass. With the decline of the Abbasid caliphate, Tyre acquired some independence under the dynasty of the Bannu Aqil, vassals of the Egyptian Fatimates. This was a time when Tyre was adorned<sup>1</sup> with fountains and its bazaars were full of all kinds of merchandise, including carpets and jewelry of gold and silver.

Thanks to Tyre's strong fortifications it was able to resist the onslaught of the Crusaders until 1124. After about 170 years of Crusader rule, the Mamlukes retook the city in 1291. Then it passed on to the Ottomans at the start of the 16<sup>th</sup> century. With the end of World War I, Tyre was integrated into the new nation of Lebanon.

### Archaeological Tyre

For a period of nearly 50 years the General Directorate of Antiquities excavated in and around Tyre, concentrating on the three major Roman archaeological sites in the town, which can be seen today.

The most important recent archaeological find is a Phoenician cemetery from the first millennium B.C. Discovered in 1991 during clandestine excavations, this is the first cemetery of its kind found in Lebanon. Funerary jars, inscribed steles and jewelry were among the objects retrieved from the site.

The importance of this historical city and its monuments was highlighted in 1979 when UNESCO declared Tyre a World Heritage Site.

In the meantime, government efforts have stopped much of the wartime pillaging<sup>2</sup> that Tyre's archaeological treasures suffered because of economic stress in the area and international demand for antiquities. Grassroots<sup>3</sup> campaigns have also drawn attention to the importance of the city's antiquities.

### ACTIVITY



.....

- A. Compare the answers you have now with what you recorded in the web (Activity 1) as topics you know. Write the information in these answers in the form of a paragraph using this opening statement: "What I already knew about Tyre was the following ..."
- B. Compare what you recorded as topics you want to know in Activity 1 with the rest of the answers. Choose the answers which cover these topics and write them in the form of a paragraph using this opening statement: "What I learned about Tyre was the following ..."

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1- to add beauty such as by ornaments.

2- to strip of money or goods by open violence in war.

3- the common people, the basic popular support.

## UNIT 1

But prosperity and power make their own enemies. Early in the sixth century B.C. Nebuchadnezzar, King of Babylon, laid siege to the walled city for thirteen years. Tyre stood firm, but it is probable that at this time the residents of the mainland city abandoned it for the safety of the island.



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In 332 B.C. Alexander the Great set out to conquer this strategic coastal base in the war between the Greeks and the Persians. Unable to storm the city, he blockaded Tyre for seven months. Again Tyre held on. But the conqueror used the debris of the abandoned mainland city to build a causeway<sup>1</sup> and once within reach of the city wall, Alexander used his siege engines to batter and finally breach the fortifications.

Tyre and the whole of ancient Syria fell under Roman rule in 64 B.C. Nonetheless, for some time Tyre continued to mint<sup>2</sup> its own silver coins. The Romans built a great many important monuments in the city, including an aqueduct, a triumphal arch and the largest hippodrome<sup>3</sup> in antiquity.

Christianity figures in the history of Tyre, whose name is mentioned in the New Testament. During the Byzantine era, the Archbishop of Tyre was the Primate of all the bishops of Phoenicia. At this time the town witnessed a second golden age as can be seen from the remains of its buildings and the inscriptions in the necropolis<sup>4</sup>.

Taken by the Muslim armies in 634, the city offered no resistance and continued to

1- a raised path or road that crosses water or marshland.

2- to make coins by stamping metal.

3- an arena for horsemen and other spectacles.

4- a large cemetery of an ancient city.

- C. Write the remaining topics listed under what you wanted to know in Activity 1, which have not been addressed or answered, in the form of a paragraph using this opening statement: "What I would like to know about Tyre is the following. . ."
- D. Study the introduction to the selection. Look at the first sentence and discuss in your group what makes it appealing or attractive. Pay special attention to the use of figurative language. Discuss the relationship of sentences two and three to the main idea in the selection. Then write an introduction to the three paragraphs which you wrote. Include in it the following:
  - a. First, an appealing general statement on Tyre (your topic in this case). (Model it after the first sentence of the selection).
  - b. Second, a thesis statement that summarizes the contents of the three paragraphs. It should have the specific topic + controlling ideas (the main ideas of the three paragraphs you wrote).

## Part Two

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### ACTIVITY 1 .....

Share your paragraphs (written in Part One - Activity 4) with the class. Check if you have a common understanding of the selection.

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

Read the selection again and complete the chart in Exercise 1 in your Workbook with your group. After you finish, compare your chart with the chart of another group.

### ACTIVITY 3 .....

The fourth paragraph in the selection starts with 'But prosperity and power make their own enemies', which means that the economic affluence of Tyre attracted invaders. This shows the relationship of economy to history and vice versa. In your groups, review the chart (Exercise 1) and try to find the stated or implicit causal relationships between the historical, geographical, archaeological and economic elements in the selection. Complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

### Assignment:

The last part of the selection states that UNESCO declared Tyre a World Heritage Site. Collect information about what this means and about the role that UNESCO and other international bodies play in preserving Lebanese as well as foreign archaeological sites declared World Heritage Sites. (Your teacher will suggest certain reference books to read or Web sites to visit.) Present this information orally at the end of the chapter.

## Part Three

### ACTIVITY

1

Answer the following questions:

- A. What do you know about Emir Bashir II? When did he live? Can you mention some of his achievements?
- B. Shanai is a Lebanese village. Do you know where it is located?
- C. Who was Akhwat Shanai? What was he famous for?

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### ACTIVITY

2

Below you have an incomplete story. Skim it and try to guess how it will end. After you finish skimming, discuss with your group all the possible endings to the story. Then write down the ending which you think is most feasible. Try to base it on certain clues in the story.

### Emir Bashir and Akhwat Shanai

by Roseanne Saad Khalaf

Emir Bashir II, [who ruled] Lebanon from 1790 to 1841 did some intelligent things while he was in power. He sent students to universities in Europe to continue their education, widened old roads and built new ones, constructed bridges which are still standing today, such as the ones at the Damur and the Dog River, and replaced some of the old dust tracks that existed in Lebanon at that time with paved mule tracks. When the bubonic plague, a very deadly and dangerous disease, appeared in a village near Jazzin, he refused to allow people to enter or leave the village. In this way, the

Emir prevented the disease from spreading to other parts of Lebanon. Furthermore, certain people were given smallpox shots for the first time in their lives during his reign.

One fine spring morning, Emir Bashir, who usually sat happily on his diwan admiring the beautiful view from his palace in Deir al-Qamar, was pacing the room with his nargileh (pipe) bearer, walking behind him.

"You are acting very strangely today, Emir," said his advisor looking troubled.

"I am unhappy," answered the Emir, "because I have my heart set on something impossible. I dreamed last night that I had built a magnificent palace in Beit Eddin overlooking the terraced mountain slopes and valley. The palace was surrounded by beautiful gardens and fountains.



"But why do you want a new palace in Beit Eddin?" [his advisor] asked looking puzzled.

Because I am a ruler, and a ruler must think ahead," answered the Emir. "Deir al-Qamar is small and crowded; therefore, it is my duty to encourage my faithful followers to come with me to [another] beautiful part of Lebanon where we can build a fine and magnificent town. But the very spot where I wish to build my dream palace is dry. Now tell me, my fine fellow, how am I to build a palace if there is no water?"

[Then] the Emir's wife, entered the room. She was dressed in a beautiful blue silk gown and a pair of yellow slippers studded with precious stones. Sitt Shams looked very worried as she took her place on a fine carpet near her husband. The Emir, who was quick to see the look on her face and the fire in her eyes, reluctantly signalled to his guards to leave the room.

"Have you gone mad, husband?" cried Sitt Shams, when the last guard had left. "Why on earth do you wish to leave our beautiful palace in Deir al-Qamar and build another in a spot where there is absolutely no water?" she exclaimed breathlessly. "How can we possibly live in Beit Eddin without water? Why, the servants would go mad. They would have to walk miles to bring back water to the palace for washing and cleaning, drinking and cooking. Besides, Deir al-Qamar is a perfect place. The rich merchants that live here have built large and beautiful houses with marble courts and fountains. The people live in style and dress well and we feel very much at home

human being. He felt strangely attracted to this fellow whose dark eyes sparkled with intelligence and wit.

"Remember, Hasan," added the Emir, "you will be rewarded handsomely if you solve this problem that has plagued me both night and day. But if you fail, I am not one to accept defeat easily."

Early the next morning, as the sun was rising and the birds were chirping, Hasan and his donkey began descending the narrow winding path from the Emir's palace to the streets of Deir al-Qamar. When Hasan reached the city square, the doors and windows of the town flew open and people poked their heads out to catch a glimpse of this proud, strange man with his shiny black pointed slippers perched on his funny little donkey. The children threw stones and made faces at him, but Hasan sat perfectly straight and motionless as he trotted along; for he was deep in thought about the strange and dangerous mission that lay ahead of him.

No sooner had Hasan left the palace than the court advisors met to discuss the serious situation which had developed. They had grown very jealous of Hasan, but more important, they feared he would succeed where they had failed by finding a way to bring water to the Emir's palace.

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"We must not allow Akhwat Shanai to find a solution to the Emir's problem," muttered the chief advisor wickedly.

"Certainly not," chimed in the rest of the group with trembling voices.

"Just imagine a mere madman, an absolute nobody, succeeding when we have failed," grumbled the chief advisor. "Why, we are in great danger of losing our credibility".

Together, the jealous advisors sat down and calmed their fears. Then they prepared to visit Emir Bashir that very same evening. They found him sitting peacefully in his courtyard. He had dined outside because the weather was very fine and the servants were taking away the dishes. Long nargilehs and coffee were now placed before him and his advisors. They sat in silence for some time puffing clouds of blue smoke and watching the sun disappear into the Mediterranean Sea and the stars appear in the cloudless sky.

"Gracious lord and master," exclaimed the chief advisor finally breaking the silence, "we are here to discuss some urgent business."

"Then speak at once," replied the Emir.

"We fear that Hasan will disappoint and disgrace you, for we have heard that he is as wicked as he is mad," added the second advisor cunningly.

"Oh!" exclaimed the Emir looking rather surprised. "Do you really think that he will bring shame upon my court?"

"Dear me," thought the Emira to herself, "I must cheer the Emir up." So the clever woman prepared to visit her husband at once.

"Husband," she exclaimed, cheerfully rushing into the courtyard, "I have heard stories about a very eccentric man by the name of Hasan, who lives in the village of Shanai. It is said that he possesses strange magical powers unknown to other men. In fact, he says such odd things and behaves in such a peculiar manner," she continued, "that he is known as the Akhwat (madman) of Shanai. Perhaps - perhaps," murmured the Emira lowering her voice to a whisper, "perhaps he can solve your problem."

"What makes you so certain that this madman will succeed when my most learned advisors have failed?" asked the surprised Emir as he eyed his wife keenly.

"But what can we lose by trying?" pleaded the Emira. "If the man fails, we will send him back to Shanai; but if he succeeds, the riches we shall reward him with will be nothing compared to what we shall gain."

"Oh well," said the Emir rubbing his chin thoughtfully and looking rather puzzled for a moment or two. "Why not give this crazy idea a try? We shall send our best horseman to fetch Hasan immediately."

"Wait!" cried his clever wife. "You are much too hasty, husband. We must be careful about whom we send on such an important mission," she said lowering her voice to a whisper. "Have you forgotten how jealous your advisors can become when you turn to other people for advice? We can send our two sons Khalil and Amin Kasem to fetch Hasan."

"Wonderful idea," beamed the Emir looking more cheerful already. "Karamah, my faithful and trusted court poet, shall accompany them; for he is wise and knows the villages well."

"Your advisors will not discover our plan until it is too late," laughed the Emira gayly as she prepared to leave the courtyard.

Bright and early the next morning, the Emir ordered his swiftest horses to be brought from the royal stable. Khalil, Amin Kasem and Karamah, the poet, quickly and quietly slipped out of the palace, swung themselves into the saddles and set



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out for the village of Shanai in search of Hasan. A few hours later, the three tired travelers approached the small village [, where they found Hasan].

Hasan was a magnificent figure. He was sturdily built, but not very tall. His eyes were black, gleaming and intelligent. Under a large hooked nose sprouted a square moustache that gave him a wild and mysterious look. His large head was topped with a black felt cap, and he wore baggy black trousers held up by a broad black belt with amber worry beads tucked into one side. On his feet, he wore a strange pair of shiny black slippers that curled up at the toes.

"If you can tell my father how to bring water to Beit Eddin where he plans to build a palace of oriental magnificence, the like of which Lebanon has not witnessed, you will be rewarded handsomely," exclaimed Amin Kasem. Hasan only smiled, for he was a man of few words ...

Just as dusk fell, the four men arrived in Deir al-Qamar. Hasan stared at the beautiful town in amazement. Never before had he set eyes on such wonderful stone houses. They all displayed long staircases with delicate iron railings leading up to the second floors. To the south Hasan saw the Grand Serail, to the north was Fakhreddin's Mosque, and to the west, perched on top of a steep hill, was Emir Bashir's palace.

When Hasan was brought before the court, there was a general buzz of amusement among all those present. All eyes were fixed on Hasan's unusual black shiny slippers.

"My word," said the Emir's guards roaring with laughter and gazing down at Hasan's feet. "What strange slippers this fellow has on."

But Hasan was not in the least bit upset. He stood there proudly leaning on his crooked wooden stick and waited to be presented to the Emir. Presently, the court became spell bound and very quiet; for such was the magic in Hasan's highly polished slippers with their silver laces.

Hasan bowed very low when Emir Bashir entered the room.

"I shall find a way to bring water to your dream palace in Beit Eddin, Grand Emir," exclaimed Hasan in his deep voice. "I only ask that you fulfill one demand."

"Speak," said the anxious Emir, "and you shall be granted whatever you desire immediately."

"I ask for seven days and seven nights, and some simple food in a basket", Hassan answered. After seven days and seven nights, I shall return to your palace with the best possible solution."

"Granted!" cried the Emir, who realized immediately that Hasan was no ordinary

---

"We do, master," said the chief advisor pretending to look sad and crestfallen.

"If that is the case," replied the Emir, "I'm sure you shall all agree that Hasan deserves our pity rather than our anger".

While the Emir was talking, he happened to glance up at the Emira's terrace and was not in the least surprised to see her watching the scene with great amusement.

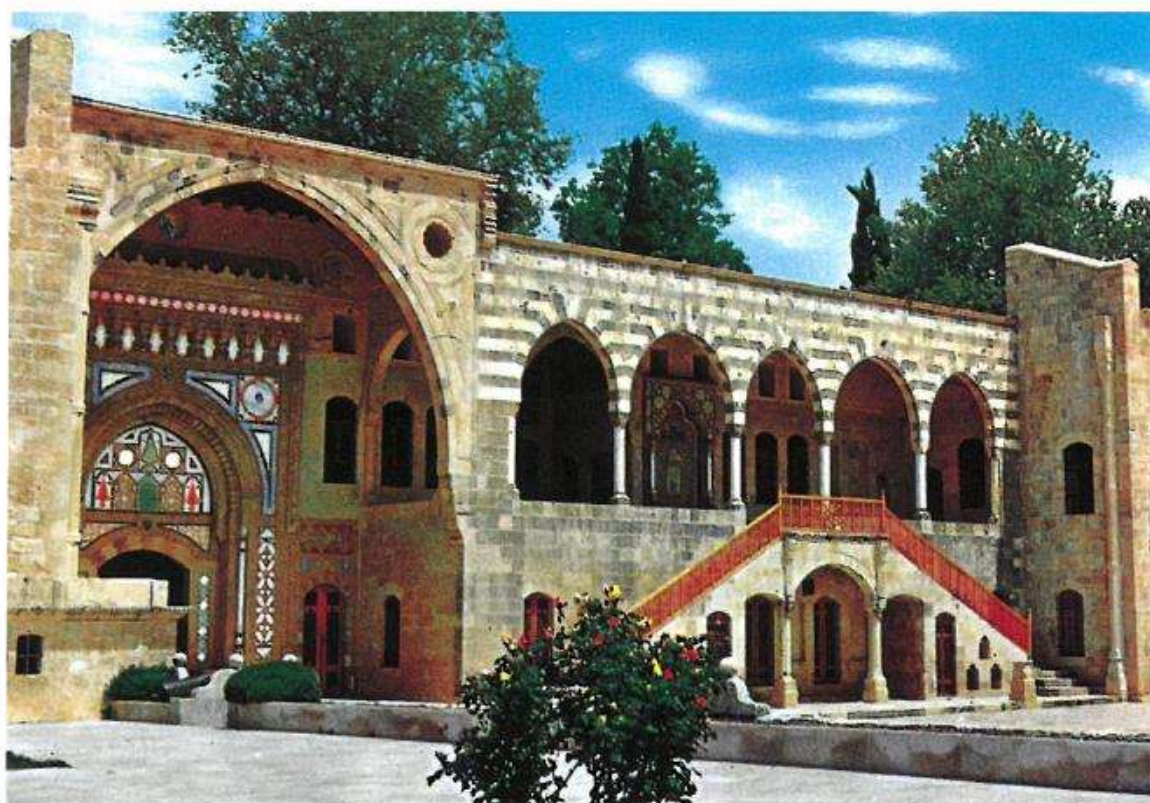
"I thank you for your concern," he said, turning his attention back to his advisors. "I will seriously consider your wise advice." And with that, he stood up and slowly strolled into the palace.

Meanwhile, Hasan continued his journey down the endless winding mountain valley. He led his donkey along steep, slippery paths that circled through high mossy green banks. The narrow trails he followed along the rugged valley walls were so slippery and dangerous that Hasan had to lean against the high walls of rock on either side to keep from losing his balance. The path itself was paved with irregular, flat cobble stones that had been bleached starchy white from the burning rays of mountain sun. How unfortunate it was that Emir Bashir had not managed to build decent roads in these lonely and deserted parts of Lebanon, thought Hasan to himself as he watched his donkey carefully search for a place to set his hoofs. Occasionally, the tired beast stretched his head down to lap up the water that flowed between the bony white pebbles.

"See how the water has flattened the stones causing them to glisten and sparkle in the bright sunlight?" said Hasan, stroking the worn-out animal gently.

When night fell, the valley was as clear as glass, and the sky was cloudless and starlit. But before Hasan settled down for the night, he scrambled to the top of a large limestone boulder on the look out for robbers that occasionally frequented deserted paths, not daring to wander about freely on the main roads for fear of the harsh punishments the Emir was likely to inflict upon them. When Hasan was satisfied that there was not a soul in sight, he allowed his eyes to marvel at the beautiful valleys and mountains that stretched out below coming to a sudden stop at the coastal plain in the distance. He stared moodily out over the dazzling dark blue Mediterranean Sea. The moon and stars seemed to sprinkle an unearthly glow on the water causing it to glimmer and sparkle like precious diamonds. Hasan, who was still perched on the great flat boulder, remained spellbound. His eyes grew misty, a far away light in them. He sat perfectly motionless allowing his senses to delight in the magnificent beauty of nature, while the cool soothing mountain breeze drifted through the spicy pine trees.

For a long time, nothing could be heard except the chirping of crickets and Hasan's heaving breathing. However, presently Hasan stood up with some effort and strolled over to a wild blackberry bush to pluck some tasty dessert. It was then that he caught sight of the terraces of vineyards that marked the boundaries of a small village nestled



among them. Why in the world do you want to leave?" concluded the worried Emira in a trembling voice. But she soon realized that her husband was too deep in thought to be paying any attention to her.

That very same day, the Emir called a meeting of his closest advisors to help him find a way to bring water to his dream palace. It was about five in the afternoon, and the weather was very hot. The servants began to throw pails of water over the paved court, which occupied the center of the lower rooms of the palace overlooking a beautiful view of the mountains.

Emir Bashir, dressed in a white silk tunic and a lemon colored mantle, was walking about barefoot, enjoying the cool water. His advisors, who formed a large ring around him, were trying to convince him to build his new palace in one of the nearby villages where there was plenty of water. The discussion continued until sunset, but still no solution was reached.

Now at the very top of the palace was the Emira's private chamber. Her terrace was beautifully paved with colored stones, and in the center was a circular basin with a fountain in the middle. The entrance was a dome supported by four pillars, painted in bright colors. Under it the Emira and her servants would sit in the daytime and overlook the courtyard below, where all the busy scene was open to their view. On this particular afternoon and evening, the Emira watched her husband with more curiosity than usual. It had not taken her long to realize how impossible it would be to change his mind about building a palace in Beit Eddin.

## Part Four

### ACTIVITY 1 .....

- A. Discuss the following with your group:
  - What is a main character?
  - What is a minor character?
- B. Identify the main characters and the minor characters in the story. Complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

Draw a character sketch of one of the characters in the story. Complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 3 .....

Discuss the following with your group:

- A. What is the setting of a story?
- B. A story can have a general setting and more specific setting or settings. Identify the general setting in this story. Identify the specific settings.

### ACTIVITY 4 .....

Identify the descriptions of the different specific settings in the story and complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 5 .....

Review the description you came up with in Exercise 5. Did you notice that water is mentioned in almost every description of a setting in the story?

- A. Identify the different words which refer explicitly or implicitly to water in the story. List these words in Exercise 6 in your Workbook.
- B. Discuss the following with your group:
  - Why does the author keep referring to water?
  - How is water related to the general theme of the story?
  - Is repetition, in your opinion, an effective technique in conveying a message? Why? How?
- C. Write a brief summary of the class discussion of the questions in Activity 5, item B.

## Part Five

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

In the following excerpt from the story Emir Bashir "called a meeting of his closest advisors to help him find a way to bring water to his dream palace ... His advisors, who formed a large ring around him, were trying to convince him to build his new palace in one of the nearby villages where there was plenty of water."

- A. Brainstorm with your group all the possible arguments the advisors could have presented to the Emir in order to try to convince him.
- B. Imagine the exact dialogue which took place between the Emir, on one hand, and his advisors, on the other. Write the dialogue the way you imagine it happened.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

In Activity 1, you brainstormed the possible arguments for living in a place "where there was plenty of water". Thus, you must have realized how the quest for water affects a society and its economy i.e., the importance of water for social aggregation and economic prosperity. Draw a socio-economic profile of the community / communities which the story focuses on. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

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### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Share your socio-economic profiles with the class and have a class discussion on how water figures in these profiles i.e., to what extent does the need for water shape the society and the economy in the story.

### Assignment:

.....

In the two selections you have read so far in this chapter, water plays an important role. The coastal location of Tyre opened it up to foreign trade, which helped shape its history, society, and economy. Mount Lebanon, as portrayed in the story, had a different history, society, and economy, having been located away from the coast. Write an essay to compare and contrast Tyre to Mount Lebanon in terms of history, society and economy basing your comparison on information and descriptive details taken from the two selections.

## Part Six

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Listen to the lecture entitled "The Origin of Sociology and Economics" to get a general idea. As you listen, complete Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Listen to the lecture again and try to understand the main points of the discussion. As you listen, complete Exercise 9 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Below you have the script of the lecture. Skim it to check your answers to Exercises 8 and 9. Compare your answers with those of other students.

## The Origins of Sociology and Economics

The scientific study of human conduct and of society is as recent as the early 1800s. The tremendous changes brought about by the French Revolution (1789) and the Industrial Revolution in Europe laid the ground for sociology and indirectly for economics. The collapse of conventional ways of life as a result of these changes prompted thinkers to read both the social and natural worlds differently in an attempt to reach a new understanding of them.

The French thinker Auguste Comte (1798-1857) is considered a major contributor to early sociological thinking. Not only was he among the first to use the term 'social physics', but he was also the one to coin the term 'sociology'. This new field, according to Comte, uses scientific evidence to acquire knowledge of society. By understanding human behavior through science, sociology could as a result predict and control this behavior, thus contributing to the welfare of humanity. Based on this belief, Comte wrote on how to restructure human societies, especially the French society.



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### **Emir Bashir and Akhwat Shanai** (Continued)

When the Emir heard that Hasan had returned, he seated himself on his diwan with Sitt Shams by his side. A brilliant assembly of notables and advisors streamed in and took their places on the rich silk cushions placed along the walls.

"Well Hasan," exclaimed the Emir anxiously, "have you found a solution to my problem?"

"I have," answered Hasan confidently.

"Then what are you waiting for, my fine fellow? Tell us at once," cried the delighted Emir.

A grave hush fell over the court; all eyes were fixed on Hasan.

"You must make every man dig his grave," cried Hasan letting out a strange hysterical laugh.

Upon hearing this, the whole court roared with laughter and muttered wildly. The Emir's advisors were delighted. They looked at one another with relief which gave way to vicious bouts of laughter. But just as the guards were preparing to take Hasan away, Emir Bashir, who was so astounded that he could hardly speak for a moment, raised his hand to silence the court which had fallen into an utter state of confusion.

25

"Stop. Leave the crazy man alone so that he may explain this foolish statement," said the Emir.

"Every mountaineer in the surrounding villages must be asked to dig a ditch," explained Hasan taking a deep breath. "The ditch that each one digs must be equal in length and depth to their height. If they dig for nine miles, they will reach a spring called al-Safa."

"By digging what is equivalent to their graves, the villagers will really be digging an aqueduct which will bring water from al-Safa to my new palace. Furthermore, by having the villagers do this, my treasury will not be wrecked," said the Emir, who seemed delighted with Hasan's excellent advice.

Two years later, in July 1812, a nine-mile aqueduct bringing water from al-Safa to the new capital at Beit Eddin was completed. To build the palace itself, the Emir hired the best masons in Lebanon. He also sent for Syrian artisans skillful in the polishing of marble and the setting of mosaic. The palace was magnificent with its slender Arabic arches, rich marble, mosaic stone decorations, flowing fountains and ornate ceilings. It was surrounded by terraces of vines, trees and flowers with the valleys and mountains stretching out below to the distant sea shore.

- B. How similar or different is the original ending to the one you wrote? Do you agree with the author's ending? Why or why not? Discuss this with your group.

in a distant valley. In no time at all, the sounds of humanity began to take shape: the laughter of children, the ringing of church bells, and old woman screaming at her neighbor. Hasan sighed to himself. How far away; how isolated I am, he thought as he popped the last tasty blackberry into his mouth before curling up at the foot of the large flat boulder and falling into deep slumber.

The next morning, Hasan led his donkey along the winding mountain path. Together, they continued their dangerous ascent along the wild path up the mountain-side until they rounded the last steep stretch and came to a sudden halt before a number of enormous gray boulders that seemed to disappear into the fluffy white clouds overhead. A grave and mysterious presence seemed to engulf the entire mountain top. Everything was empty and bare. The clip-clop of the donkey's hoofs sent echoes that bounced from valley to valley.

A smile spread across Hasan's weary face, for the cave which loomed before him was his secret hideout. He alone knew the where-about of this mysterious spot where he often sat for days on end meditating and thinking. All the skill and magic he possessed had been inspired by the peace, beauty and solitude discovered within the walls of this enormous dark cave.

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Hasan remained in the cave for four days and five nights. On the morning of the sixth day, he prepared to return to Deir al-Qamar sad and downcast because he had not hit upon a solution to the Emir's problem. He stood crestfallen outside the cave rubbing his eyes in the cheerful sunshine. "How can I possibly accept defeat?" he moaned lowering his eyes to the ground in despair.

Then suddenly his whole face lit up, and a faint smile came to his lips as he sank down closer to the earth. The little man's eyes were fixed upon something with a kind of twinkling amusement. For there before him was a colony of ants feverishly gliding back and forth. Presently, Hasan's eyes began to twinkle as he bent down even closer to the earth in order to examine these minute creatures busily digging long, thin tunnels in the soft sand.

"I've got it!" cried Hasan breathlessly. "I've hit upon the best solution." And with that, he sprang up and began his long journey down the steep, rugged mountainside whistling cheerfully to himself the whole way.

## ACTIVITY

3

- A. Read your ending of the story to your classmates and explain to them what made you give it this ending. (Refer to certain clues in the story.) Listen to their endings and explanations. Then read the continuation to the story which is printed below and consider whether you agree or disagree with the original ending the author wrote.



## Part Seven

### ACTIVITY 1 .....

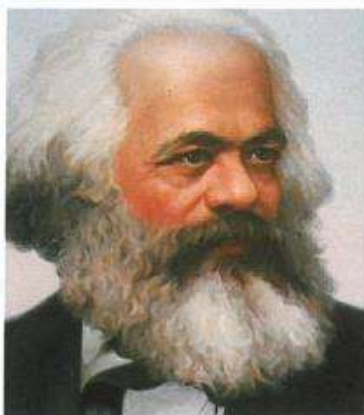
Listen to parts of the lecture and identify which thinker each part describes. Complete Exercise 10 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

Read "The Origins of Sociology and Economics" and fill out the chart in Exercise 11 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 3 .....

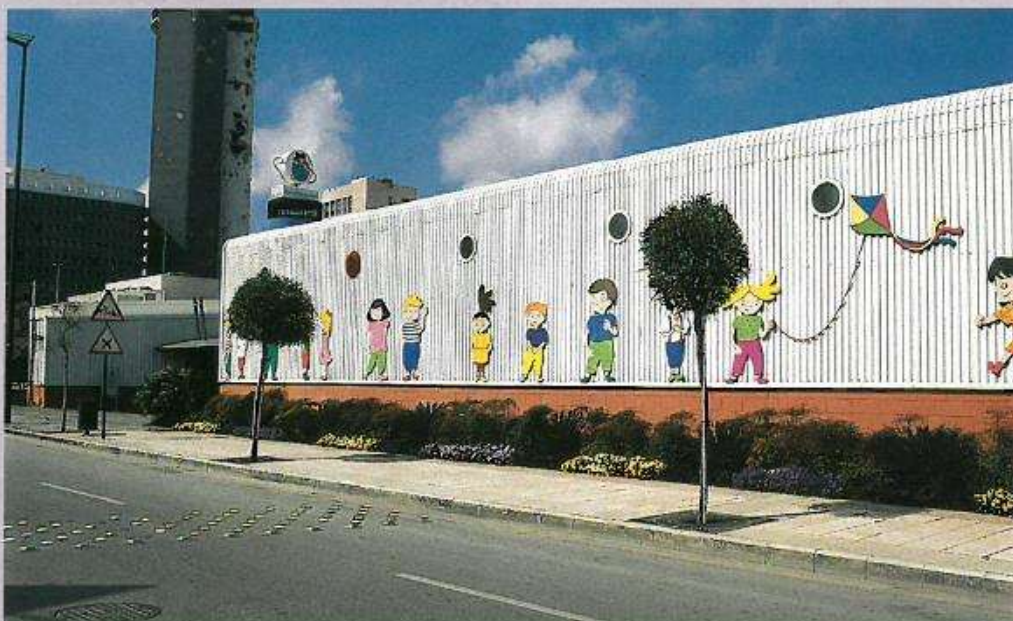
Evaluate and critique the different theories presented in "The Origins of Sociology and Economics". Complete Exercise 12 in your Workbook.



## *National Reconstruction Plans*

"In the depth of winter  
I finally learned there  
was in me invincible  
summer."

*Albert Camus*



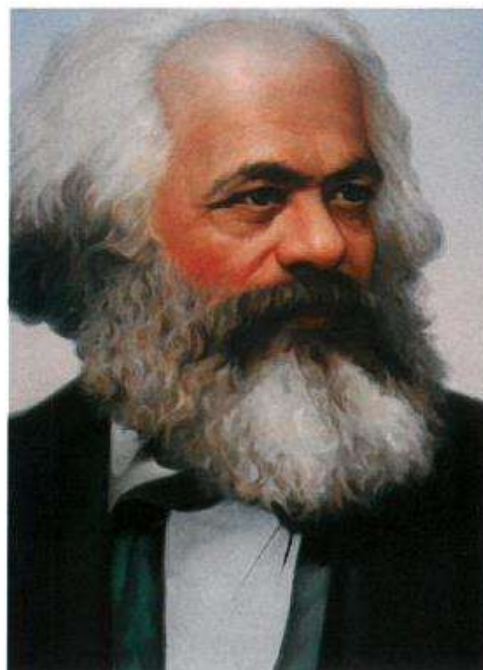
Emile Durkheim (1858-1917), another French writer, drew on aspects of Comte's work but found many of Comte's ideas speculative and vague. He believed that Comte did not succeed in establishing sociology on a scientific basis. For sociology to become scientific, Durkheim believed it must study social facts i.e., elements of social life which influence our actions as individuals, such as the economic condition or the effect of religion. His principle of sociology, "study social facts as things", meant that social life can be analyzed like objects or occurrences in nature.



Durkheim, similarly to other initial contributors to sociology, studied the changes which reshaped society at the time. He concluded that what holds society together is its common values and customs. He also believed that what caused social change was the emergence of the division of labor i.e., the separation between different occupations, which he believed to be the new basis of social cohesion. In other words, people came to rely increasingly on one another to get goods and services provided by different people in different occupations, thus making society cohesive. However, Durkheim thought that the rapid changes in the modern world and the breakdown of traditional moral standards created anomie, a feeling of despair or lack of purpose, which in turn created serious social problems, such as suicide, and left numerous individuals feeling that their lives were meaningless.

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Although Karl Marx's (1818-1883) beliefs are quite different than those of Comte's and Durkheim's, he attempted to explain, like they did, the changes in society at the time of the Industrial Revolution. Marx wrote on a wide variety of subjects, and much of his work focused on economic issues, but no one denies the importance of his work in the development of sociology, for he linked economic problems to social institutions. In contrast to Durkheim, who believed that human ideas or values are the primary causes of social change, Marx believed that social change is mainly provoked by economic influences. This is based on what he called the materialist conception of history. Marx wrote, "All human history thus far is the history of class struggles", thus explaining historical development as prompted by class conflicts i.e., the rich versus the poor.



Marx wrote mostly on changes in modern times, the most important of which for him were linked with the development of capitalism, a system of production fundamentally different from earlier economic systems in history, such as feudalism\*. This system produces goods and services and sells them to a great number of consumers. In it the group who has capital i.e., great amounts of money, factories, etc, constitutes the ruling class. The majority of the population form the working class, who are obliged to seek work from the capital owners because the working class does not own the means of its living. Thus, capitalism is fundamentally a class system, where conflict between the rich and poor is inherent in the system. Marx believed that capitalism will be succeeded by a more equal society where economic and political power will not be controlled by a small class, but will be subject to communal ownership, by means of which the working classes enjoy the benefits of their work.

Max Weber (1864-1920), like his contemporaries, studied social change. He wrote in sociology, economics, law, philosophy and comparative history and gave a great deal of attention to the development of modern capitalism. In this respect, he was like Marx whose views both influenced, and conflicted with some of Weber's basic views. Although Weber, like Marx, considered economic factors important in inducing social change; unlike Marx, he saw that ideas and values are equally influential. He also differed from Marx in his interpretation of modern societies and in his analysis of why western ways of life have spread worldwide.



Weber saw that capitalism is not the sole factor in social development. He believed that science and bureaucracy play, in some ways, a more important role. They are important because, first, science has shaped modern technology and will continue to do so in all future societies; second, bureaucracy is the only method of efficiently organizing a great number of people, so bureaucracy is bound to expand with economic and political growth. Weber described the development of science, modern technology, and bureaucracy as rationalization, which means using the principles of efficiency and technical knowledge to organize social and economic life.

\* a system in which people are given land and protection by lords and they work and fight for the lords in return.

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Three weeks after the fire, Edison managed to deliver his first phonograph.

- 1- Did the ending come as a surprise to you?
- 2- Is Edison's reaction normal in this situation?
- 3- Would you have reacted in the same way?
- 4- If not, how would you have reacted and why?

### ACTIVITY

3

- .....
- A- What is the purpose of this story and what lesson does it teach? Read the story carefully and summarize the theme in not more than two sentences.
- B- Can you think of a similar incident you have experienced or read about? If so, write a short paragraph explaining what you have learned from this experience. Share your paragraph with your classmates.

## Part Two

35

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Read the title of the selection "Beirut: The City That Would Not Die". Do you agree or disagree with the notion that Beirut is the city that would not die? Discuss your ideas with the class and justify your answer.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

The selection discusses specific topics about Beirut. Read the selection and complete Exercise 1 in your Workbook.

### Beirut: The City That Would Not Die

- 1- Beirut, with its million-plus inhabitants, conveys a sense of life and energy that is immediately apparent. This dynamism is echoed by the Capital's geographical position: a great promontory\* jutting into the blue sea with dramatic mountains rising behind it. A city with a venerable past, 5,000 years ago Beirut was a prosperous town on the Canaanite and Phoenician coast.

---

\* a cliff that stretches out into the sea.

## Part One

### ACTIVITY

1

Discuss with your group the title of the story "Great Value in Disaster" and try to predict its content from the title. Also, tell your teammates who Edison was and what he invented.

### ACTIVITY

2

Read the story. Then react to the questions which follow it. Share your reactions with your partner.

## Great Value in Disaster

*If your house is on fire, warm yourself by it.*

Spanish Proverb

34

Thomas Edison's laboratory was virtually destroyed by fire in December 1914. Although the damage exceeded \$2 million, the buildings were only insured for \$238,000 because they were made of concrete and thought to be fireproof. Much of Edison's life's work went up in spectacular flames that December night.

At the height of the fire, Edison's 24-year-old son, Charles, frantically searched for his father among the smoke and debris. He finally found him, calmly watching the scene, his face glowing in the reflection, his white hair blowing in the wind.

"My heart ached for him," said Charles. "He was 67, no longer a young man and everything was going up in flames. When he saw me, he shouted, 'Charles, where's your mother?' When I told him I didn't know, he said, 'Find her. Bring her here. She will never see anything like this as long as she lives.'"

The next morning, Edison looked at the ruins and said, "There is great value in disaster. All our mistakes are burned up. Thank God we can start anew."



- 10- Beneath the ruined downtown area, which is under reconstruction, lie the remains of Ottoman, Mamluke, Crusader, Abbassid, Omayyad, Byzantine, Roman, Persian, Phoenician and Canaanite Beirut. With luck, a good portion of Beirut's history will be uncovered before reconstruction is complete.
- 11- Beginning in 1993, archaeologists and builders began cooperating on just such a project. Teams from Lebanese and foreign institutions have found significant remains from each of Beirut's historical periods. All discoveries are being carefully recorded and many will be preserved.

## ACTIVITY

3

Analyze the style of the author. Discuss the following in your group.

- A- Why does the author use words such as energy, dynamism, resiliency, vigorous, innovations and flourishing? How is this related to the main idea of this selection?
- B- Do these words create a special mood or tone? How would you describe the tone?
- C- How is the tone-related to the title? Is the idea of vibrancy and life conveyed through the choice of diction? Explain.

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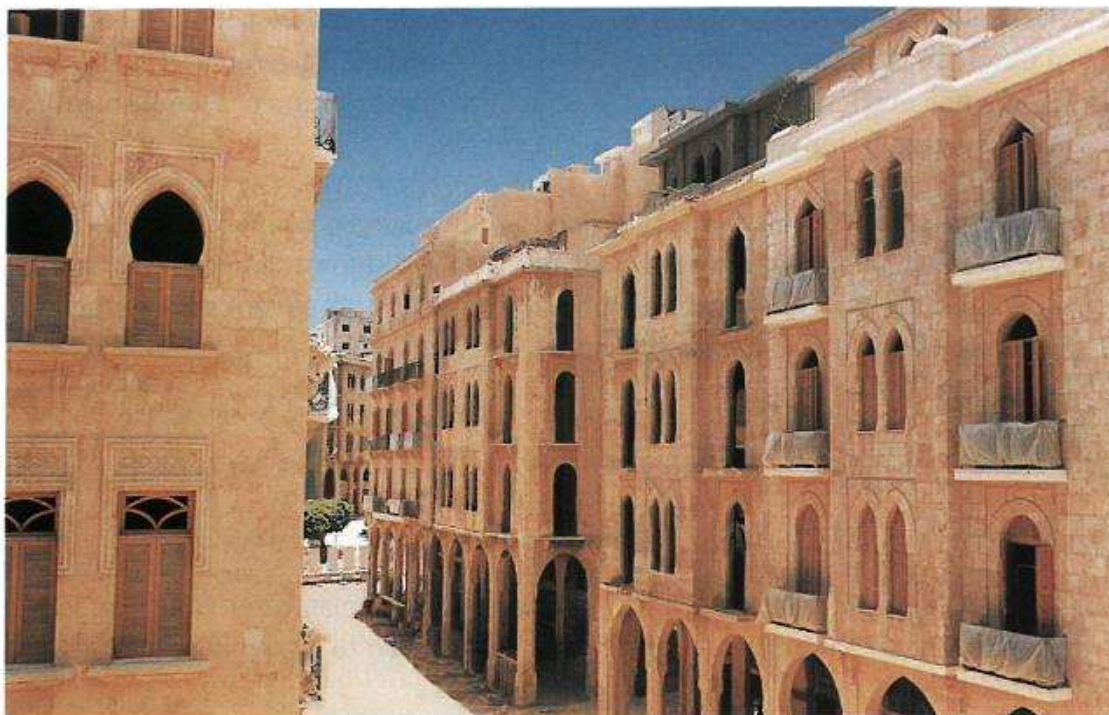
## ACTIVITY

4

Use the words mentioned in item A-Activity 3 and other words you might have chosen yourself from the selection to write a piece of verse on "Beirut: The City That Would Not Die". Use your imagination and do not be afraid to experiment. Share your verse/poems/songs with your classmates.

## Assignment:

The selection states that Beirut has survived a number of different kinds of disasters ranging from major earthquakes to civil strife. Keeping in mind the theme in "Great Value in Disaster", think of how Beirut has benefited from the disasters it was subjected to in the past. Use the information in the selection to do some library or field research. Write a report on how Beirut has benefited from its past catastrophes on the economic, social, urban planning, or educational levels, etc. Try to conclude your report with recommendations on what the Lebanese should do to build a Beirut which is immune to all kinds of disasters.



- 6- The Lebanese capital enjoys a vigorous press that publishes in Arabic, English, French and Armenian. Five Universities help keep ideas and innovations flowing. The flourishing art scene, including theater, film making, music and plastic arts adds to the sense that it is indeed a city on the move.
- 7- Its many advantages also make Beirut a natural venue<sup>1</sup> for international, regional or local conferences and conventions.
- 8- Beirut's Port, the largest in the eastern Mediterranean, is equipped to handle tens of freight and passenger vessels. Further updating of its busy facilities will be made as part of Lebanon's general reconstruction plan. Beirut international Airport, which serves the national carrier Middle East Airlines and numerous foreign airlines, will have an annual capacity of six million passengers by the start of the 21<sup>st</sup> century.
- 9- The 1.8 million-square-meter reconstruction project for Beirut's Central District includes hotels, office space and residential areas. But not all the buildings will be new. Some 265 structures will be restored by 1998, plus historic mosques and churches. Beirut's souks or markets will be reconstructed in traditional style by 1999. Solidere, the private company taking on the challenge of this 25-year project, plans a modern infrastructure of roads, utilities, public areas and marine works. More than half a million square meters of landfill<sup>2</sup> will provide land for two marinas, a seaside promenade and a green park.

1- a place where an action or event has been arranged to happen.

2- a low area of land that is built up by deposits of solid refuse covered by soil.

## UNIT 2

- 2- Beirut stands on the site of a very ancient settlement going back at least 5,000 years. Its name appeared in cuneiform<sup>1</sup> inscriptions as early as the 14<sup>th</sup> century B.C. In the first century B.C., Berytus, as it was then called, became a Roman Colony and under Roman rule was the seat of a famous Law School which continued into the Byzantine era.
- 3- But the power and the glory of Berytus were destroyed by a triple catastrophe of earthquake, tidal wave and fire in 551 A.D. In the following century Arab Muslim forces took the city and in 1110 it fell to the Crusaders. Beirut remained in Crusader hands until 1291 when it was conquered by the Mamlukes. Ottoman rule began in 1516, continuing for 400 years until the defeat of the Turks in World War I. The French Mandate Period followed and in 1943 Lebanon gained its independence.
- 4- Beirut survived a decade and a half of conflict and so has earned the right to call itself "the City that would not die". As if to demonstrate this resiliency<sup>2</sup>, the Lebanese have launched a great rush of building activity, including the public service infrastructure<sup>3</sup>. In the ruined City Center, a huge reconstruction project is underway to create a new commercial and residential district for the 21<sup>st</sup> century.
- 5- Commerce is second nature to Beirutis, who long ago discovered that their port city on the East-West cross-roads was ideally placed for trading and business of all kinds. A banking center with free currency exchange, the chief employment here is in trade, banking, construction, import-export and service industries.

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1- composed of slim triangular elements, as writing by the ancient Babylonian.

2- the ability to recover quickly from a misfortune.

3- the basic structure on which it is built such as the facilities, services, and equipment needed.

- 
- And killed a woman ... once called Liberty ...
3. Rise out of your sleep ...  
Radiant princess  
A lamp shining in our hearts ...  
Rise up - - Beirut!  
So that the world revives  
So that we revive  
And love revives ...
4. Rise up ...  
Most beautiful pearl, gift of the sea ...  
Now we know what it means  
To kill a bird at dawn  
Now we know what it means ...  
To pour a bottle of ink on the summery sky  
Now we know ...  
That we stood against God ...  
That we stood against poetry ...
5. Rise out of your sorrow  
Revolutions are born out of the womb's sorrow  
Rise up to glorify the forests ...  
The rivers ....  
The valleys ...  
Rise up to glorify man ...  
We were guilty, Beirut  
And have come begging for absolution ...
6. I still love you, crazy Beirut ...  
I still love you, kind-hearted Beirut ...  
Chaotic Beirut,  
Beirut of outrageous hunger ...  
And outrageous surfeit ...  
.
7. I still love you impassioned Beirut ...  
I still love you despite human folly  
I still love you  
Why don't we start right now?

**ACTIVITY****2**

Study the imagery and symbolism in the poem.  
Complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

---

## Part Three

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Try to guess the missing words in the first two stanzas of the poem "Beirut! O Queen of the World". Complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook. Compare your answers with your group's and explain to them your choice of words.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

- A- Listen to the first two stanzas of the poem and fill in the missing words in Exercise 2 in your Workbook. Compare the original words with the ones you guessed.
- B- Study the words which were left out and try to find some kind of relationship between them. Discuss the following with your group.
  - a- Are they words that are usually used to describe a city?
  - b- The dictionary definition of personification is as follows: a figure of speech in which a thing, quality, or idea is represented as a person. Do you recognize instances of personification in the two stanzas?
  - c- Is Beirut personified?
  - d- What is it personified as?
  - e- What is the significance of this personification?

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### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Listen to the complete poem and write down other words or phrases which the poet uses to personify Beirut. Then complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

## Part Four

### ACTIVITY

1

Read the poem to complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

### Beirut! O Queen of the World

by Nizar Kabbani

1. Beirut! O Queen of the World...  
Who sold your ruby-chiselled bracelets?  
Who took away your magic ring,  
And cut out your golden nails?



2. Who killed the joy in your green eyes,  
Slashed your face with a knife,  
And threw burning acid on your lovely lips?  
Who poisoned the sea water  
And sprinkled hatred on your rosy beaches?  
Here we come ... to apologize ... to confess  
That we fired on you with a tribal spirit ...

## ACTIVITY 3

Analyze the tone in the poem. Complete Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

## Part Five

## ACTIVITY 1

- A- Read the first three paragraphs of the selection "Planet Discovery" and imagine what you would see on a visit to Planet Discovery. Make a list of these activities.
- B- Compare the activities you listed with those listed by other members of your group. Explain to each other what made you think of such activities.

### Planet Discovery

Children between the ages of 3 and 15 have been streaming to Beirut Central District since February 26, 1999, to visit Planet Discovery. Lebanon's first permanent children's museum was created by SOLIDERE in collaboration with the French science museum La Cité des Sciences et de l'Industrie de la Villette (Paris).

Planet Discovery offers the children an itinerary\*, especially designed for them, where the secrets of life and the surrounding world are revealed in both a fascinating and entertaining way.

All activities are available, according to the children's needs, in either of three languages, Arabic, English and French, in addition to Braille. Most impor-



\* a plan of a journey showing the route and the places that you will visit.

tant, however, is the excitement of discovery and learning that accompanies them throughout their visit.

*The Unfinished House* is a building site of 120 sq m where young children team up and work towards a common end: finishing the construction of a house. In addition to providing a physical and social play arena, this activity initiates children in teamwork and in the planning and distribution of tasks.

*In the Children's Village*, 'Draw with the finger' introduces the 3-to 12-year olds to the spectrum\* of existing colors, which they can obtain by drawing with their fingers on a computer screen. When reaching the section 'How life works', they learn how the body evolves before and after birth, with special sections explaining the respiratory and blood circulation systems. This heightens the children's awareness about their body and how it operates. Nearby, they study insect life; one activity shows how an ant reacts to different situations it may find itself in. Another activity in the Children's



Village enables them to discover a new means of communication, the videophone, which combines telephone, camera and television screen.

*Building Structures*, open to children between the ages of 5 and 15, offers information about some of the basic building structures used in architecture. Activities include demonstration methods for the construction of a beam, arch, or dome. The

\* the range of different colors in the order of their wavelengths.

## UNIT 2

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### ACTIVITY

3

.....

The selection describes two countries and two cultures, Lebanon and the United States. Use the new words in the selection (which you have checked in the dictionary at home) to summarize the most important characteristics of the United States and the most important characteristics of Lebanon as seen through Ramzi's eyes.

### ACTIVITY

4

.....

In the last three paragraphs, the author discusses his hopes for the future of Lebanon and the reconstruction of Lebanese society. Respond to the author's views in writing by stating whether you agree or disagree with him. Add your own hopes for the future of Lebanon.

- B- Team up with another group and compare your lists. Select five items from the lists and justify why they should be given priority.
- C- Now compare your five item list with the five item list of another group, and select one item that you all agree is the most important. Discuss and justify your decision.

### ACTIVITY

3

Write a letter to Planet Discovery in which you suggest adding another activity (the one you decided on in Activity 2). In your letter justify why this activity is needed i.e., explain its educational benefits to children and its cultural benefits to Beirut.

### Assignment:

In the future, there are plans to help Beirut regain its role as an active cultural center. Do some research to find out about the cultural activities that used to take place in Beirut. Also, find out about other big cities such as Paris, London, New York, etc. Based on your research, write a proposal to the Ministry of Culture in which you include cultural activities you would like to see take place in Beirut. Also, make concrete suggestions that might help Beirut regain its cultural significance in the region.

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## Part Seven

### ACTIVITY

1

Read the selection "Lebanon Through Ramzi's Eyes" and complete Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

### Lebanon Through Ramzi's Eyes

by Samir Khalaf

When we left Lebanon in the summer of 1984, our youngest son, Ramzi, was barely two years old. Now he is nine and his world is largely a fantasy world of "secret gardens" - - witches, ghosts, animated cartoons, superstars and entertainers. His room is cluttered with posters and mementos\* of his idols.

\* objects which you keep because it reminds you of a person or a special occasion..

---

replaced it with his new acquisition and his reawakened longings to reconnect with a disinherited<sup>1</sup> past. He now counts the days to the moment he will behold the same riveting<sup>7</sup> view from the window of the plane taking him back home.

Ramzi's rediscovery of his country's natural and historic endowments should not be dismissed as an infantile gesture. It carries an instructive message. Just as an intuitive young boy is willing to part with his ephemeral<sup>3</sup>, often catchy symbols and embrace those of a higher and more endowing order, so his besieged compatriots in Lebanon (young and old) could do likewise.

Now that many are seeing or revisiting parts of their country inaccessible to them before, they too, it is hoped, will renounce the alien and borrowed ideologies they had embraced to sustain their belligerency<sup>4</sup>. They could begin by disarming themselves of the instruments of collective violence.

Lebanon has long been plagued by disharmony between its natural beauty and its boisterous<sup>5</sup> political culture. An awakened sense of geography among Lebanese, sustained by an ethos<sup>6</sup> for preserving the edifying<sup>7</sup> features of one's habitat, could be sobering and enriching. Moreover, in a postwar period it could inspire needed tranquillity and vitality.

## ACTIVITY

2

47

Discuss the following with your group:

- 1- Who is the narrator and what is the narrator's relationship to Ramzi?
- 2- What is the purpose of this narrative?
- 3- How is the focus of this selection different from the focus of other selections you have read in this chapter?
- 4- What aspect of the reconstruction of Lebanon does this selection focus on?
- 5- Why does the narrator/author make a child the focus of his narrative?
- 6- How can children succeed where adults have failed?

---

1- lost cultural or social traditions.

2- fascinating, holds attention firmly and completely.

3- lasts only for a short time.

4- hostility and aggressiveness.

5- noisy, lively and full of energy.

6- set of ideas and attitudes that is associated with a particular group of people.

7- intended to make people better, instructive, educational.

children may learn about different forces exerted on the material and the resulting deformation. Then they discover the techniques used to prevent any failure or collapse of structures that might be caused by these forces.

*Phenomena* demonstrates to the 10- to 15-year olds some theories in physics and mathematics in a simple and practical way. They learn to use scientific instruments ranging from the magnifying glass to the electronic microscope. The wonder of how planes fly is also revealed to them through a demonstration of the effects of gravity and pressure.

The 1,200 sq m Planet Discovery, temporarily set up on Omar Daouk street, is destined to become a permanent feature in the Souks of Beirut. Abiding by international standards of safety and security, it is equipped to welcome the disabled and visually-impaired. Aside from scientific activities, Planet Discovery offers the public various facilities for private exhibitions, birthdays and special events.

Planet Discovery is the first in a series of attractions planned by SOLIDERE to help the Beirut Central District regain its role as a center of cultural activity.

44

## ACTIVITY 2 .....

Scan the selection and list the activities which are mentioned in it. Compare this list to the one you imagined in Activity 1.

## ACTIVITY 3 .....

Choose one activity (mentioned in the selection) that you find particularly interesting and explain in one paragraph why it appeals to you.

## Part Six

## ACTIVITY 1 .....

Scan the selection again to complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY 2 .....

A- With your group, make a list of the activities you would like to add to the museum.

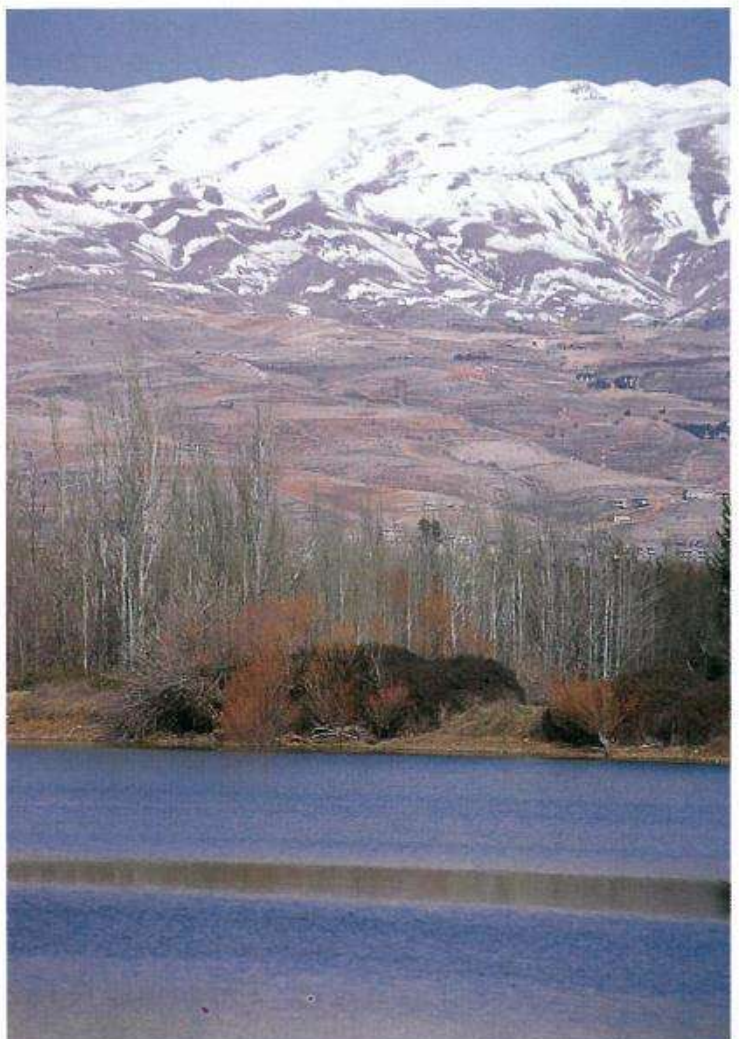
An episode a few days ago signaled the first symptoms of a change in his self-image, with portents<sup>1</sup>, perhaps, of a more felicitous<sup>2</sup> reshaping of interests and loyalties. We had gone to the Lebanese consulate in New York to renew our expired passports in anticipation of our trip to Lebanon this month.

The moment Ramzi walked into the consulate and saw posters of Lebanon - - the usual glossy mounted portraits one sees in tourist offices and travel agencies - - he was overtaken by amazement and wonder. There was a sparkle in his eyes, as dazzling and consummate<sup>3</sup> as the entrenchment<sup>4</sup> which overwhelms him while dancing or simulating the fantasy world of his favorite fairy tales.

To him, the scenes from Lebanon were juxtaposed<sup>5</sup> against the ordered, flat, dull, antiseptic milestones of America - - at least the America most familiar to him, the America of suburbia, manicured<sup>6</sup> lawns and parks, shopping malls and mega<sup>7</sup>-highways. They seemed out of this world and much closer to Ramzi's world of make-believe.

He was awestruck. The Lebanese consul, touched by Ramzi's reaction, graciously offered him a poster. He picked a view of Sannin, with the highest snowcapped ranges and rifts of Mount Lebanon peaking in splendor against the blue skies.

When Ramzi got home he furtively<sup>8</sup> dismounted one of Madonna's portraits and



1- something that indicates what is likely to happen in the future.

2- particularly suitable, appropriate and well-chosen.

3- a perfect or extreme example of a particular thing.

4- the strong, deeply established, difficult to change state of being.

5- put close together to emphasize the difference between them.

6- well taken care of.

7- very big.

8- as if to keep something secret.

C- Mention some of the terms used to describe the first picture. What generalization can you make about these terms?

D- Mention some of the terms used to describe the second picture. What generalization can you make about these terms.

E- According to the poem, should the two conflicting pictures co-exist? Justify your answer.

F- What is the theme of this poem?

G- This poem was written in the eighteenth century.

In your opinion, does its theme still apply today?

Justify your answer.

## Holy Thursday

by William Blake  
(1757-1827)

Is this a holy thing to see  
In a rich and fruitful land –  
Babes reduced to misery,  
Fed with cold and usurous hand?

Is that trembling cry a song?  
Can it be a song of joy?  
And so many children poor  
It is a land of poverty!

And their sun does never shine,  
And their fields are bleak and bare,  
And their ways are filled with thorns:  
It is eternal winter there.

For where'er the sun does shine,  
And where'er the rain does fall,  
Babe can never hunger there,  
Nor poverty the mind appall.



51

### ACTIVITY



.....

Write a poem or a short story about one of the groups you included in your answer to item D - Activity 1.

## Part One

### ACTIVITY



.....

Read the story and discuss the following questions in your group:

- A- Why is it significant that the contestants are all physically or mentally disabled?
- B- The title is "What's Really Important". After reading the story, can you tell what is really important? Is it winning, or is it the way one treats his fellow humans?
- C- How is the meaning of this story related to the theme of human rights?
- D- The story is about a group of people who are sometimes discriminated against, namely the disabled. Can you think of other groups who have been historically or are currently discriminated against?

### What's Really Important

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A few years ago at the Seattle Special Olympics, nine contestants, all physically or mentally disabled, assembled at the starting line for the 100-yard dash. At the gun they all started out, not exactly in a dash, but with the relish to run the race to the finish and win.



All, that is, except one boy who stumbled on the asphalt, tumbled over a couple of times, and began to cry. The other eight heard the boy cry. They slowed down and paused. Then they all turned around and went back. Every one of them. One girl with Down's syndrome bent down, kissed him and said, "This will make it better," Then all nine linked arms and walked together to the finish line.

Everyone in the stadium stood, and the cheering went on for 10 minutes.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Read the poem and discuss the following questions in your group:

- A- What group of people is the poem about? Is this group given its rights? Why or why not? Did you include this group in your answer to item D-activity 1?
- B- The poem presents two contradictory and conflicting pictures? What are they? Why are they conflicting?

## Part Two

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Before you read the selection, answer the questions in Exercise 1 in your Workbook. Work with your group.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Compare the selection you wrote on human rights to the selection entitled "The Development of Human Rights". Then complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

## The Development of Human Rights

by Raif Khoury

(1913-1967)

52

A shrewd historian once noted that in none of the wall drawings from the times of the Pharaohs was there a single drawing that showed a peasant enjoying himself or working in his own vineyard; not a single drawing indicated that independent thinking or occupations were allowed for the poor, who were subjugated<sup>1</sup> to serve the Prince.

However, history was fulfilling its task. History was progressing, though slowly sometimes, towards Man's awareness that he has rights, which were usurped<sup>2</sup> by the powerful, who burdened Man with the expensive cost of their prosperity and dominance. The course which history has taken since dark ages is not linear. It has taken detours although it continues to move forward.

There have been poets, scientists, artisans, intellectuals, and philosophers, whose intellect and commitment elevated them to the zenith<sup>3</sup>. They were humanitarians who sided with the people. The Greek philosopher Democritus dreamt about an equitable society, in which human rights were safeguarded. He believed that the only worthwhile society is the one which allows the majority to experience the greatest portion of happiness, with as little pain as possible.

It did not demean such devoted and sincere thinkers that their imagination detached them from reality. Nor did it demean them that civilization had not yet reached the stage of historical evolution that created the material conditions to actualize their dreams. They often had to live in yearning without any hope, in much the same way

1- taken complete control of; treated as less important.

2- taken without right.

3- the highest point.

Dante described the inhabitants of Hell in *The Divine Comedy*, or die with their rage as al –Maari, an Arab poet, would similarly express it.

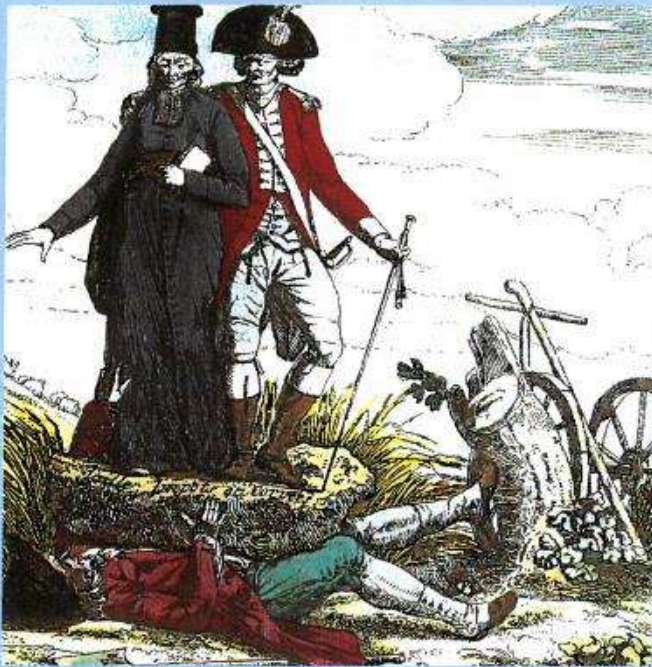
The major turning point in history towards the establishment of human rights was undoubtedly the French Revolution. In the Eighteenth Century, absolute monarchy and privileges enjoyed by the aristocracy and the clergy burdened the people of France. The French Revolution gave birth to an important document which should be known to all those who want to acquaint themselves with the spirit and achievements of the French Revolution. This document is known as the Declaration of Human Rights, which is an immortal document in the history of mankind. Although some critics have tried to lessen the real worth of this document, claiming that it is nothing but a beautiful dream, it is important to remember that beautiful dreams were among the factors that shaped human history.



On August 26, 1789, the human rights text was finalized and announced to the people by the French National Assembly. The main items of this document can be summarized as follows:

- People are born free and remain so, having equal rights, namely freedom, property, security, and resistance against oppression.
- The limits of freedom allow for a human being to do whatever he wants on condition that he does not harm others.
- Charters are phenomena born out of general will. It is the right of every citizen to participate in their legislation either in person or through a representative he elects.

# Human Rights and Democracy



*"On the international level, nowadays, we are faced with two choices: either life and the flourishing of human rights, or death and decay. The only course to take is that of democracy, for in the shade of democracy flourish the rights of citizens and their freedom, rights which are vital for development and success in every aspect of our lives"*

**Raif Khoury**

*"The shedding of blood is forbidden. Who, then, has sanctioned it to the ruler?...*

*Shall we meet evil with greater evil and say: this is the law; and fight corruption with more corruption and proclaim it moral? Shall we overcome a crime with one greater and call it justice?"*

**Kahlil Gibran**



- C- In pairs, use the key words to reconstruct the generalizations, correcting any that have been declared false. (Do not look at the selection). Your teacher will be circulating to help you with the reconstruction.

## ACTIVITY

2

.....

- A- Choose the generalization from the list for which you have the greatest amount of support. This sentence will serve as an opening sentence of a paragraph.
- B- Compose a well-supported paragraph starting with the selected generalization. (Do not look at the selection.)

## ACTIVITY

3

.....

Read the selection again to trace the course of the historical development of human rights. Complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

## Part Four

## ACTIVITY

1

.....

Read the section assigned to your group, and then, as a group, choose four unfamiliar vocabulary items that are important for understanding the reading. Find the dictionary definition that corresponds to the word's usage in the sentence. Complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

### From Declaration of Rights

by Percy Bysshe Shelley – 1792-1822

- 1- Government has no rights; it is a delegation from several individuals for the purpose of securing their own. It is therefore just only so far as it exists by their consent, useful only so far as it operates to their well-being.
- 2- If these individuals think that the form of government which they, or their forefathers, constituted is ill adapted to produce their happiness, they have a right to change it.
- 3- Government is devised for the security of rights. The rights of man are liberty and an equal participation of the commonage of nature.

- 18- Man has no right to kill his brother; it is no excuse that he does so in uniform. He only adds the infamy of servitude to the crime of murder.
- 19- Man, whatever be his country, has the same rights in one place as another, the rights of universal citizenship.
- 20- The government of a country ought to be perfectly indifferent to every opinion. Religious differences, the bloodiest and most rancorous of all, spring from partiality.
- 21- A delegation of individuals, for the purpose of securing their rights, can have no undelegated power of restraining the expression of their opinion.
- 22- Belief is involuntary; nothing involuntary is meritorious or reprehensible. A man ought not to be considered worse or better for his belief.
- 23- If a person's religious ideas correspond not with your own, love him nevertheless. How different would yours have been, had the chance of birth placed you in Tartary or India!
- 24- No man has a right to be respected for any other possessions but those of virtue and talents. Titles are tinsel, power a corruptor, glory a bubble, and excessive wealth a libel on its possessor.
- 25- No man has a right to monopolize more than he can enjoy; what the rich give to the poor, whilst millions are starving, is not a perfect favor, but an imperfect right.
- 26- Every man has a right to a certain degree of leisure and liberty, because it is his duty to attain a certain degree of knowledge. He may, before he ought.

## ACTIVITY



.....

- A- Write the comprehension questions you wrote (Exercise 5, item B) on the board. Then read your summary of the paragraphs assigned to you. Ask your classmates to answer the questions based on the information given in the summary.
- B- Write your answers to the questions prepared by other groups.

## ACTIVITY



.....

- A- Scan "Declaration of Rights" to check your answers to the different questions written by your classmates.
- B- Tell the different groups whether you were able to answer the questions (they wrote) based on their summaries, or whether the summaries did not accurately reflect the content or emphasis of the original.

- All citizens are equal in the eyes of the law. Thus, anyone has the right to hold a position or job, in the merit of his qualifications.
- None should be accused, arrested, or jailed except in cases specified in the legislation and according to procedures explained in it.
- The right of ownership is sacred; no one can take it away unless public interest is in danger of being compromised and when the need for such measures is legally justified, in which case the owner has the right to be fairly compensated.
- Society has the right to hold each public servant accountable for his conduct while in office.
- No one should be persecuted for his beliefs - - be it religious or otherwise - - on condition that the public declaration of such beliefs should not threaten public security, which is protected by the law.
- The free exchange of ideas, views, and opinions is one of the most valuable human rights. Thus, every citizen has the right to speak, write and publish freely, keeping in mind that he will be held responsible for any abuse of this freedom as dictated by the law.
- One of the principles of the revolution is that authority be given to the nation, and its motto is liberty, fraternity and equality.

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On the international level, nowadays, we are faced with two choices: either life and the flourishing of human rights, or death and decay. The only course to take is that of democracy, for in the shade of democracy flourish the rights of citizens and their freedom, rights which are vital for development and success in every aspect of our lives. Thus, what we, the people, need to do is to actively participate in specific daily activities on a democratic basis: free discussions to communicate with and convince each other, self-education and learning, and decisions taken according to the will of the majority.

## ACTIVITY



.....

Read "The Development of Human Rights" again, and complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

## Assignment:

.....

Find the United Nations Charter of Human Rights (which is a relatively recent document) and compare it to the summary of the Declaration of Human Rights (1789) which appears in the selection. Write a comparison / contrast essay of the contents of the two documents, focusing on the applicability of some of the ideas to modern societies.

- 
- 4- As the benefit of the governed is, or ought to be, the origin of government, no men can have any authority that does not expressly emanate from their will.
  - 5- All have a right to an equal share in the benefits and burdens of government. Any disabilities for opinion imply by their existence barefaced tyranny on the side of government, ignorant slavishness on the side of the governed.
  - 6- The rights of man in the present state of society are only to be secured by some degree of coercion to be exercised on their violator. The sufferer has a right that the degree of coercion employed be as slight as possible.
  - 7- It may be considered as a plain proof of the hollowness of any proposition, if power be used to enforce instead of reason to persuade its admission. Government is never supported by fraud until it cannot be supported by reason.
  - 8- No man has a right to disturb the public peace by personally resisting the execution of a law however bad. He ought to acquiesce, using at the same time the utmost powers of his reason to promote its repeal.
  - 9- A man must have a right to act in a certain manner before it can be his duty. He may, before he ought.
  - 10- A man has a right to think as his reason directs; it is a duty he owes to himself to think with freedom, that he may act from conviction.
  - 11- A man has a right to unrestricted liberty of discussion; falsehood is a scorpion that will sting itself to death.
  - 12- A man has not only a right to express his thoughts, but it is his duty to do so.
  - 13- No law has a right to discourage the practice of truth. A man ought to speak the truth on every occasion; a duty can never be criminal; what is not criminal cannot be injurious.
  - 14- Law cannot make what is in its nature virtuous or innocent to be criminal, any more than it can make what is criminal to be innocent. Government cannot make a law; it can only pronounce that which was the law before its organization – viz, the moral result of the imperishable relations of things.
  - 15- The present generation cannot bind their posterity. The few cannot promise for the many.
  - 16- No man has a right to do an evil thing that good may come.
  - 17- Expediency is inadmissible in morals. Politics are only sound when conducted on principles of morality. They are, in fact, the morals of nations.



## Part Three

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

A- Read the following general statements and say aloud whether each is true or false according to "The Development of Human Rights". Give at least one reason for your answer.

a- Poor people were not allowed to have their own occupations during the time of the Pharaohs.

b- Before the Eighteenth Century, everyone used to think that the common people were there to serve the nobility.

c- People have inborn rights to which they are entitled regardless of race, class or sex.

d- People are free to express ideas and opinions regardless of their effect on other people.

e- Democracy cannot ensure the implementation of human rights.

B- Read the key words which your teacher wrote on the board for each of the generalizations you have just reviewed.

## Part Five

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

In your groups, review the three selections you have on human rights i.e., "The Development of Human Rights", "The UN Charter of Human Rights" and "Declaration of Rights." Find out what is common or different in the three. Complete Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Compare your answers to Exercise 6 with those of another group. Discuss the discrepancies in the answers until you reach some consensus.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Use the information you recorded in Exercise 6 and the comparison between "The Development of Human Rights" and "The UN Charter of Human Rights" to write a group outline for a synthesis of the three selections. Share your outline with the class.

### Assignment:

.....

Use the outline you wrote in class to write a synthesis of the three selections.

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## Part Six

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Read the selection entitled "It's Your Business," and answer the questions in Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

### It's Your Business

by Randy Fitzgerald

Vincent Cummins felt he was on the verge of victory. This was America, the land of free enterprise, and Cummins, 46, who had emigrated from Barbados some 25 years before, was eager to start a new business. His idea: a van service in Brooklyn, N.Y., that would employ 80 people and serve low-income neighborhoods.

ACTIVITY

3

Walter E. Williams says that arbitrary regulations discriminate against "outsiders, late-comers and the resourceless". Who are these? Do you agree or disagree with such a statement? Write a short argumentative essay, and support it from the selection and from your general knowledge.

## Part Seven

ACTIVITY

1

- A- Pretend you are the attorney of either Cummins, Rasheed or Connell. In your group, prepare your defense of this case. Try to point out the basic human rights which your client is deprived of (consulting the previous selections on human rights). Also indicate the economic and social benefits that will follow as a result of licensing your client's business.
- B- Write a complete scenario for the government officials and for the defense. Try to imagine the exchange which might take place in the hearing room.
- C- Give each member of your group a role to play.

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ACTIVITY

2

Act out the court hearing in front of your classmates.

### Assignment:

Two of the selections in this chapter make specific recommendations on how to protect human rights and eliminate discrimination. Raif Khoury proposes democracy as the only sure solution. Randy Fitzgerald suggests deregulation for the problem of bureaucracy, which ideally should not exist in a democracy (though it does sometimes). Research two or more of the democratic systems that exist nowadays and discuss their different economic systems, focusing on the role of bureaucracy as Weber sees it. Write a report on your findings.

Goldsmith's first major target for deregulation was taxi service. Indianapolis had a ceiling of only 392 taxi permits. Regulation had gone so awry that you could rent a stretch limousine to go to the airport for half the cost of taking a cab.

Goldsmith appointed a Regulatory Study Commission, which recommended eliminating the ceiling on taxi licenses. Five months after the proposal was approved in May 1994, cab fares had decreased, thanks to 29 new taxi companies, most owned by minorities and women.

In response to other commission findings, many more regulations were abolished as frivolous or absurd. Eliminated permits included those for pigeon eradicators and drive-in movie theaters.

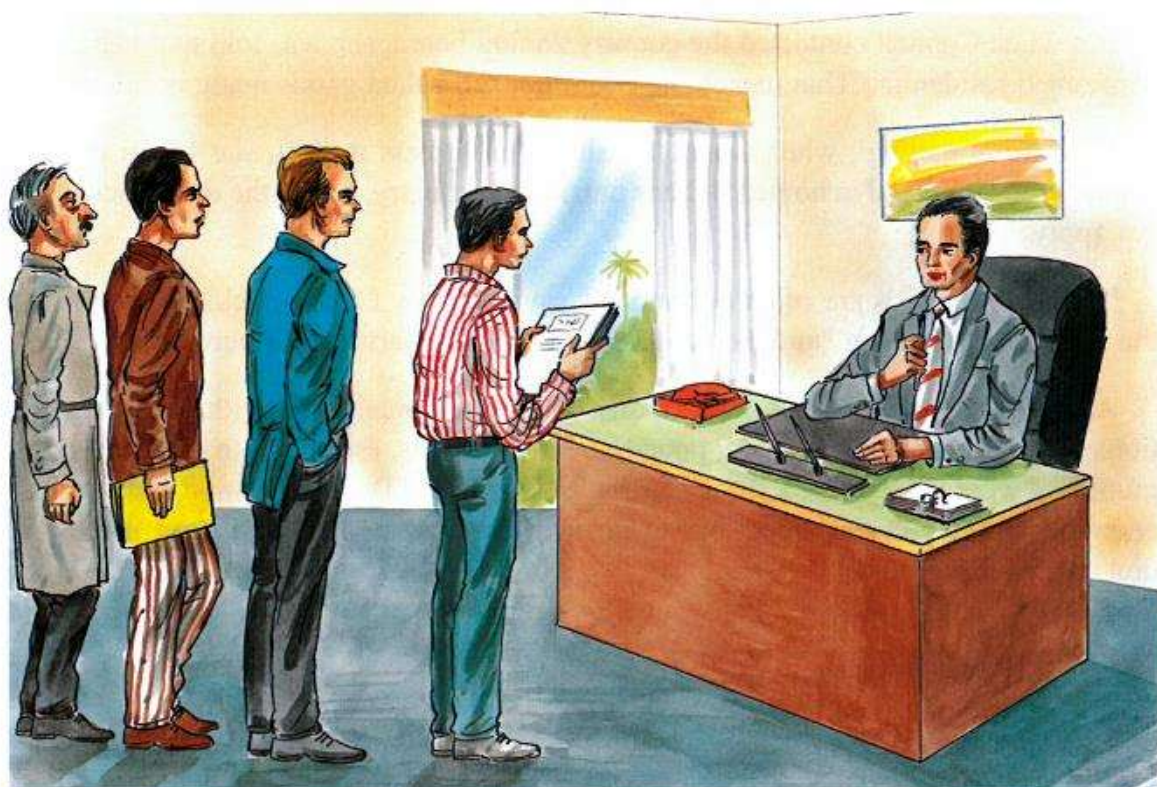
Few other cities have summoned the political will for such far-reaching deregulation. But recent welfare reforms mean that our cities need more entrepreneurs to create jobs. Mellor of the Institute for Justice concludes. "Surely government can find a way to give everyone a chance to earn a share of the American Dream".

## ACTIVITY

2

62

Read the selection again to check the evidence given and complete Exercise 8 in your Workbook.



---

"Few of these regulations have anything to do with health and safety," says William H. Mellor, president of the Institute for Justice, a public-interest law firm in Washington, D.C. "They insulate monopolies from healthy competition that would lower costs to consumers."

Arbitrary regulations<sup>1</sup>, says George Mason University economist Walter E. Williams, discriminate against "outsiders, latecomers and the resourceless."

The Braideie in San Diego specialized in African hairstyling, such as braiding and cornrowing. Employees never cut or styled hair using chemicals—procedures that the state regulates on public-safety grounds.

Nevertheless, in October 1996, a California State inspector arrived at the salon unannounced and told co-owner Ali Rasheed that hairbraiding required a state license. Salon employees would have to attend cosmetology school, at a cost of up to \$7000, where they would have to learn procedures such as eyebrow arching—but none of the braiding techniques the salon actually used.

Rasheed, 57, and his partners are challenging California's cosmetology law in federal court. "We don't object to standards for public health and safety," he says. "But these licenses are about government over-regulation and control."

Anyone wishing to start a business can also be foiled by arbitrary zoning restrictions. Consider the case of Thelma Connell of Charlotte, N.C. After retiring as a dental assistant, Connell decided in 1996 to supplement her Social Security benefits by selling home-baked poundcakes and peach cobbles at a nearby farmers market.

But when Connell contacted the country zoning board, she was told that her house was zoned residential. That meant she could not sell baked goods made in her home.

Even more galling<sup>2</sup>, when Connell visited the farmers market, she found on sale baked goods prepared in home kitchens outside the country, where the ordinance<sup>3</sup> does not apply.

"Zoning standards are often outmoded," says attorney Clint Bolick, co-founder of the Institute for Justice, "and the process for obtaining variances is cumbersome."

After becoming mayor of Indianapolis in 1992, Stephen Goldsmith found regulations to be so onerous<sup>4</sup> that many potential entrepreneurs, especially in minority communities, were discouraged from starting a business. "Denying opportunity is bad enough," Goldsmith declared, "but to do it to the very people who need it most is downright shameful."

---

1- not done according to a plan or system.

2- annoying.

3- official rule or order.

4- difficult or unpleasant.

For more than two years he had navigated the city's regulatory maze<sup>1</sup>, spending \$40,000 on legal and other fees to obtain approval for his business. Backed by 768 statements of support, Cummins's application was accepted by the Taxi and Limousine Commission. Now the application was sent before the City Council's transportation committee.

But the hearing<sup>2</sup> room was packed with city bus drivers from the Transport Workers Union, which opposed Cummins's van service. By an 8-0 vote, the committee rejected Cummins's application. Declared Councilman Archie Spigner, "I plead guilty" to protecting union jobs.



It took an extended political fight by Mayor Rudolph Giuliani for the council to relent. The final compromise allows Cummins to run a van service—though with half the vehicles he requested.

From coast to coast, would-be entrepreneurs<sup>3</sup> are blocked by thousands of regulations, usually on the pretext of protecting public health and safety. The 130-page *New York City Business License and Permit Reference Guide*, for instance, provides information on obtaining over 110 different licenses. Want to repair VCRs or operate a parking lot? You need a city license. In San Antonio, repairing or upholstering furniture in the home is prohibited. Detroit will not permit vendors to sell any hot food except hot dogs and sausages. In San Diego, shoeshiners are banned from public areas.

1- a system of passages which is difficult to follow because many of these passages lead nowhere.

2- an official meeting which is arranged in order to collect facts about a problem, event, etc...

3- persons who set up business deals to make a profit.



## Gender Issues



*"Should you really open your eyes and see,  
you would hold your image in all images.  
And should you open your ears and listen, you  
would hear your own voice in all voices."*

**Kahlil Gibran**

UNIT FOUR

## ACTIVITY

3

.....

Write 1-3 paragraphs in which you react to the language, tone and theme of the poem.

## Part Three

## ACTIVITY

1

.....

Skim the poem and think of a similar situation which applies to your life. Do you find yourself or have you ever found yourself in a situation where you work hard and your work is not recognized by your parents / teachers / friends, etc? Narrate your experience to your classmates. Listen to what they have to tell you.

## ACTIVITY

2

.....

- A. Compose a short poem that translates a strong feeling or emotion you have experienced into words.
- B. Share your poem with the class. Listen to other poems and exchange ideas and suggestions for change. Refer to the guidelines in Exercise 2 in your Workbook to help you give useful feedback.

## Part Four

## ACTIVITY

1

.....

- A. Read the following story. Then prepare a list of tasks you usually perform for the family similar to the one the boy in the story has prepared. If you were to apply the barter\* system, what service would you require in return for each of the tasks you perform. Complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

---

\* trade by exchange of commodities.

## Part One

### ACTIVITY

1

Read the poem silently. Then write down any words, images or thoughts that come to mind. Share these with a partner.

### Occupation: Housewife



"What do you do?"

- "Nothing,  
I'm just a housewife."

"What do you do as a housewife?"

- "Nothing,  
I have two children,  
so I market,  
cook three meals a day,  
clean, do the wash, mend,  
dust, vacuum,  
take the children  
to school, the dentist, music lessons,  
buy them shoes,  
bandage a knee,  
repair a bike,  
pay bills,  
put away toys,  
read stories,  
market,  
cook three meals a day,  
clean, do the wash, mend,  
dust, vacuum.  
Nothing."



### ACTIVITY

2

- Scan the poem to list the different tasks a mother does. Complete Exercise 1 in your Workbook.
- Compare the two lists and think how similar / different your mother's work is to/from the mother's work in the poem. Does your mother, for example, cook three meals a day? Take the children to school? Pay the bills? If not, explain why, in your opinion, your mother does not do certain tasks mentioned in the

poem. Also explain why she does other tasks not mentioned in the poem. Share your ideas with a partner.

- C. Review the lists in Exercise 1 in your Workbook, and think how important a mother's work is to the family: Emotionally, psychologically, socially, and economically. Justify your opinion to your partner.
- D. The author mentions a number of tasks a housewife / mother does. Why, then, does she end the poem with the word 'nothing'? What does she really mean by it? Are you satisfied with the ending of the poem? Exchange views with your partner.

### ACTIVITY .....

With your partner, write a different (maybe more direct) ending to this poem. Discuss whether the ending changes the intended message.

## Part Two

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### ACTIVITY .....

Read your ending of the poem to your classmates and explain to them why you chose this new and different closing. Does your ending convey the same message the author meant to convey? How? If not, why not?

### ACTIVITY .....

Discuss the following with your group. Then share your answers with the class.

- A. Identify the words that carry a negative meaning. Pay special attention to the repetition of the word 'nothing'.
- B. The poem is sandwiched between two 'nothings'. Do you find this significant? Is this technique an effective way of conveying a certain message?
- C. Many would argue that the poem is more effective because it is written in a concise and economical manner. The author uses very few words but gets right to the point. Do you agree or disagree? Support your answer by citing examples from the poem.
- D. Examine the language and explain how it influences the tone.
- E. What is the theme of the poem?

As you carry the suitcases  
 I check in at the counter  
 You figure our taxes  
 I decide on our budget  
 You vacuum  
 I dust  
 You turn the mattress over  
 I water the plants  
 You chop the onions  
 I add the spices  
 You go marketing . . .  
 but with my shopping list  
 You buy me books  
 I buy you ties  
 You know how to cure the ills of the world  
 I know how to cure your ills  
 You know what the children ought to do  
 I know how they are  
 You know about driving in the snow  
 I know you should wear a scarf  
 You show me how much you love me  
 I tell it to you  
 I could not do well what you do so well  
 nor could you do what I do  
 I like me as me  
 and you as you.

- B. Discuss with your group the similarities and differences in the three selections with regard to how each of them presents the role of a woman. Which selection/s portray/s a woman as more giving than receiving? Where is a woman depicted as a victim? In which selection is the woman more content or happier? Support your answers with specific references to the three selections.

## *Assignment:*

Write a short essay in which you examine a woman's image and role as portrayed in the three selections you have read so far. Indicate which one you prefer and why.

---

## Part Five

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

With your group discuss the endings of "Occupation: Housewife" and "No Charge". The first ends with the word "nothing", leaving the interpretation entirely to the imagination of the reader. The ending of the second, on the other hand, is more concrete, for the boy responds directly by saying "PAID IN FULL". Which of the two endings do you consider to be more effective?

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

A. "Patterns" presents a different perspective regarding the role of men and women and their relationship to each other. Read the poem and think about how the theme differs from the other two selections you have previously read in this chapter.

### Patterns

71

Instead of minimizing our differences,  
let us maximize them  
Instead of denying that you are better at this  
and I am better at that,  
let us take full advantage of our special skills  
and recognize the weaknesses  
in order either to work on them  
or turn to what we do best  
It is OK with me  
that most men have better spatial skills  
and that most women are better at verbal skills  
I can accept that most men are more concerned with objects  
and most women with people  
That boys excel at gross motor coordination  
and girls at manual dexterity  
That males are good at problem-solving  
and females process information faster  
I like our differences!  
As you shovel the driveway  
I fix you hot soup  
As you drive at night  
I keep you awake

## No Charge

by M. Adams

Our little boy came up to his mother in the kitchen one evening while she was fixing supper, and he handed her a piece of paper that he had been writing on. After his mom dried her hands on an apron, she read it, and this is what it said:

|                                                        |         |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| For cutting the grass                                  | \$ 5.00 |
| For cleaning up my room this week                      | \$ 1.00 |
| For going to the store for you                         | .50     |
| Baby sitting my kid brother while<br>you went shopping | .25     |
| Taking out the garbage                                 | \$ 1.00 |
| For getting a good report card                         | \$ 5.00 |
| For cleaning up and raking the yard                    | \$ 2.00 |
| Total owed:                                            | \$14.75 |

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Well, I'll tell you, his mother looked at him standing there expectantly, and boy, could I see the memories flashing through her mind. So she picked up the pen, turned over the paper he'd written on, and this is what she wrote:

For the nine months I carried you while you were growing inside me, No Charge.

For all the nights that I've sat up with you, doctored and prayed for you, No Charge.

For all the trying times, and all the tears that you've caused through the years, there's No Charge.

When you add it all up, the cost of my love is No Charge.

For all the nights that were filled with dread, and for the worries I knew were ahead, No Charge.

For the toys, food, clothes, and even wiping your nose, there's No Charge, Son.

And when you add it all up, the full cost of real love is No Charge.

Well, friends, when our son finished reading what his mother had written, there were great big old tears in his eyes, and he looked straight up at his mother and said, "Mom, I sure do love you." And then he took the pen and in great big letters he wrote. "PAID IN FULL."

- B. Look at the list of tasks your mother performs for the family (which you listed in Exercise 1) and compare it to the list of tasks you perform. Estimate the overall financial and moral value of each list. Which one, in your opinion, is worth more? Why?

78

## ACTIVITY

2

Study with your group the list which the boy in the story presents to his mother and the list which the mother presents to her boy. How can you describe the nature of the tasks in each list. Complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY

3

Read the story again and discuss the following with your group:

- What is the theme of the story?
- What does the boy learn from this experience and how does his awareness help him mature?
- The story ends in what is called 'a reversal of situation'. Explain how the situation is reversed.

## Part Six

### ACTIVITY 1 .....

Discuss the following questions in you groups; then share the answers with the class.

- A. Are women equal to men in our society?
- B. Do you know what domestic violence is?
- C. Have you read or heard of any violent domestic incident? What is it?

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

Which behaviors do you label as violent. Complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 3 .....

Read the selection, and answer the questions in Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

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## Domestic Violence

### What is domestic violence?

Domestic violence is the abuse, mental or physical, of one person by another person with whom the abused has a significant and intimate relationship. Domestic violence can occur in relationships even if the couple do not live together.

### What is spousal abuse?

Spousal abuse is harmful behavior between two adults who are in an intimate, sexual, usually cohabiting relationship. The abuse can take many forms. It, nonetheless, should be known that all forms of abusive behaviors are situations in which one human being is trying to control or have power over another person. These behaviors can include, but are not limited to, verbal abuse such as actual threats of harm to the woman or someone else, intimidation such as angry looks or raised voice, emotional abuse such as extreme jealousy, isolation such as keeping a woman from making any friends, physical abuse such as pushing or hitting, sexual abuse such as rape, economic abuse such as preventing her from getting a job, and denial of rights such as depriving her from any privacy.

## Part One

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Interview your partner and report the results. Complete Exercise 1 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

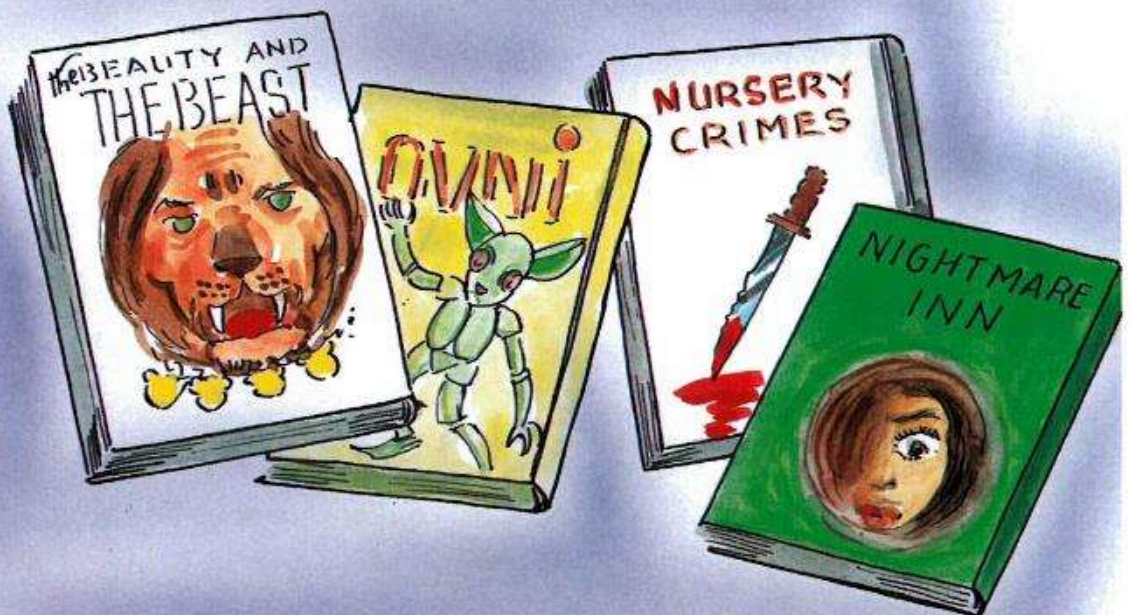
2

.....

Read the title and look at the pictures. Then free-write for five minutes about your impressions.

## Shriek! The Horrible World of Children's Books

by Peter Finn



### Simple and primary action to help battered women

As an individual you can

- acknowledge the positive things they do.
- be positive when correcting them.
- listen respectfully when they are telling you something.
- believe what they say and take it seriously.
- allow them to make decisions appropriate to their ability.
- encourage them to express their likes and dislikes.



As a community member you can

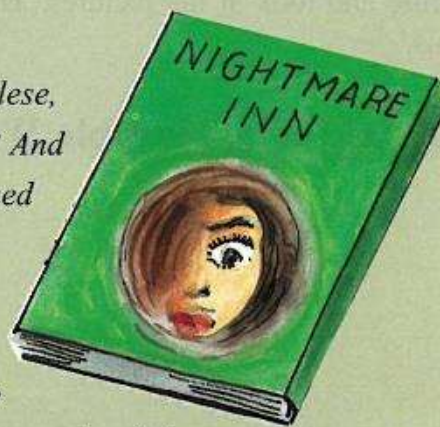
- support gender equality in the workplace and elsewhere.
- support programs that offer opportunities for learning communication assertiveness.
- support the provision of safe places for abused women and their children.
- support organization in the battle to create a safe legal system for battered women.

## *Social and Recreational Issues: The Family, Youth Issues and the Media*

*"And tell me, people of Orphalese,  
what have you in these houses? And  
what is it you guard with fastened  
doors?"*

*Have you peace, the quiet urge  
that reveals your power?*

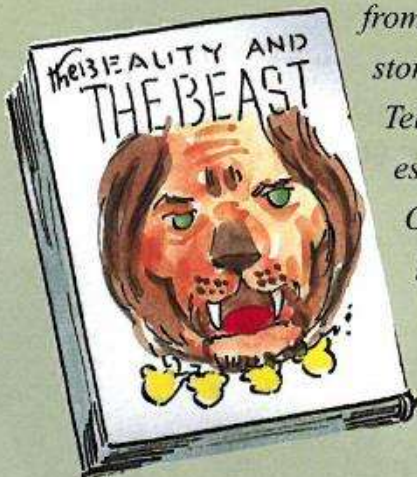
*Have you remembrances, the  
glimmering arches that span the summits of the  
mind?*



*Have you beauty, that leads the heart  
from things fashioned of wood and  
stone to the holy mountain?*

*Tell me, have you these in your hous-  
es?*

*Or have you only comfort, and the  
lust for comfort, that stealthy thing  
that enters the house a guest, and  
then becomes a host, and then a  
master?"*



**Kahlil Gibran**

During the seventies, many women believed that if women were simply admitted to full participation in decision-making, the world would be a better place. This no longer seems as simple as it once did. We can see now that those women who succeed in adopting traditional male models leave the world very much as it is, and so we celebrate the success of women who participate on male terms with a certain ambivalence. We no longer see femaleness as guaranteeing a higher degree of caring; rather, we are concerned with the question of how the necessary combinations of caring will be made and how the old divisions of labor, constructed in terms of separate spheres of activity, will be redistributed across genders.

There has been a tendency to look ahead to some sort of utopia in which women will no longer be torn by the conflicting claims and desires that so often turn their pathways into zigzags or, at best, spirals. And yet these very conflicting claims are affirmations of value. It would be easier to live with a greater clarity of ambition, to follow goals that beckon toward a single upward progression. But perhaps what women have to offer in the world today, in which men and women both must learn to deal with new orders of complexity and rapid change, lies in the very rejection of forced choices: work or home, strength or vulnerability, caring or competition, trust or questioning. Truth may not be so simple.

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## ACTIVITY 3 .....

Skim the selection and locate words related to art and music. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY 4 .....

Read the selection and answer the following questions in Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

## *Assignment:* .....

Research the life of one famous woman who challenged conventions to actualize her potential. Write a short paper in which you report your findings.

## ACTIVITY

4

Choose, with your group, a group of people whom you believe should be educated about domestic violence. Design a brochure, having this group as your target audience, and include in it what you think is the most important and relevant information on domestic violence. Brainstorm in class and finish your work at home. Include visuals and give your brochure an attractive design.

### *Assignment:*

Continue your work on the brochure. Get more information to use in the brochure on domestic violence from the library or visit certain web sites on the internet such as the home page of the Lebanese Council to Resist Violence Against Women (address: [www.lebanesewomen.org](http://www.lebanesewomen.org))

## Part Seven

## ACTIVITY

1

Name three women who have managed to make a difference in society. Explain what each was able to achieve and what personal characteristics helped them succeed. Share this with the class.

## ACTIVITY

2

Look up the work "compose", which is a key word in "Enriching the Earth", in the dictionary and record its different meanings. Read the selection and decide which of the various meanings would best apply in the selection and why. Discuss with a partner.

### **Enriching the Earth**

by Mary Catherine Bateson

WOMEN TODAY, trying to compose lives that will honor all their commitments and still express all their potentials with a certain unitary grace, do not have an easy task. It is important, however, to see that, in finding a personal path among the discontinuities and moral ambiguities they face, they are performing a creative synthesis with a value that goes beyond the merely personal. We feel lonely sometimes because each composition is unique, but gradually we are becoming aware of the balances and harmonies that must inform all such compositions. Individual improvisations can sometimes be shared as models of possibility for men and women in the future.

## Part Two

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Some quotations in the selection present a favorable point of view about children's books, while others present an unfavorable one. Examine the quotations and complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

- A- Discuss in your group which of the two categories you find more convincing and why?
- B- Write down your conclusions based on the discussion. Try to add examples from your own readings.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

- A- Take a few minutes to think about what scares you most.
- B- Write a short horror story related to your experience. Try to make it funny. Share your story with the class.

## Part Three

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Prepare for a debate:

- A- Side with one of the following statements:
  - a- In the future, I will allow my children to read stories that contain descriptions of violence.
  - b- In the future, I will not allow my children to read stories that contain vivid descriptions of violence.
- B- Sit with the group who shares your opinion i.e., who sides with the statement you chose.
- C- Think of the reasons for your decision. Prepare a comprehensive list with your group.
- D- Choose a spokesperson for your group and help him/her prepare the main logical argument which supports your group's view.

---

**ACTIVITY****2**

.....

Debate the issue:

- A- The spokesperson of the group in favor of the first statement (i) gives an uninterrupted speech, presenting his/her group's view and main argument.
- B- The spokesperson of the group in favor of the second statement (ii) gives an uninterrupted speech, presenting his/her group's view and main argument. Meanwhile, the opposing group can take notes during the speeches to prepare what to say.
- C- After the speeches, the other students can take turns discussing their arguments.
- D- The two spokespersons sum up the main arguments.

**ACTIVITY****3**

.....

Write an essay in which you defend your point of view.

**Part Four****83****ACTIVITY****1**

.....

You will listen to a selection entitled "Whose School Is It, Anyway?" Try to predict its content from the title.

**ACTIVITY****2**

.....

Write a dictogloss

- A- Listen to your teacher as he/she reads the selection for the first time.
- B- Take down as many words and phrases as you can while the teacher is reading the selection for the second time.
- C- Work with your group to reconstruct the selection. Pool your ideas and borrow words from each other. Try to come up with a version of the selection that is as close as possible to the original (but not necessarily the same).
- D- Share your dictogloss (i.e., your written version of the selection) with the class and get their feedback on how close they think it is to the original, which they have listened to.
- E- Compare your dictogloss with the original which is printed below.

Children apparently like the hair-raising thrill of it all.

"The books catch you in the very beginning, and you have to keep reading," said Caitlin Trost, 12. "Other books, like the ones we read in class are so boring. No monster pops out. No one dies."

Horror writers and some specialists on children's literature argue that the books allow youngsters to exercise their fears in a safe way. "I think they find some catharsis in the books," said L.J. Smith, a former schoolteacher and the author of *The Vampire Diaries*, *The Secret Circle* and the upcoming *Night World Series*. "Good nearly always wins; these are their myths."

Others, however, argue that today's tales of horror are too shallow, and wantonly violent to deserve such a redeeming analysis. In a blistering attack on the genre, Diana West, writing in the conservative magazine *Weekly Standard*, said modern horror is little better than pornography.

"As graphic, horrific and exciting as Edgar Allen Poe's stories may be, for example, the act of reading them requires a mental engagement with language, with character, with the author's interpretation of events that transforms the action and elevates it above the cheap thrills of a rap sheet," West wrote. "But in shock fiction, a raw catalogue of horrors and grotesqueries is used — not interpreted, not stylized, not in any way transformed by a writer for good or bad — to charge the nerve endings of young readers."

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Work with a partner. Read the first two paragraphs and select words that describe acts of violence. Then discuss the following:

- A- Why, in your opinion, does the author include such strong vocabulary?
- B- Does he do this to emphasize a certain point of view?
- B- What, in your opinion, is his point of view?

### ACTIVITY

4

.....

Read the selection and summarize the author's main argument.

---

Something wicked has this way come, and the world in children's fiction has become a very menacing place. Children kill and are killed. Method is everything; people are decapitated, incinerated, stabbed, slashed, dismembered, impaled and strangled in battles with the supernatural or plain old evil.

Blood is everywhere. It trickles, flows, gushes, spurts, spatters and even explodes across pages that lurch from one shuddering moment to the next.

And youngsters can't get enough of it.

"The books kids like are horrible and scary," said Chris Diaz, 12, of Fairfax County, Virginia, a horror fan. "I guess it's the times we live in, with all the killing and everything."

"There's a lot of killing and stabbing," said Aaron Shin, 11, of Silver Spring, Maryland. "It's kind of cool and intense. But it's not real life, so it's only scary sometimes."

Horror fiction is marauding across the bookshelves of 6 to 14-years-olds. The young-adult sections in public libraries and bookstores are dominated by novels with lurid covers of wide-eyed teenagers stalked by heinous forces.

"We can't keep them on the shelves because they're so popular," said Lize Long, children's librarian at the Reston Regional Library in Virginia. "They come in, and they're immediately checked out. Some of the books are in tatters; they have been read so often."

In Publishers Weekly's young-adult paperback best-seller list for 1995, 17 of the top 20 books were horror titles, all by R.L. Stine, who publishes as many as two books a month. Stine has become a one-man industry, with 95 million books in print, but at least a half-dozen other authors of the genre have sold 200,000 to 300,000 copies of individual novels.

Any young-adult paperback that reaches sales of more than 50,000 is considered a commercial success, and publishers view the current popularity of horror books as an unprecedented industry phenomenon.

"There have been genre hits before, like *Sweet Valley High*, but never anything this big," said Nancy Pines, associate publisher of young-adult fiction at Archway Paperbacks. "And I think the reason for that is that horror crosses the gender line. Boys and girls are reading these books in equal numbers."

The novels, with titles such as *Nightmare Inn*, *Nursery Crimes* and *Horror High*, revel in gore in a way unimaginable to onetime readers of Nancy Drew or the Hardy boys.

Many parents, while uneasy about the books' content, console themselves with the thought that their children are avid readers. Others, echoing concerns about the level of violence in other forms of popular culture, question whether the literature has any value. "It upsets me that the old-fashioned books are not as popular, but as long as she's reading....," said Patti Cancellier, of Rockville, Maryland, as her 12-year-old daughter, Sylvie, checked out a horror novel at the public library.

Most parents seem to view horror as a fad from which their children will graduate unscathed.

"Horror is a big thing in the house," said Debi Blum, of Herndon, West Virginia, whose 12-year-old, Sarah, is a fan. "I don't think it affects them. If they started doing bizarre things, maybe I'd start looking at the books."

Said Sarah: "They're realistic and interesting in a weird kind of way. It's like hearing on the news that someone was shot at 2 A.M."

Scary children's literature is nothing new, of course. Through the millennia, evil and virtue have struggled on the pages of fairy tales; Hansel and Gretel, after all, get tossed in an oven, only to escape and bake the witch.

The recent popularity of horror books for teenagers stems from young people's need to make sense of a world that has become more violent and fearful, some observers believe.

In the largely suburban and middle-class universe found in horror books, good almost always triumphs, albeit in the shadow of murderous death. Make-believe terror, in other-words, becomes an antidote to real-life horror.

"Sometimes I look at the bookshelves and wonder what kind of monster I created," said Christopher Pike, who began the explosive growth in modern children's horror in 1986, when he wrote *Chain Letter*, a runaway bestseller. "But in a violent book, I try to have a moral center. To have indiscriminate violence, to have no conscience in a young-adult book would be irresponsible."

For the youngest readers, horror stories mostly involve slimy creatures and malicious beings. But children quickly graduate from the absurdly monstrous to the homicidal. And in books such as *Monster*, *Fear Street*, *Nursery Crimes* and *Horror High*, which 8 to 15-year-olds read, human and ghostly violence is explicit.

"Sally never felt the sharp steel that ripped across her throat, and she never saw the fingers that dipped into the crimson puddle and scrawled the hateful message on the wall above her body," reads an excerpt from *Heartbreaker* in the Horror High series by Nicholas Adams.

## Part Six



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### ACTIVITY



.....

Read the story "Mr. Preble Gets Rid of his Wife" to understand the plot. Complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

### Mr. Preble Gets Rid of His wife

by James Thurber

Mr. Preble was a plump middle-aged lawyer in Scarsdale. He used to kid with his stenographer about running away with him. "Let's run away together," he would say, during a pause in dictation. "All righty," she would say.

One rainy Monday afternoon, Mr. Preble was more serious about it than usual.

"Let's run away together," said Mr. Preble. "All righty," said his stenographer. Mr. Preble jingled the keys in his pocket and looked out the window.

## Part Five

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Scan the selection "Whose School Is It, Anyway?" and identify some of the things parents do instead of their children. Complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Discuss the following in your group:

- A- According to the selection, why are college applications putting a strain on family relationships?
- B- Do you think it is ethical or correct for parents to become involved in preparing their children's college applications?
- C- Try to discuss the issue from the parents' point of view.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

- A- After you have identified the nature of the conflict between parents and children as presented in the selection and after you have looked at this conflict from both points of view, try to come up with creative solutions to resolve this serious conflict. List all the solutions you can think of.
- B- In your group, debate the various solutions mentioned until you reach group consensus on the best solution.
- C- Propose your group solution to the class and debate the different group solutions until you reach class consensus on the best one.

### Assignment:

.....

The selection "Whose School Is It, Anyway?" raises an important issue that centers on parents trying to control their children's future. Now that you are about to graduate from high school, are you experiencing similar problems? Write about your own experience or that of a friend.

"My wife would be glad to get rid of me," he said.

"Would she give you a divorce?" asked the stenographer.

"I don't suppose so," he said. The stenographer laughed.

"You'd have to get rid of your wife," she said.

Mr. Preble was unusually silent at dinner that night. About half an hour after coffee, he spoke without looking up from his paper.

"Let's go down in the cellar," Mr. Preble said to his wife.

"What for?" she said, not looking up from her book.

"Oh, I don't know," he said. "We never go down in the cellar any more. The way we used to."

"We never did go down in the cellar that I remember," said Mrs. Preble. "I could rest easy the balance of my life if I never went down in the cellar." Mr. Preble was silent for several minutes.

"Supposing I said it meant a whole lot to me," began Mr. Preble.

"What's come over you?" his wife demanded. "It's cold down there and there is absolutely nothing to do."

"We could pick up pieces of coal," said Mr. Preble. "We might get up some kind of a game with pieces of coal."

"I don't want to," said his wife. "Anyway, I'm reading."

"Listen," said Mr. Preble, rising and walking up and down. "Why won't you come down in the cellar? You can read down there, as far as that goes."

"There isn't a good enough light down there," she said, "and anyway, I'm not going to go down in the cellar. You may as well make up your mind to that."

"Gee whiz!" said Mr. Preble, kicking at the edge of a rug. "Other people's wives go down in the cellar. Why is it you never want to do anything? I come home worn out from the office and you won't even go down in the cellar with me. God knows it isn't very far—it isn't as if I was asking you to go to the movies or some place."

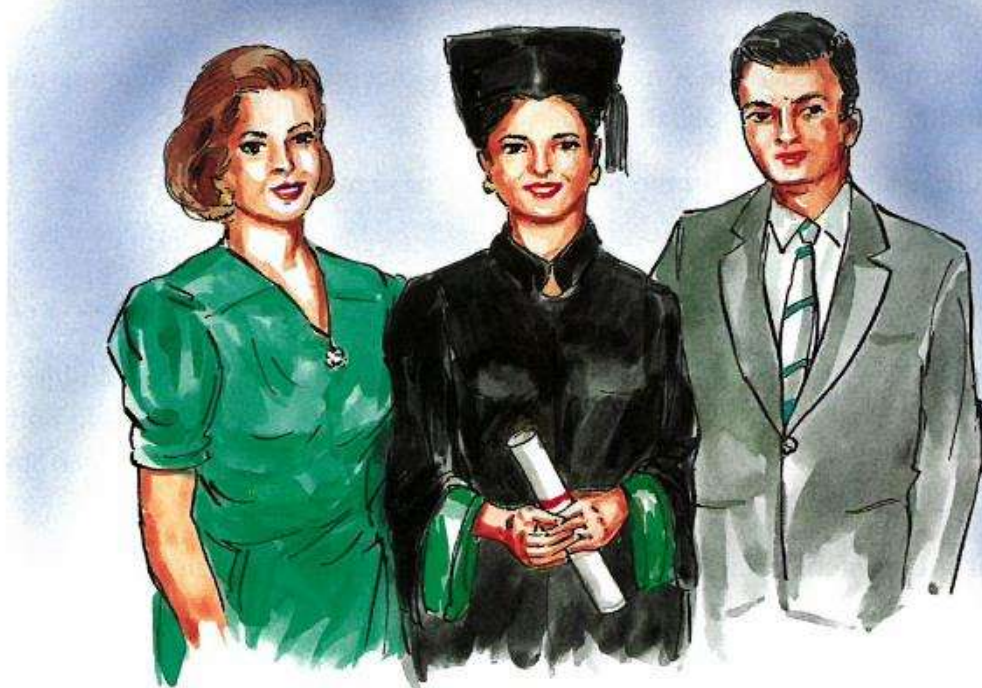
"I don't want to go!" shouted Mrs. Preble. Mr. Preble sat down on the edge of a davenport.

"All right, *all right*," he said. He picked up the newspaper again. "I wish you'd let me tell you more about it. It's - - kind of a surprise."

---

Institute, fewer than 10 percent of first-year students said a relative's wishes played an important part in their college choice.

One way parents can head off disagreements: avoid mentioning specific schools early on and, instead, get youngsters talking about the kinds of colleges they think they want to attend. "As soon as you're dealing with particular insinuations<sup>1</sup>, you're dealing much more with stereotypes and preconceptions," explains Laura Dean, former director of counseling at Manchester College in Indiana.



But some parents have a hard time holding back because their egos are at stake, particularly when it comes to acceptance at a school the parent favors. Too many parents come to believe that it is they, not their children, who are being judged. Observes Lynda Herring, a high school guidance counselor at Colorado's Kent Denver School: "It's really hard for parents to avoid feeling that their child's college acceptance in some way reflects on their own parenting."

---

1- hints which are unpleasant.

## Whose School Is It, Anyway?

by Jeff Archer and Lisa Hasday

Virginia Carey, dean of undergraduate admissions at Virginia's College of William and Mary, was wading<sup>1</sup> through applications a few years ago when she came upon a troubling postscript: At the end of a well-crafted essay, the applicant begged the school not to admit her. The student wrote that she had applied at the insistence of her parents and had no desire to attend the college.

The incident confirmed Carey's suspicion that college applications can put a significant strain on family relationships, especially when parent and child have differing opinions. Some parents get so wrapped up in the process that it becomes unclear who's actually applying. "One of the danger signs," says William Fitzsimmons, dean of admissions and financial aid at Harvard, "is when parents start talking about 'our' application."

The applicant's essay can be a particular problem. Parents often argue with their college-bound student over what the topic should be handled. Some go so far as to write the essay themselves. David Murray, former admissions dean at DePauw University in Indiana, recalls receiving identical essays from a brother and sister. The girl was applying as a transfer student, while the boy sought to enter the freshman class. By questioning the applicants, Murray discovered that the father had written the essay and had forgotten that both of his youngsters were applying to the same school. "This was the death knell<sup>2</sup> of their candidacy," recalls Murray. "Beyond the obvious ethical problems, the overly manipulative<sup>3</sup> parent only makes us question the strength of the student involved."

Then there are those parents who try to prompt their children during campus interviews or who leave notes on college applications apologizing for not having time to make more corrections. Patricia McDonough, a professor of education at the University of California-Los Angeles, says it's "a time when parents and children's relationships are pretty notorious for being at their worst." In a new book, *Choosing Colleges*, McDonough examines the experiences of 24 students and finds that the conflicts do not end with the admissions process: Many parents then try to steer their children toward enrolling in certain schools. "When I ask students if they had the power to be God for a day, what would they do, they say they'd tell their parents to stop asking them where they're going to college", she reports.

Parents, however, may be less influential than they think. In a 1995 survey of nearly 240,000 college freshmen by the UCLA-based Higher Education Research

1- spending a lot of time and effort reading.

2- the sound made by a bell rung slowly for a death.

3- to manage or influence by devious skills.

## Part Seven

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Based on the content of the selections in this chapter and on your general knowledge, describe relationships between different groups. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Choose one of the groups mentioned in Exercise 7 and imagine a humorous episode between the two parties in the group. Use extensive dialogue to relate this episode. Narrate indirectly what took place through the exchange of conversation between the people involved.

### Assignment:

.....

This chapter focuses on family and social issues, especially conflict between parents and children, husbands and wives, and the advocates of violence in children's recreational books and their critics. The main concern is, of course, how all this will affect children. Write an essay in which you summarize the different factors which could influence a young person's development in the home environment, at school, etc. Suggest solutions to the problems which could arise due to conflict between the parties involved.

"All right" said Mr. Preble. "I'll hurry."

"And shut that *door* behind you!" she screamed after him. "Where were you born - in a barn?"

### ACTIVITY



.....

Read the story and draw a character sketch of Mr. Preble. Complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Read the story and draw a character sketch of Mr. Preble's wife. Complete Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Discuss with your group:

- A- The author makes use of extensive dialogue to advance the plot and create tension. Identify specific instances in the dialogue where tension is created and the plot is set into motion (moves from one event to another) through the use of dialogue.
- B- Explain how the author uses humor in the story. Mention specific examples.
- C- In your opinion, is the author successful in his attempt to be humorous? Explain.
- D- What is the conflict between Mr. Preble and his wife?
- E- Do you think that Mr. Preble gets rid of his wife at the end of the story?
- F- In your opinion, is the conflict resolved i.e., is there closure at the end of the story? If so, how is the story resolved? If not, what might have happened at the end?
- G- Is the ending effective and why?
- H- What is the theme or purpose behind the story?
- I- Critics have argued that Thurber focuses on the on-going struggle for dominance between men and women. After reading this story, do you agree or disagree with this view? Explain.

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"Will you quit harping on that subject?" asked Mrs. Preble.

"Listen," said Mr. Preble, leaping to his feet. "I might as well tell you the truth instead of beating around the bush. I want to get rid of you so I can marry my stenographer. Is there anything especially wrong about that? People do it every day. Love is something you can't control."

"We've been all over that," said Mrs. Preble. "I'm not going to go all over that again."

"I just wanted you to know how things are," said Mr. Preble. "But you have to take everything so literally. Good Lord, do you suppose I really wanted to go down there and make up some silly game with pieces of coal?"

"I never believed that for a minute," said Mrs. Preble. "I knew all along you wanted to get me down there and bury me."

"You can say that now- - after I told you," said Mr. Preble. "But it would never have occurred to you if I hadn't."

"You didn't tell me; I got it out of you," said Mrs. Preble. "Anyway, I'm always two steps ahead of what you're thinking."

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"You're never within a mile of what I'm thinking," said Mr. Preble.

"Is that so? I knew you wanted to bury me the minute you set foot in this house tonight," Mrs. Preble held him with a glare.

"Now that's just plain damn exaggeration," said Mr. Preble, considerably annoyed. "You knew nothing of the sort. As a matter of fact, I never thought of it till just a few minutes ago."

"It was in the back of your mind," said Mrs. Preble. "I suppose this filing woman put you up to it."

"You needn't get sarcastic," said Mr. Preble. "I have plenty of people to file without having her file. She doesn't know anything about this. She isn't in on it. I was going to tell her you had gone to visit some friends and fell over a cliff. She wants me to get a divorce."

"That's a laugh," said Mrs. Preble. "*That's* a laugh. You may bury me, but you'll never get a divorce."

"She knows that! I told her that," said Mr. Preble. "I mean—I told her I'd never get a divorce."

"Oh, you probably told her about burying me, too," said Mrs. Preble.

## *Socio-economic Issues: Employment, Immigration, Living Standards, etc.*



*"Work is love made visible.  
And if you cannot work with love but only with dis-  
taste, it is better that you should leave your work  
and sit at the gate of the temple and take alms of  
those who work with joy"*

*Kahlil Gibran*

"That's not true," said Mr. Preble, with dignity. "That's between you and me. I was never going to tell a soul."

"You'd blab it to the whole world; don't tell me," said Mrs. Preble. "I know you." Mr. Preble puffed at his cigar. "I wish you were buried now and it was all over with," he said.

"Don't you suppose you would get caught, you crazy thing?" she said. "They always get caught. Why don't you go to bed? ? You're just getting yourself worked up over nothing."

"I'm not going to bed," said Mr. Preble. "I'm going to bury you in the cellar. I've got my mind made up to it. I don't know how I could make it any plainer."

"Listen," cried Mrs. Preble, throwing her book down, "Will you be satisfied and shut up if I go down in the cellar? Can I have a little peace if I go down in the cellar? Will you let me alone then?"

"Yes," said Mr. Preble. "But you spoil it by taking that attitude."

"Sure, sure, I always spoil everything. I stop reading right in the middle of a chapter. I'll never know how the story comes out—but that's nothing to you."

"Did I make you start reading the book?" asked Mr. Preble. He opened the cellar door. "Here, you go first."

"Burr," said Mrs. Preble, starting down the steps. "It's *cold* down here! You *would* think of this, at this time of year! Any other husband would have buried his wife in the summer."

"You can't arrange these things just whenever you want to," said Mr. Preble. "I didn't fall in love with this girl till late fall."

"Anybody else would have fallen in love with her long before that. She's been around for years. Why is it you always let other men get in ahead of you? Mercy, but it's dirty down here! What have you got there?"

"I was going to hit you over the head with this shovel," said Mr. Preble.

"You were, huh?" said Mrs. Preble. "Well, get that out of your mind. Do you want to leave a great big clue right here in the middle of everything where the first detective that comes snooping around will find it? Go out in the street and find some piece of iron or something - something that doesn't belong to you."

"Oh, all right," said Mr. Preble. "But there won't be any piece of iron in the street. Women always expect to pick up a piece of iron anywhere."

"If you look in the right place you'll find it," said Mrs. Preble. "And don't be gone long. Don't you dare stop in at the cigar store. I'm not going to stand down here in this cold cellar all night and freeze."

## Part One

### ACTIVITY



.....

Listen to the recording of the poem and try to identify the main ideas. Complete Exercise 1 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Listen to the poem again and identify key terms. Complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

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### ACTIVITY



.....

- A- Discuss the following in your group:
- a- Why do people move from their old communities into new ones? Numerate some of the reasons.
  - b- Who are these people usually? Indicate some of the groups of people who usually leave their old communities and move into new ones.
  - c- What are some of the problems these immigrant groups face? Do they face, for instance, psychological problems, financial problems, cultural problems, or discrimination? Explain.
- B- Listen to the poem again and try, in the light of what you have discussed with your group, to identify who the speaker is, who he/she is addressing and in what context. What is/are the major problem/s that the speaker faces? Support your interpretation with specific references to the poem.

### ACTIVITY



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Suppose the poem is written by a boy or girl your age who has recently moved into your neighborhood. Address this boy or girl in a letter in which you give him/her advice about his/her new life.

## ACTIVITY

2

.....

A- Discuss the following with your partner:

- a- What is the conflict in the story?
- b- Did the narrator give information which you found irrelevant to the conflict? (for example, the information about Mort's head wound).
- c- Could the narrator have left such information out, or was it absolutely necessary to include it?

Justify your answers.

B- Distinguish between relevant and irrelevant information. Work with your partner to complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY

3

.....

This is the story of a family who has recently arrived in California and is facing financial problems.

- A- Identify some of the terms in the story which refer to money and earning a living. Write them down in your copybook.
- B- The financial problems of this family are due to reasons stated or implied in the story. Read the story again to complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

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## ACTIVITY

4

.....

Write one or two paragraphs in which you analyze the reason why the family is suffering financially. Try to use the terms you identified in Activity 3-item A.

## Part Three

## ACTIVITY

1

.....

There is information in the story that hides certain implied attitudes. Try to infer the attitude that each statement implies in order to complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY

2

.....

At the end of the story, the narrator and Mort are considered heroes. Each in his own way "made the world a better place" because each believed in values which he applied

## Part Two

### ACTIVITY



A- Read the story and write a summary of its plot. Remember to focus on the main events and exclude the details.

### My \$ 325 Salvation

by Marvin J. Wolf

- 1- I stood on tiptoe and handed the card from my school's help-wanted board to the tall, ruddy-faced man behind the counter of Mort's Deli at Farmers Market in Los Angeles. He wore a starched chef's hat and a clean white apron. Even before I opened my mouth, he was frowning and shaking his head.
- 2- "This is a tough job for any high school kid," the man said. "I need somebody big and strong."
- 3- At 16, I looked younger and was barely five feet tall. "I worked last summer washing dishes in a boys camp," I said. "I'm not afraid of hot water, dirty dishes or heavy lifting."
- 4- "Really, we need someone bigger," he said. "You'll find something easier than this, kid."
- 5- It was September 1957, and my family had just arrived in California. Without seniority in the local union, my father, a sheet-metal worker, was lucky to get work



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circled the neighborhood, thinking furiously. Who might have \$325? Who would even consider lending me such a princely sum?

- 18- The only person I could think of was Mort. I drove back to his deli, rapped on the rear door, then waited until the window shade went up. I found myself staring down the barrel of an Army.45. "What do you want?" Mort growled, lowering the gun.
- 19- I stammered out my tale: the bald man, his foul cursing, the outrageous demand. "So could you possibly loan my father \$325?" I finished, realizing how absurd it sounded.
- 20- Mort's eyes bored holes in my face. His cheeks began purpling, and his lips quivered. Realizing he was still clutching the gun, I took a step backward. At that, he smiled. "I'm not going to shoot you," he said, placing the pistol on his tiny desk. Then he knelt, pried a worn red tile from the floor to reveal a safe, and began to twist the dial.
- 21- He counted the money twice and placed it in an old envelope. "This is \$325," he said. "When school is out, you'll work full time. I'll take back half your wages until it's repaid."
- 22- "Thank you," I said, trembling at this responsibility. "Do you want my father to sign something?"
- 23- He shook his head. "No, son. I'm betting on you."
- 24- I went in the back door like the lord of the manor, and Dad came rushing into the kitchen, the bald man on his heels. "Quick!" my father cried. "Drive the car away!"
- 25- I calmly handed the man the envelope. "Count it, give my father a receipt and get out of our house," I said, a speech I'd rehearsed all the way home.
- 26- That night I was a hero to my family. But the real hero was Mort Rubin, who not only saved us from certain penury, but also quietly raised my salary every month until, by summer, I was earning \$2.50 an hour, double the original wage.
- 27- I worked for Mort until I graduated two years later and joined the Army. We stayed in touch for many decades, but I lost track of him several years ago and don't even know if he's still alive.
- 28- But this I do know: Mort Rubin made the world a better place.

B- Compare your summary with your partner's. Did you include and exclude the same information?

two or three days a week. Our meager savings was gone, and as the oldest boy of what would soon be six children, I was the only one able to help. I'd applied at retail stores, but without local references shopkeepers were reluctant to let me handle cash.

- 6- "Tell you what," I said. "Let me work the rest of the week, and if you don't like the way I do the job, don't pay me."
- 7- The tall man stared at me, then nodded. "I'm Mort Rubin. What's your name?"
- 8- At Mort's, a river of soiled utensils, trays, pots and pans flowed into my sinks. I washed and rinsed and scoured. By the end of my first after-school shift, sharp pains were shooting up my legs from standing for hours without a break.
- 9- As closing time approached on Saturday, I was in agony. I also had no idea whether Mort would pay me. Near the end of the day he called me up front. "How much did that card at school say this job paid?" he asked.
- 10- "Dollar an hour," I murmured. "The minimum wage." I was willing to take less.
- 11- "That's not enough for someone who works as hard as you," Mort said. "You start at \$1.25."
- 12- Over the next few weeks I learned a lot about Mort. A few years older than my dad, he was from Chicago and had a daughter my age. When things were slow, he often shared stories from his Army days. Early in World War II, he was nearly killed in a savage battle in New Guinea. He'd spent some time recuperating from the terrible head wound he had suffered.
- 13- We were closed Sundays. So every Saturday evening Mort urged me to take home the left over soup in a huge jar. A rich broth of turkey, rice and vegetables, it was a meal in itself, a treat for my struggling family.
- 14- My father usually picked me up after work those days because the soup was too hard to lug home on my bike. Then one Saturday he let me take the family car.
- 15- After work I drove home and parked. With the warm jar in my arms, I crossed the lawn and passed the living-room window. As I glanced inside, I almost dropped the jar. In my father's chair—my father's chair!—was a large bald man. He was cursing my father in a voice dripping with contempt. My brothers and sisters sat like statues. Dad's face was stone; Mom wept.
- 16- I crept into the kitchen, set the soup on a counter and listened through the door. The man wanted to take our car. Dad offered to make the three payments, but the man demanded the entire sum—\$325—or the car.
- 17- I had been in Los Angeles just long enough to understand how essential a car is. I slipped out the door, pushed the car down to the corner, started the engine and

to his life. Discuss with your group the following statements and decide which one best describes what Mort or the narrator believed in.

A- Mort believed in the following values:

- a- Helping the sick and the poor
- b- Rewarding those who work hard
- c- Giving work to needy teenagers
- d- Using cheap labor to make a profit.

B- The narrator believed in the following values:

- a- A job pays better than an education or a degree.
- b- Belonging to the working classes means continuous hard work.
- c- Society has an obligation towards a teenager in need.
- d- Being trustworthy and hard working pays in the end.

Justify your choice and summarize your group discussion. Be ready to share these ideas with the rest of the class.

### ACTIVITY



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Report the summary of your discussion in Activity 2 to the class. Compare your answer with the answers of other groups.

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## Part Four

### ACTIVITY



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Scan the selection "The Americanization of George" to extract the two incidents where the author notices the transformation of George. Complete Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

### The Americanization of George

by Samir Khalaf

The family system in Lebanon is, on the whole, intimate, warm, and affectionate. A child there grows up in a nurturing atmosphere of extended kinship networks. The Lebanese are very tactile. Touching, kissing, hugging, and the outward display of emotion - - regardless of gender - - are generously and spontaneously expressed. At least children of George's age indulge in these emotive expressions with little self-consciousness or feelings of shame and guilt.

## ACTIVITY

2

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A- Scan the selection to identify or infer information about the family system in Lebanon and the United States. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY

3

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The author identifies certain behaviors which reflect the Americanization of George. These behaviors are the result of certain factors or reasons suggested in the selection. Read the selection carefully and identify George's behaviors and the reasons behind them. Complete Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

## Assignment:

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Write an essay in which you compare and contrast the family system in Lebanon with that of the United States. Use the information in Exercise 7 as well as your own general knowledge.

## Part Five

## ACTIVITY

1

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Analyze the attitude of the author towards the subject he is writing about. Complete Exercise 9 in your Workbook.

## ACTIVITY

2

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In Exercise 9, you analyzed the attitude of the father towards his son's transformation. There is little explicit information in the selection about how George himself must have felt about his new environment or new home, his old home, and the transformation he is going through. Try to infer from the selection how George must have felt. Write briefly, giving some insight into George's mind and feelings at the time.

## ACTIVITY

3

.....

Compare and contrast the problems encountered by the two boys in "The Americanization of George" and "My \$ 325 Dollar Salvation". Complete Exercise 10 in your Workbook.

## Assignment:

Choose one of the following writing assignments:

- 1- In Activity 2 you had some insight into George's feelings. Write a letter to George in which you give him advice on how to cope with his situation.
- 2- Use the information in Exercise 10 to write an essay in which you compare and contrast the concerns of the two boys.
- 3- George's family is one of many Lebanese families who emigrated to different parts of the world, especially the US and Canada. Analyze the social and economic reasons that drove these families to emigrate. Present some of the main social and economic effects of such emigration on Lebanon and the Lebanese immigrant communities abroad.

## Part Six

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### ACTIVITY



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The writer of "The Call of the Open Road" mentions a number of reasons why he enjoys being an immigrant. Read the selection and complete Exercise 11 in your Workbook.

### The Call of the Open Road

by Henry Fenwick

The wonderful thing about being an immigrant is that you always feel that you are traveling. Your home is your home, but it also has a quality of the unforeseen, the happy accident, Robinson Crusoe's island. It's not quite the same thing as feeling that you are always on holiday (alas!) but there are similarities. If the people around you seem crazy you can think "how interesting" instead of "how irritating." And when you go back to the land you started out from, you find yourself still thinking "how interesting" about the manners and the mores you left behind, though you may well remember when you felt "how infuriating."

Not everyone can be an immigrant, though an experience that I highly recommend. Everyone, however, can be a traveler and that is probably almost as good. Leaving

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with me Lebanese style, he "froze" once again and treated me to a tamed version of the American "high five."

These are benign symptoms of George's Americanization – trivial compared with the messages he is bombarded with. George's sixth- and seventh-grade curriculum, for instance, included class discussion of such disheartening problems as illegitimate birth, teenage pregnancy, child abuse, and divorce.

Given the public outcry over such problems, the concern of school officials is certainly timely and legitimate. I cannot, though, help feeling that at least George has been needlessly damaged by this exposure to menacing<sup>1</sup> cruelties far removed from his situation at the moment.

There is a painful irony here. Before he has had a chance to become interested in romance, he is already being tutored and forewarned about the pathologies<sup>2</sup> of sex. More disquieting, perhaps, he is being denied the warmth and shelter of his family, with all its familiar intimacies, which could soften the anguish of such crude awakenings. The loss of innocence, if this is what he is going through, has been, as a result, an experience as crude and jarring<sup>3</sup> as America is at times.

Richard Rodriguez, the Mexican-American scholar, in a gripping autobiographical essay he wrote in 1974 argued how, in order for him to become an "American scholarship boy," he was compelled to sever his psychological ties with his family. He described how the solitude, silence, and rationality of the Oxford library was much too jarring a milieu when juxtaposed against the intimacy, gregariousness<sup>4</sup>, and rambunctiousness<sup>5</sup> of his family culture. Losing touch with his past, becoming alien to his family, was to him the inevitable and legitimate price of becoming "American".

Is George doomed, I wonder, to suffer the same fate? He has had to be uprooted from his true home and suffer the anguish of exile at a very tender age. Is this to be compounded now by a more baffling and painful form of homelessness? On balance, America has thus far been good to him.

But can he continue to enjoy this exuberance and freedom without breaking away from the reassuring intimacies of his family? He certainly needs both if he is to be the wholesome and lovable kid he has been so far.

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1- likely to cause serious harm.

2- the study of the way diseases begin and develop.

3- unpleasant, annoying.

4- the need to live in large groups and the enjoyment of being with others.

5- the wild and unruly nature.

I feel resentful that George should be disarmed of such harmless but reassuring expressions. I first noticed this transformation (or deformation) upon returning from a brief trip a few months after we had settled in Princeton.

I recall arriving from the airport one evening after an absence of five or six days. Normally, even after the



regular daily return home from work, George would interrupt his play and rush across the driveway to greet me; often, he would literally hurl himself into my open arms. If I happened to be carrying books or a briefcase, he would whisk them away, accompany me to the doorway, and regale<sup>1</sup> me with highlights of his day at school. It was no more than a token gesture of affection and mutual respect. It rendered, nonetheless, the return home a tender encounter fondly anticipated by both.

On that day, however, just as he was about to heed<sup>2</sup> his normal impulse as he rushed across the driveway, he suddenly "froze" in mid-passage, looked in the direction of his watchful playmates, and with obvious hesitation and embarrassment, calmly walked over to greet me with a cold handshake and a casual "Hi, Dad." Bit by bit, even this gesture has been abandoned. The most I can expect is a disengaged and distant nod.

Such "frozen" moments have recurred and spilled over to other daily encounters with members of the family from Lebanon. I could see him fret as relatives and friends he has not seen for two years try, in vain, to solicit<sup>3</sup> a hug or a kiss on the forehead. The reluctant denial has been transformed into a boast, that he is now an "American boy."

His "Americanization" was most forcefully conveyed by a recent incident on the tennis court. George is a versatile, gifted athlete and a superb tennis player for his age. It is a pleasure to witness his natural talents unfold by leaps and bounds<sup>4</sup>. We were struggling in a doubles game against two other, more seasoned partners who normally beat us. After a long and heated game we won the set, partly because of two exquisite shots by George. He was ecstatic. As he rushed across to share his exuberance<sup>5</sup>

1- tell me a lot of stories even if I don't want to hear.

2- pay attention to and do as suggested.

3- ask for.

4- very quickly, suddenly and by large amounts.

5- behavior which is energetic, excited and cheerful.

### ACTIVITY

.....

Read the selection and answer the questions in Exercise 12 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

.....

In your group, discuss your classroom environment and suggest ways of improving it. Think whether the factors that affect a supportive work environment apply in a classroom context and why. Share your ideas with the other groups.

### *Assignment:*

.....

Use the questionnaire in Exercise 13 in your Workbook to interview five to ten people about their work environment. Tabulate the results, and write a short report which summarizes your findings.

your hometown, getting on the road, seeing new places, even staying in motel rooms that look just like the last one but somehow aren't quite ... to me, this is the most euphoric feeling in the world. The whole pleasure of travel is that it has such immediacy—there's nothing generalized about it whatsoever. The splendid meal you eat in the Napa Valley that stays ever after in your mind as the meal to judge all meals by; the landfall that makes your heart leap because the sound, or the sight, or the smell of that island port strikes you with such pungent\* surprise.

## ACTIVITY

2

.....

A- Discuss the following with your group:

- a- In your opinion, does the writer present a one-sided point of view?
- b- Can you imagine some of the problems that an immigrant faces?

B- Draw on your general knowledge and some of the ideas mentioned in the previous selections you have read in this chapter, and write briefly about the possible problems which an immigrant might face.

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## ACTIVITY

3

.....

Work with a partner. Pretend you are having a conversation with the author concerning his views on immigration. Try to jot down the imaginary conversation in dialogue form. Use the ideas you talked or wrote about in Activity 2

## Part Seven

## ACTIVITY

1

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A- Work with a partner and list in order of importance, the factors that you believe affect job performance and productivity.

B- Read the selection "Give a Little, Get a Lot" and check whether or not the author agrees with your ranking of the factors that affect job performance and productivity.

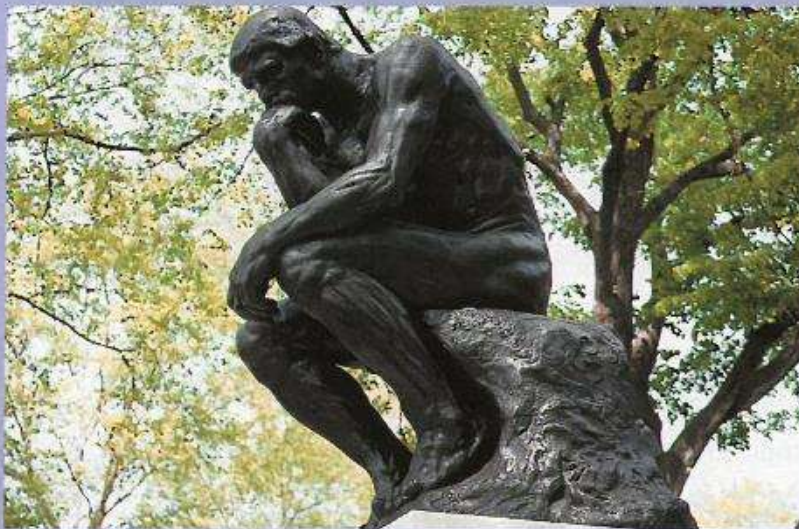
\* very strong and sharp.

# *International Economic Relations: Developed, Developing, Underdeveloped Countries and World and Economic Organizations*

*"In my wanderings I once saw upon an Island a man-headed, iron-hoofed monster who ate of the earth and drank of the sea incessantly. And for a long while I watched him. Then I approached him and said, "Have you never enough; is your hunger never satisfied and your thirst never quenched?"*

*And he answered saying, "Yes, I am satisfied, say, I am weary of eating and drinking; but I am afraid that tomorrow there will be no more earth to eat and no more sea to drink."*

**Kahlil Gibran**



## Part One

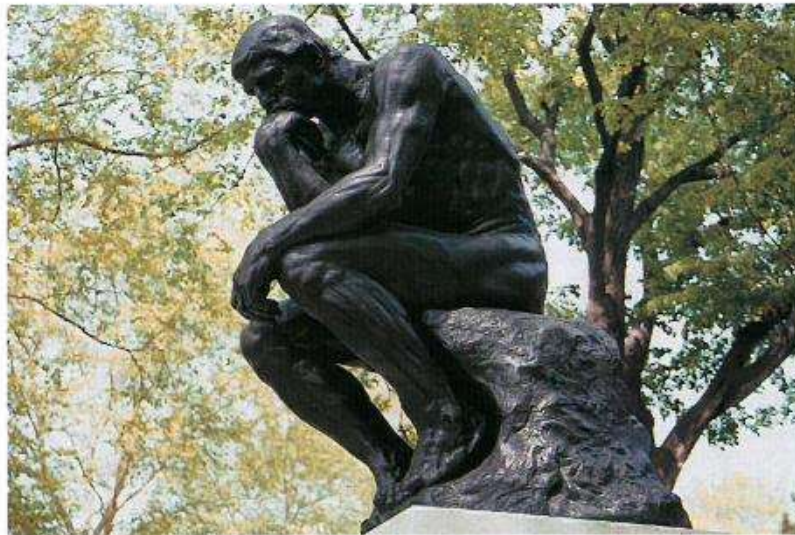
### ACTIVITY



.....

Brainstorm in your groups and come up with answers to the following questions. Share your answers with your teacher who will write your ideas on the board.

- A- After looking at the title and the picture, what do you think the selection is going to be about?
- B- Read the first and last paragraphs and the first sentence of each paragraph. What do you now think this selection is going to be about?
- C- Read the title then quickly scan the selection and circle all the words that have a connection to the title.



### Healthy, Wealthy and Unhappy

Why is it that economic success does not necessarily bring personal contentment?  
by Gerd Behrens

- 1- Some Years Ago, the story goes, a large corporation gave African peasants fertilizer so that their crop would double. And indeed it did. The businessmen thought they had sown the seeds of efficient agriculture. Alas, when the next season came the peasants didn't plant anything. "Why don't you plant?" the businessmen asked. The peasants thought this question somewhat silly. "Our last harvest was double," they replied. "We have enough to feed our families till next year". Whether a rural legend or not, the story illustrates the different answers people give to the question,

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## Give A Little, Get A Lot

by Michael Hickins

The idea that employees would prefer to work in a pleasant environment is not startling in and of itself. But the results of a 1998 study by the New York-based Families and Work Institute (FWI) indicate that a supportive workplace has a greater positive impact on job performance than do benefits or even pay.

With more two-income families struggling to balance work and family demands, employees' needs and expectations have evolved. Companies with a supportive work environment develop policies to meet those needs, such as flexible schedules that allow employees to care for a sick child or parent without fear of a pay-cut.

In the FWI study of 3,351 US workers, the workplace support factor accounted for 37 percent of the variability in job satisfaction. As support increases, so does employee satisfaction. Another 32 percent of the variability was attributed to factors measuring job quality, including autonomy, meaningfulness, opportunities for learning and advancement and job security. By contrast, earnings and access to benefits accounted for only 2 percent of the variability.

According to FWI President Ellen Galinsky, workplace flexibility and responsiveness to individual needs are very powerful predictors of employees' willingness to go the extra mile and provide added value. "Employees with more supportive workplaces are more willing than other workers to work harder than they have to in order to help their employers succeed," she says.



The study also found that a poor work environment spills over into employees' personal lives in a much more disruptive manner than previously believed. "Jobs affect home life three times more than your home life affects job performance," Galinsky says. "[This] causes a chain effect where the negative home life then affects performance."

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## Part Two

### ACTIVITY



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Diagnose the problem of the unhappiness of the wealthy. Read the selection to analyze the reasons for this unhappiness. Complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



.....

If you were in a leadership position, what measures would you take to enhance a sense of contentment and happiness in the wealthy countries? Use the diagnosis of the problem in Exercise 2 to help you come up with solutions. Work with your group and write a list of solutions.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Let the spokesperson of your group read the list of your suggested solutions to the class. Listen to their critique of your solutions.

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## Part Three

### ACTIVITY



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The author divides the world into two groups: the unhappy rich and the happy poor.

Do you agree with such a dichotomy? Are the rich necessarily unhappy and the poor necessarily happy? Discuss the issue with your partner, and think of evidence to support your point of view.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Are there other possible theories about social and economic divisions? Review the work of previously mentioned sociologists and economists in Unit One such as Durkheim, Marx, etc., and determine whether they agree or disagree with Behren's (the author) argument. What division would each find among social groups, communities, or nations? What explanation/s does each give for such divisions? Complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

zero. A nation of neurotics with two Ph.D.s each who will live to 90 gets full marks. The Bakutu, a tribe living in the Congo region of Central Africa, have always considered the white man's logic a bit batty. They call him *lolema djola feke*, "the bat that flies intensely but knows not where to."

7- According to the parable of the businessman and the fisherman, some Mexicans agree with the Bakutu. On holiday in a fishing village, an American businessman watches a local fisherman haul in a rather small catch. "Why don't you stay out at sea longer and bring in more fish?" the visitor inquires. "I like to spend my time playing with my children, taking a siesta with my wife, playing the guitar with my friends," the Mexican answers. The American is not impressed. "If you worked harder you could buy a second fishing boat, then a whole fleet. You could head up a large corporation, move to New York and list it on Wall Street. Eventually you could sell your stock and become very rich." "And then, senior?" the fisherman asks. "Then comes the best part", the businessman replies. "You retire. You move to a Mexican fishing village. You take a siesta with your wife and play with your children ..."

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## ACTIVITY



.....

Work with your group to answer the following in writing:

A- Brainstorm the specific words you expect to see in the selection (other than the ones you identified in Activity 1).

B- Make up some questions you think this selection might answer.

## ACTIVITY



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Read the selection and find out which of your questions were addressed. Write the answers to your questions.

## ACTIVITY



.....

Read the selection to answer the questions in Exercise 1 in your Workbook.

## Assignment:

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Do you agree that wealth is not necessarily the secret to happiness but, on the contrary, is the source of unhappiness? Write an essay in which you agree or disagree with the author's argument. Provide stories from your own experience to support your point of view.

## ACTIVITY



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Which of the theories of socio-economic divisions do you favor? Write briefly to explain why you find one of the theories (i.e., the ones discussed in Exercise 3 and Behren's theory) the most logical.

## Part Four

## ACTIVITY



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In "Responding to Change", the author presents change as the most common thread in the lives of individuals. Read the selection and complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

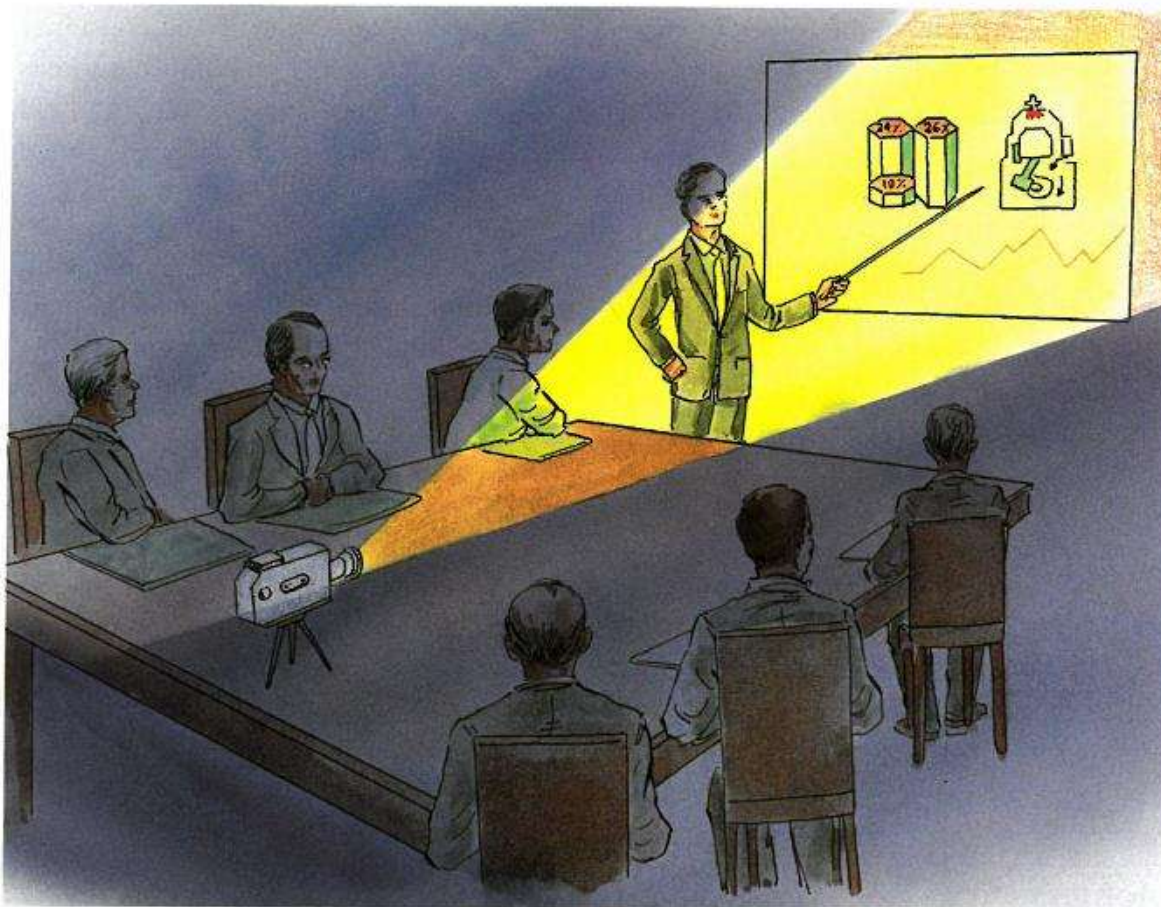
### Responding to Change

by George B. Weathersby  
President and CEO

American Management Association

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- 1- Change is perhaps the most common thread in the lives of the more than 70,000 individual members of the AMA, and it is a continuous challenge for our nearly 10,000 corporate members. The usual observations are that change is occurring faster, pervading almost all aspects of our lives and requiring more sophisticated skills of those who want to prosper from it.
- 2- At AMA, we focus on how the process and substance of change will affect the careers of individuals and the productivity and effectiveness of organizations.
- 3- Among the many forces of change affecting individuals, several strong global trends stand out. Career paths with a single company have given way to the reality that many people will work for multiple employers in different areas of professional responsibility. This transformation can be seen in the former state-owned enterprises of China that are reevaluating the role of every worker, for example, and in the traditional manufacturing companies that have adopted the mantra of "better, faster, cheaper."
- 4- Given these global trends, the economic security of individuals derives from employability, not employment. Their success is measured by contributions, not job longevity. And work products increasingly are intangible ideas, software programs, conceptual designs or services, not tangible physical products.



- 5- Moreover, wealth is no longer measured by one's control of land, buildings, equipment and other physical assets. It is created by ideas, images, services, timely information or access to capital, all of which are globally mobile in an instant as long as a political system does not prevent their dissemination. Individuals are the indispensable creators of value to corporations and societies, not the indefensible consumers of value from corporations and society.
- 6- In a climate of surging change, the most significant attributes of high-value-added individuals are the abilities to learn and adapt to change, to provide leadership at every level of an organization and to adopt change as a positive force for renewal. The relationship between individuals and their corporate environments increasingly is the distinguishing characteristic—the sustainable competitive advantage—of a corporation.
- 7- Recognizing these global trends, forward-looking companies are increasing their appeal by offering continuous professional development, individually guided retirement programs and extended management development to enable leaders at all levels to manage the process of change in a highly productive manner. AMA is at the forefront of organizations that can assist individuals and companies with this process.

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how much does man need? One says, "Enough to subsist." Another may say, "As much as possible". The latter certainly creates more wealth. But does it also create more happiness?

- 2- Any seasoned traveler can attest to the fact that wealth and happiness do not usually cohabit. Visit Europe and be mystified by the unsmiling faces and furrowed brows in the most affluent countries. Visit Africa and marvel at the laughter and general merriment, even in the most impoverished ones.
- 3- For those who prefer empirical to impressionistic evidence, there are opinion polls. I recall that back in the 80s, a survey asked Western Europeans the mother of all questions: Are you happy? The Germans, the richest, were the most miserable. The Irish and Portuguese, the poorest, turned out to be the most contented. In 1998, a global survey by the Angus Reid Group constructed a Hope Index, asking people how optimistic they felt about the future. Pessimism reigned supreme in Europe, particularly in the countries along the Rhine. In Germany (per capita GDP \$28,000) only 18% of the respondents were upbeat about the future, and in France (\$26,000) it was 17%. By comparison, South Africa (\$ 3,500) and Brazil (\$ 4,400) scored 42% and 64% on the Hope Index. It is not a new insight that the relationship between material and emotional welfare seems to be an inverse one. When the carpenter of Galilee declared that man does not live by bread alone, he reminded all those who see man as *Homo oeconomicus* of their materialist blinkers.
- 4- What is the explanation for this strange phenomenon? Maybe it has to do with the cerebral and the visceral. Mankind has known for a long time that too much self-scrutiny is not conducive to happiness. "Ask yourself whether you are happy, and you cease to be so," John Stuart Mill wrote more than 100 years ago. To intellectuals, the pursuit of happiness is something unbecoming of cultured people. It is appropriate, the élite might argue, only to the shallow and unsophisticated. How many novels or movies about happy people win critical acclaim? Anguish and discontent are taken as the mark of a deep thinker.
- 5- To the cerebral, it is not so much that ignorance is bliss, but that bliss is ignorance. Suffering is often seen as a precondition not only for great insights, but for any meaningful existence. I suffer, therefore I am. Marcel Proust, one of the great malcontents of all times, held that the only possible paradise is the one we've lost. And if there are no obvious problems one can always invent some. Thinking up problems serves as a make-work scheme for the problem-solving classes.
- 6- The realization that wealth breeds unhappiness calls for a new yardstick to measure human development. The current scale, the United Nations Human Development Index, classifies countries according to per capita income, literacy rate and life expectancy. These criteria, unsurprisingly, were drawn up by people with high per capita income, high literacy rates and high life expectancy. On this index a nation with a large proportion of short-lived illiterate subsistence farmers scores virtually

The future of any organization depends on its ability to learn, grow and change as the world changes. The United Nations is no exception. I am joined by the Organization's senior officials in urging all staff and managers to demonstrate their commitment to professional excellence and continuous learning. In return, we commit ourselves to doing our part to promote a culture in the United Nations Secretariat where excellence and continuous learning are expected, valued and rewarded.

## Part Six

### ACTIVITY



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Work with a partner on the following:

- A- Think of how spoken language is different from written language. Jot down all the ideas that come to your mind.
- B- Scan the script of the speech and identify the elements which distinguish it from a written text. Tell your teacher about these elements so they may be written on the board.

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### ACTIVITY



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Compare and contrast "Building the Future" with the previous selection "Responding to Change". Complete Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



.....

Work with your group to prepare a short speech in which you propose measures you would take to enhance a sense of happiness and contentment in your society. Ask the spokesperson of your group to present this short speech to the class.

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## Part Five

### ACTIVITY



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Listen to the speech and complete Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



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Listen once more and identify the key concepts in the speech. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY



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A- Listen to the speech again and check your answers. Jot down any additional notes which you may need to write a summary of the speech.

B- Write your summary of the speech.

C- Compare it with your partner's summary. Come up with a revised summary together.

D- Check the accuracy of your ideas against the script of the speech printed below.

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## Building the Future

by Kofi A. Annan  
UN Secretary-General

Together we have embarked on a journey to reform the United Nations and prepare it to meet the challenges of the next century. We are building on our strengths and creating a result-oriented, high performing organization that is flexible, responsive and ready to meet the ever-evolving needs of our Member States.

Our greatest strength – and the key to our success – is the quality of our people, both staff and managers. To capitalize on this strength, we need to create an organizational environment that supports managers and enables all staff to contribute to their maximum potential. To this end, we are undertaking a thorough review of the Organization's human resources management.

There is a clear need to move responsibility for the management of human resources to those directly accountable for programme delivery – the line managers. This will require forging new partnerships between the Office of Human Resources

## Part Seven

### ACTIVITY



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Read the selection and complete Exercise 9 in your Workbook.

### Spiritual Unfoldment at the World Bank

by Richard Barrett

- 1- Toward the end of 1992, I was nearing completion of the second draft of my book, *A Guide to Liberating Your Soul*. To get feedback, I invited about a dozen spiritually motivated colleagues from the World Bank to discuss the ideas and theories expressed in my book. We began a series of six brown-bag lunches.
- 2- A few weeks later, I accepted a challenging new job as assistant to one of the vice-presidents and two colleagues from the brown-bag lunch group asked if I would set up a spiritual study group. Thinking I would be too busy, I asked for inner guid-

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ance—a sign from my soul.

- 3- A few days later, two women I didn't know called me after reading a report about a seminar I had given in South Africa on "Liberating the Soul." They were also staff members and asked if I would set up some form of spiritual study group at the World Bank. I had little time to organize it, but they told me not to worry. "Just tell us what to do and we will do it." I had received my sign. That was the start of the

Management, department heads and line managers. Through our reform efforts, I aim to create a management culture that recognizes staff as the Organization's greatest resource and holds managers accountable for making the most effective use of this resource. Managing people must be seen as a key managerial task, along with managing programmes, financial resources, information and change. I, therefore, expect managers to communicate a clear sense of purpose and direction to their staff, to motivate them, build team spirit and trust, and manage performance to achieve results.

The new Performance Appraisal System provides an important tool to assist in managing performance through jointly setting goals, agreeing on expected results and engaging in ongoing dialogue about performance. The Performance Appraisal System also emphasizes the importance of professional development and learning by requiring all staff and managers to set development goals and hold managers accountable for developing their staff.

As you know, I see staff development as a responsibility shared by the Organization, by managers and by staff themselves. The Organization must provide a framework of opportunities and foster an environment conducive to learning. I recognize that, in the past, the Organization has underinvested in developing its human resources. It is now time to recognize that building and maintaining the professional competence of staff is a critical investment in the Organization's future.

In the current biennial budget, I asked for and received an increase in funds for staff development and learning activities. We must use these funds to strengthen the Organization's technical and managerial capacity and to promote shared values and standards across the Organization. But development is not a one-time effort. Maintaining professional excellence and cutting-edge expertise is a continual process, in which managers and staff themselves have important roles to play.

I expect managers to keep themselves up to date, and to support their staff's development and career progress by providing on-the-job training, coaching and mentoring, and ensuring that staff are allowed and encouraged to take advantage of opportunities for learning and growth. Mandatory managerial development programmes have been put in place to assist managers in meeting the many challenges they face, and we will increasingly place emphasis on managerial ability when selecting staff for positions of leadership within the Organization. Expanded opportunities for learning and development are also being made available to staff at all levels. In this regard, the Organization will redouble its efforts to ensure that merit, productivity and achievement are rewarded by promotion and advancement at all levels. I therefore urge all staff to be proactive, flexible and mobile and to seek new challenges in their daily work in order to achieve organizational goals and, in so doing, to fulfil their individual aspirations.

- 8- For organizations, the forces of change are numerous: rapidly evolving consumer demands, the changing roles and regulations of governments, competitive forces and new players in the market, and technologies that either level the playing field for new and old competitors or give a decided edge to the newest ones, unfettered by historical decisions and obligations.
- 9- As in Asian martial arts, companies must direct the forces of change to the achievement of their own objectives—first to survive and then to thrive. Each company chooses its response to change, be it designing innovative offerings, becoming market- or customer-centered or redesigning work and the deployment of people against it.
- 10- Every year, the AMA works with more than 600 corporations to help them respond to change, design the organization and deployment of people, create management development, employee information and skills programs to maximize the effectiveness of the chosen design, and increase profitability of the entire unit. Helping individuals and organizations learn to manage change is what your AMA does all of the time. In fact, managing change is a good description of our core business. How can we help you?

## ACTIVITY



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Work with a partner to formulate a questionnaire which could be used to measure whether companies and individuals are equipped with the required skills to face change. Use the information you came up with in Exercise 4.

## ACTIVITY



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Read the selection again and complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

## *Assignment:*

.....

Can you think of another area such as the environment, for example, that is experiencing rapid change? Devise an international organization that will meet the new challenges in this field. Prepare a poster to advertise such an organization. You may want to write a concise statement of objective for the organization and prepare an organizational chart to show the hierarchy and the different divisions in this organization. Be ready to present your poster at the end of this chapter.

## Part One

### ACTIVITY

1

A- Look at the title and picture and tell your partner what you expect the selection to be about.

B- Read the first sentence of each paragraph. Then write with your partner questions you expect to be answered in the selection.

### ACTIVITY

2

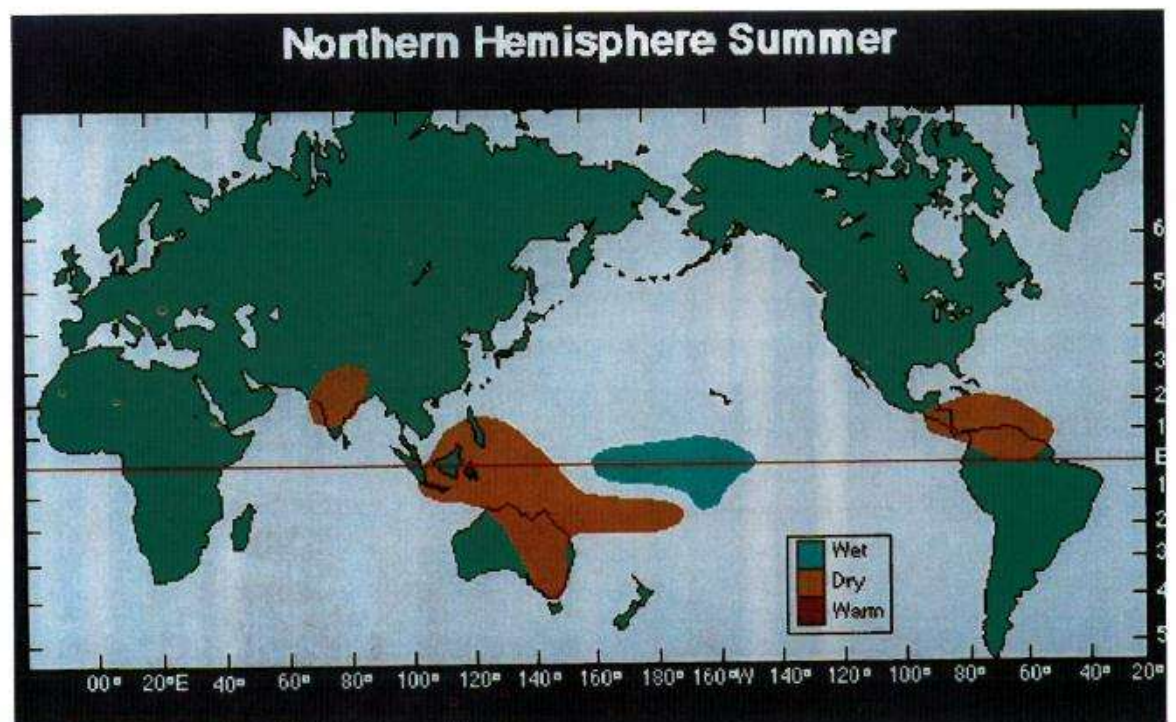
Read the selection and check whether the questions you wrote are answered. Then complete Exercise 1 in your Workbook.

## The Climate Factor

by Arthur Fisher

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Something drastic happened to the tree of human evolution at least three times in the last 3 million years, something that caused some new species of prehumans to branch out and others to die off. That something, according to new research, was a series of dramatic climate shifts in Africa, the hypothetical home of humankind. The



## ACTIVITY

2

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Evaluate the solution offered by Barrett, the author of this narrative, for people who are "wealthy and unhappy." Overall, do you feel that this is a realistic and practical solution? In your group, discuss the pros and cons of this solution. Share the summary of your discussion with your class.

## ACTIVITY

3

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A- "Spiritual Unfoldment at the World Bank" concludes with a proposal to sponsor a World Bank conference in which the link between spiritual values and sustainable development is explored. Discuss the following with your group and write down your understanding of them in concrete terms.

- a- What do you understand by spiritual values? List the values that are the most important to you.
- b- What do you understand by sustainable development? Explain in more specific terms.
- c- Do you feel that such a conference is a priority? If not, what issue needs to be given more immediate attention and funding?

B- Write briefly on one of the following:

- a- Why do you feel that a conference on the link between spiritual values and sustainable development is a priority?
- b- Why should a certain issue of your choice be given more immediate attention and funding?

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shifts brought long severe periods of cool dry conditions to punctuate warm wet stretches. And each time, the evolutionary tree shook.

The evidence, the first detailed, continuous record of African climate, was gathered by Peter de-Menocal, of Columbia University's Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory, by analyzing ocean sediment cores drilled in coastal African waters. The sediments, formed over some 8 million years, contained fragments of soil and grasses that had blown out to sea. Drier periods resulted in thicker layers of this material, called aeolian dust.

This dusty record showed that some 2.8 million years ago the cold dry episodes became longer and more severe, killing the rain forests and allowing grasslands to take over. Species that could not adapt would die out. Others would thrive.

Sure enough, fossil evidence reveals that the earliest known prehuman to walk on two legs, *Australopithecus afarensis* (dubbed "Lucy"), evolved some time after 2.8 million years ago into at least two different lines: the genus *Paranthropus* and the genus *Homo*. And when the next cool dry cycle began, about 1.7 million years ago, *Homo habilis* disappeared, replaced by larger-brained *Homo erectus*. By the last great climate shift, a million years ago, the entire *Paranthropus* line had become extinct, and only *Homo erectus* remained, eventually to evolve into *Homo sapiens*.

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What caused these climatic changes? A NASA global circulation model indicates that the periodic expansion of North American and European ice sheets would have chilled the Atlantic Ocean, propelling cold dry air across Africa.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Read the selection again and complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

### Assignment:

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Can you provide evidence based on information you have learned in history or science class to support or refute the author's theory. Present this evidence in a short report (one or two pages).

## *Ecology: Impact on Future Socio-economic Relations*

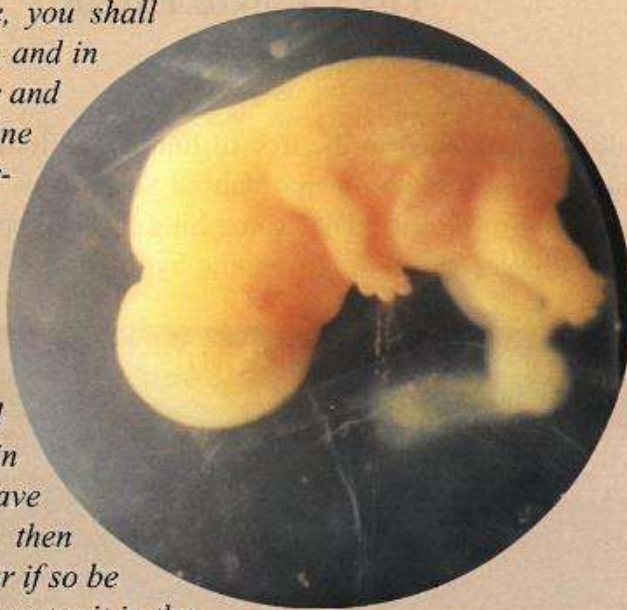
*"...All things live and glow in the knowledge of the day and the majesty of the night. You and the stone are one. There is a difference only in heart-beats. Your heart beats a little faster, does it, my friend? Ay, but it is not so tranquil.*

*Its rhythm may be another rhythm, but I say unto you that if you sound the depths of your soul and scale the heights of space, you shall hear but one melody, and in that melody the stone and the star sing, the one with the other, in perfect unison.*

*If my words reach not your understanding, then let be until another dawn.*

*If you have cursed this stone because in your blindness you have stumbled upon it, then would you curse a star if so be your head should encounter it in the*

*sky? But the day will come when you will gather stones and stars as a child plucks the valley-lilies, and then shall you know that all these things are living and fragrant."*



**Kahlil Gibran**

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Spiritual Unfoldment Society (SUS), Our purpose included:

- Promoting personal transformation through self-knowledge and understanding, and awakening higher consciousness;
- Providing a safe forum for the exchange of beliefs and ideas that promote spiritual awareness;
- Encouraging the integration of higher consciousness into every aspect of our lives;
- Seeking to create within the World Bank a consciousness of love and understanding that contributes toward transforming the way we interact with one another.

- 4- Within a matter of months after our first meeting, 40 to 50 people were attending. Although initially there was some fear about how colleagues might react to our society, it soon became perfectly respectable to be associated with the SUS.
- 5- A major boost to the Society came within a few months. *The Washington Post* featured the SUS in a magazine article. Management was particularly delighted with the following quote: "The World Bank, at 18th and H Streets NW, typically regarded as just another institutional pillar in the Washington power structure, is gaining a reputation for enlightenment<sup>1</sup>." Soon we began getting calls from people who worked in the downtown area and who wanted to attend our weekly meetings.
- 6- Our membership grew to almost 400. We instituted monthly meditation sessions, created special-interest groups, held two retreats and published two newsletters. Members reported that the meetings had a profound impact on both their business and personal lives. We were feeding their souls.
- 7- From the steering committee also came the idea for an international conference to explore the link between spiritual values and sustainable<sup>2</sup> development. After some initial hesitation, the World Bank agreed to sponsor the conference. The conference auditorium was packed with over 350 people from more than 20 countries. I heard people say, "I am totally amazed."
- 8- The outside world was finding it difficult to believe that this conservative monolith<sup>3</sup> was holding a conference on ethical and spiritual values in relation to development. The real significance of the conference and of the Spiritual Unfoldment Society was that the bank staff now have permission to talk about spiritual values in development, and to bring their hearts and souls to work.

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1- giving intellectual or spiritual light; teaching or instructing.

2- maintaining, kept going or in effect.

3- very large, upright piece of stone; something having a uniform, massive, or rigid quality or character

- B- Based on the above and on the information in the selection, make a list with your group of all the possible reasons for air pollution in Lebanon.
- C- With your group, scan the selection for reasons for the recent increase in the size of personal transport in Lebanon. Write down these reasons. Add to them others based on your general knowledge.
- D- In your opinion, what can be done on both the personal and social levels to minimize air pollution in Lebanon. Suggest ways to change personal and social habits which contribute to this problem. Try to suggest specific measures you would take if you were in a position of responsibility, for example, the minister of the environment.

## Part Three

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Read the section on the "Economic Impacts of Air Pollution" in the selection and determine with your group whether it would be more cost effective in the long run to introduce costly preventive measures, which would help decrease the air pollution problem. Take notes on the discussion. Then share your ideas with the rest of the class.

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### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Skim the selection and take notes. Complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Add to the outline (Exercise 4) ideas from your previous discussion and general knowledge. Then share this working outline with the rest of the class and try to get ideas from their outlines to add to yours.

### Assignment:

.....

Find more information on air pollution in Lebanon from library sources, interviews with experts in the field, internet web sites, personal observation of factory waste and car exhaust, etc. Add headings to your outline (Exercise 4), or revise it to incorporate this new information. Write a report on the topic and hand it in when you complete this chapter.

## Part Two

### ACTIVITY

1

Interview your partner about the causes and effects of air pollution. Use the questions in Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

In groups, read one of the paragraphs in the selection (as assigned by the teacher). Change groups, and then report what you have read to the new group members. Take notes on what the other members report to you. (This is called jigsaw reading.)

## The Impact of Mobile Source Pollution in Beirut

by S. Djoundaurian, I. Nuwayhid, and F. Chaaban

The demand for passenger cars in Lebanon, as in any other country, is affected by many factors. These include lifestyle, income, labor structure, cost of fuel and urban development patterns. These parameters have been changing over the past two decades due to the drastic development, both political and social, that occurred in Lebanon. However, statistics have shown that the size of the transportation sector, particularly personal transport, has increased. As a result, energy consumption for transport has been growing as have pollution problems caused by combustion from vehicles.

Cars were first used in Lebanon in 1905. On the eve of independence in 1943



in Lebanese cities because tower blocks, in which most Lebanese live, are situated on both sides of the streets. This leads to a concentration of emissions due to a lack of sufficient natural ventilation.

### Economic Impacts of Air Pollution

There is a significant correlation between poor health and air pollution. Consequently, any improvement in air quality is associated with improvement in health. However, improvements in air quality can only be brought about by expending resources for pollution control and abatement programs. The question that naturally arises is the amount of resources which need be expended to design economically-optimal and politically-feasible pollution control programs. Economic theory suggests that a pollution control policy is optimal if the marginal benefits due to abatement are matched by the marginal expenditures incurred to implement the control.

Benefit valuation is essential for comparing physical effects with each other and with costs. Values are usually measured in terms of how much of one asset individuals are willing to sacrifice in order to obtain another. Information about the number of lives saved and illnesses prevented is desirable for efficient resource allocation among competing uses, such as allocation of resources for air quality management programs versus other investment opportunities. Knowledge of the economic cost or monetary value of mortality and morbidity – the relative incidence of disease – provides a better perspective of the choices involved.

Many would oppose this kind of quantification on the grounds that it dehumanizes life, which is supposed to have an infinite and intrinsic value. In practice, however, societies do place values on human life and illness as reflected by the choices made in day-to-day safety and health decisions.

Health impacts are expressed in both physical and monetary terms for statistical lives lost to premature death, hospital admissions, chronic disease cases, emergency room admissions, and days of restricted activity due to hospitalization for various diseases.

### ACTIVITY



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- A- Discuss the following in your group:
- a- How many vehicles does your family own?
  - b- Are the vehicles you own properly maintained?
  - c- Do you use leaded or unleaded gasoline?
  - d- How often do you use public transportation?

## Part Four

### ACTIVITY

1

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1st- Listen to the lecture and take notes of the main ideas.

2nd- Write the main ideas of the lecture in a two or three sentence summary.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Listen to the lecture again and complete Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Write a paragraph on one of the categories in Exercise 5. Exchange your paragraph with a partner and check your partner's paragraph for content, organization and style. Use the checklist in Exercise 6. You may want to check the content against the script of the lecture printed below.

## Water

by A. Biswas, J. Kolars, M. Murakami, J. Waterbury, and A. Wolf

The per unit price of water is tied to a number of natural and technological factors as well as to the producer's desire for profit. Sources (springs, rivers, aquifers) and site characteristics are primary in these considerations. For example, is the water to be desalinized brackish or sea water? Significant differences in cost stem from this. Is the reservoir site in a deep canyon or on an undulating plain? Water loss through evaporation, plus major differences in dam construction apply here. The means of transfer also influence ultimate cost. If pipelines, how far between source and consumer, and what are the costs of pumping and lifting the water? What waste and loss will occur? The type of production facility plays its role: desalination plant or high dam? What energy costs are involved in reverse osmosis—is hydro-power involved? Or is imported fuel for a thermal plant a concern? Finally, what will the producer and shipper consider to be a reasonable per unit profit? It should be noted that the time horizon for these costs may vary, but all fall within the scope of a few years and are tied to the market mechanism. Therefore, this group of variables has been placed near the 'quick to change' end of the continuum.

When per unit water costs are aggregated in terms of the consuming population not only the size but the projected growth rates are important, as are the level and type of consumption. These measures lead to consideration of even more complex variables that often create social dissonance related to the national agendas of the peoples involved.

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around 3.400 cars were on the roads. This number increased until more than 1.300.000 cars were estimated to be in use at the end of 1997, according to official figures. Over 50% of these cars operate in Beirut and its suburbs. This has caused serious traffic problems and air and noise pollution in a densely-populated region.

The estimated population of Lebanon is around 3.5 million, which suggests that the per capita car-ownership rate is around 0.3%. This is high when compared to other countries, even those with higher living standards. The fleet of motor vehicles in Lebanon is relatively old and poorly maintained. This has led to higher emission levels of various pollutants than in countries where cars are properly inspected and engines better tuned. Other means of land transport, such as railways, are non-existent. Even public transport in urban areas is still in the early stages of rehabilitation.

A major consequence of the sizable and poorly-maintained fleet of motor vehicles is that most urbanized areas in Lebanon face serious pollution problems. In fact available data indicate the potential for significant health problems associated with poor air quality: The estimated maximum hourly carbon monoxide concentration in the vicinity of some main roads during rush hour traffic is likely to approach or exceed, World Health Organization guidelines for health.

While rush hour traffic contributes most to the general level of pollution in the city, there are several other factors one must take into consideration:

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*The predominance of passenger cars on the road:* A survey of vehicle classification in the Greater Beirut Area for the period 1991-1996, revealed that about 88% of registered vehicles were passenger cars, 8% were buses and trucks, and 4% were other types of vehicles such as motorcycles.

*The age distribution of the vehicle fleet:* Available data indicate that a significant proportion of the fleet of passenger cars is old. A positively-skewed distribution revealed that about 70% of the private car fleet was made up of models dating from 1984 or earlier.

*Improper maintenance:* The car fleet is poorly maintained due to a lack of strict and effective inspections. This leads to low fuel combustion efficiency and, consequently, higher emissions from exhausts and higher noise levels.

*Rare use of the vehicle testing system:* Although there is a system for vehicle testing which requires that vehicles be serviced and tested each year, this is often ignored.

*The widespread use of leaded gasoline:* The consumption level of leaded gasoline in Lebanon ranks among the highest in the world. Although unleaded gasoline was introduced in 1993, it represented only 12% of all gasoline consumed in 1997.

*The concentration of tower blocks:* Air pollution caused by vehicles is significant

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## Part Six

### ACTIVITY 1 .....

Read the selection and answer the questions in Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

- A- In your groups, discuss whether harmful chemicals are a pressing problem in Lebanon. Make sure that all the members of your group participate in the discussion. Use the discussion wheel for that purpose.
- B- What recommendations can you come up with to help solve this serious problem? Make a list of these recommendations to share with the rest of the class.

### ACTIVITY 3 .....

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- A- Ask the spokesperson of your group to read your list of recommendations to the class.
- B- Listen to the other group's recommendations and use the checklist in Exercise 9 to give them feedback.

## Part Seven

### ACTIVITY 1 .....

Use the questions in Exercise 10 to write a story. Read the story to your classmates.

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

Read the poem and answer the question in Exercise 11 in your Workbook.

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The most disturbing research is on a substance called bisphenol A, which is worth billions of dollars to the chemical industry. It is a building block of polycarbonate plastic, which means little until you realize that it is used for lining the inside of food cans.

Independent scientists say that in experiments, this substance had a powerful effect on the reproductive tract of mice at levels thousands of times below what was thought possible.



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The chemical industry denies it, saying it has conducted the same experiments but cannot reproduce the same results. Much is at stake for shareholders if the substance is banned.

Peterson was preaching to the converted in Japan. The 25 scientists gathered there were so concerned about the mass of new evidence before them that they demanded steps be taken to reduce the levels of the hundreds of untested chemicals in the environment.

They were particularly anxious about organochlorines, used as pesticides, because evidence already existed that they were harming wildlife.

The European Union has banned some substances used as softening agents in plastic toys. These were toys that children might suck, thereby ingesting hormone-disrupting chemicals.

- D- Put these similar ideas into some kind of logical order (e.g. chronological, cause and effect, comparison and contrast etc.)

## ACTIVITY

2

.....

Read the selection and try to interact with it while reading. As you read you will be thinking of the information, commenting on it in your mind and asking yourself questions about it. Write down what goes through your mind as you read. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook. Then share what you wrote with your classmates.

## ACTIVITY

3

.....

- A- Read through the selection once, underlining the words you don't know, without stopping to look them up.
- B- Read through the selection again checking the underlined words that you now understand from the context.
- C- Compare the words you underlined with those the other members of your group underlined and help each other to understand the remaining unknown words.
- D- If you are still left with words you don't understand, look them up in the dictionary (either in class or at home).

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## Human Body Has Become a Sea of Chemical Contaminants

by Paul Brown

It all sounds rather scary. "A hundred or more novel chemicals are swilling around in our bloodstreams, chemicals which, before this century, were not found in humans. It makes all of us, as well as our children and grandchildren, a walking experiment – one with completely unknown results."

But John Peterson, director of the W. Alton Jones Foundation in the United States, was not trying to frighten his audience. He was talking last month in Japan to a group of international scientists, already deeply concerned about the issue of chemical contamination of the human body. They agreed that the major danger seemed to be hormone disruption, and that the most vulnerable group was unborn children.

"No mother anywhere on Earth doesn't carry some of these compounds in her body," Peterson said.

When this first became an issue five years ago, research was concerned with what were dubbed "gender-benders" – chemicals capable of causing sex changes in fish and other animals exposed to them, otherwise known as endocrine disrupters.

A few instances of how politics and emotions intersect will suffice at this juncture. International relations can be good or poor, and the perceptions that one nation's population has of another's can also play an important role. National pride which insist upon the internal production of a resource regardless of its cost is frequently encountered as is national anxiety. The familiar question of food security couched in terms of water availability and security needs little explication. The perception of need and the perception of supply also can be part of the national concern.

Attitudes and perceptions do change, but more slowly than the size of populations or the stock market. On the other hand the juggernaut-like pace of possible global climatic change is slower than the tides of human affairs.

Each of these groups of variables imply further consequences. Variance necessitates evaluation of precipitation predictability. This leads to consideration of less certain precipitation in the core of the region compared with more certain water supplies on its northern periphery.

Turning to the human side, the social dissonance of national moods reflects on the reliability of international co-operation which, combined with the problems of natural supply, determine the availability of each water source. This, in turn, must be matched to the affordability of water and each nation's ability to pay the total bill involved. All such considerations are embedded in the question of the environmental impact each project will have on national economies as well as upon an increasingly fragile planet.

## Part Five

### ACTIVITY



.....

- A- Read the title "Human Body Has Become a Sea of Chemical Contaminants" written on the board and think of
- what you already know about this topic.
  - what you want to know about it.
- B- Tell your ideas to your teacher who will write them on the board, grouping similar ideas together.
- C- With a partner, organize the ideas on the board, which should now look like a web, into two major topics and subtopics, making sure to group similar ideas together.

After this single action, the EU issued a strategy to deal with "substances which disrupt human and wildlife hormone systems."

But while the EU statement looks to "identify appropriate policy action" and use the "precautionary principle," little further action is proposed – apart from more research.

Instead of compulsory action to cut the number of chemicals contaminating human blood, the EU suggests "voluntary initiatives" to identify substitutes in order to eliminate or find replacements for substances of concern.

This does not satisfy Peterson, the 25 scientists or the campaigners in this field. The World Wide Fund for Nature said in a statement: "The commission's strategy is a limp response to a major problem – no doubt at least in part due to industries' pleas for minimal disruption to business as usual, and to the lack of resources being made available. One of the main thrusts of the commission's strategy is to list priority chemicals, but it's not clear that exposure to these will be controlled or eliminated. There is no clear strategy to investigate the bulk of chemicals to which we are exposed for their ability to disrupt endocrine systems."

Gwynne Lyons, toxics and policy adviser to the WWF, said: "The EC seems content to focus only on the tip of the iceberg, but there is a need for a far more robust strategy to protect humans and the environment from these chemicals."

Peterson has no doubts about the dangers either. "We know now that while there can be acute health impacts on adults with high exposures, the most vital are low-level exposures in the womb," he said. "These have lifelong, debilitating impacts that erode the very essence of what a young baby can aspire to as he or she grows and matures and becomes a functioning – or dysfunctional – adult in society."

"This is happening fast, certainly more rapidly than advances in our understanding of what we've done or what risks we've created," he warned. "And because the scale is now global, we have no place to hide from our mistakes. No human baby has been born for several decades without experiencing measurable contamination in the womb. These are experiments whose results we won't know until it's too late to call them off."

But he and his colleagues in Japan urged politicians to stop the situation getting worse. As a minimum, they said, substances that accumulate in the body and persist should be eliminated from products and commerce.

Peterson also suggested a shift of burden of proof for endocrine disrupting chemicals, even those that are not bio-accumulative and persistent. Currently, science has to prove them dangerous before they can be banned.

## Part One

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Read the poem and make a list of the things the narrator has not done. Complete Exercise 1 in your Workbook.

### I have Arrived

I have not seen the plays in town  
                     only the computer printouts  
 I have not read the latest books  
                     only *The Wall Street Journal*  
 I have not heard birds sing this year  
                     only the ringing of phones  
 I have not taken a walk anywhere  
                     but from the parking lot to my office  
 I have not shared a feeling in years  
                     but my thoughts are known to all  
 I have not listened to my own needs  
                     but what I want to get  
 I have not shed a tear in ages  
                     I have arrived  
 Is *this* where I was going?

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### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Focus on the style of the poem. Complete Exercise 2 in your Workbook.

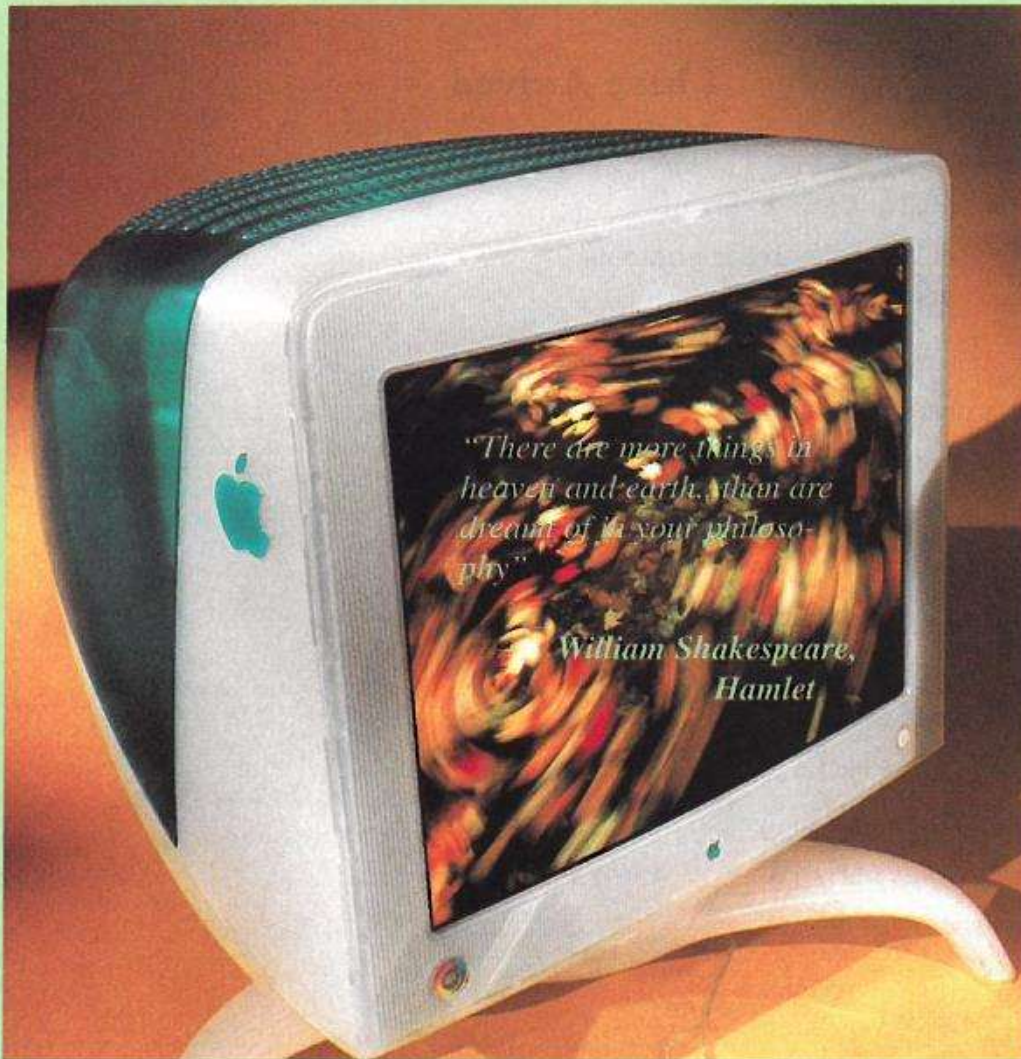
### ACTIVITY

3

.....

Focus on the meaning of the poem. Complete Exercise 3 in your Workbook.

# *Socio-political Economy and Future Development*



## Part Two

### ACTIVITY

1

.....

In your groups, discuss the following:

- A- In your opinion, does modern technology have a positive or negative influence on human beings?
- B- What are the possible positive aspects of technology? Make a list.
- C- What are the possible negative aspects of technology? Make a list.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Write a cause-effect essay in which you analyze the effects of modern technology on our lives.

## Part Three

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### ACTIVITY

1

.....

Read the title "The Technological Revolution".

Write down what you already know about the technological revolution. Complete Exercise 4 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY

2

.....

Read the selection and answer the comprehension questions in Exercise 5 in your Workbook.

## The Technological Revolution

by Carl Becker

- 1- We are now living in the second great epoch of discovery and invention. Since the seventeenth century, the discovery of steam power, gas, electricity, and radiation have made possible those innumerable tools and appliances, those complicated and powerful machines, and those delicate instruments of precision which elicit our wonder and our admiration. The result has been that the new technology, by giving men unprecedented control over material things, has transformed the relatively

## Blue Heron

by Chick Wallace

Blue heron, is your corner grocery store back in the marsh  
 So full of man and man's poisonous **additives** to  
 Your daily fare of crab and minnow, now so harsh  
 That you are driven to seek your **sustenance** new  
**In unadapted spaces**, like this snow-fluff tide  
 Receding on my ocean shore  
 Where this season of the year  
 Not even gulls and willets stop here for long for tea,  
 Knowing nothing's here?

You won't let me close enough to say it:  
 Heron blue, come home with me, and you  
 And I and Dog may share my bowl of deathly steaming stew,  
 Spiced by Man's poisons and **debris**—just like your native **slew**.

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## ACTIVITY

3

After reading the poem, go back to your story and revise it to include some environmental concerns, especially with regard to Lebanon. You may want to write about air pollution, noise pollution, water pollution, etc., or any combination of these.

*Assignment:*

Write a poem similar to "Blue Heron", in which you ponder the problems of environmental pollution in Lebanon. You may want to focus on one aspect or discuss pollution in general.

simple agricultural communities of the eighteenth century into societies far more complex and impersonal than anything the prophets of liberal-democracy could have imagined—mechanized Laviathans which Thomas Jefferson at least would have regarded as unreal and fantastic and altogether unsuited to the principles of liberty and equality as he understood them.

2- I need not say that the influence of the technological revolution has not been confined to any particular aspect of social life. On the contrary, it has exerted and still exerts a decisive influence in modifying all the habitual patterns of thought and conduct. But I am here concerned with the influence of the technological revolution in accelerating and intensifying that concentration of wealth and power in the hands of a few which the principles of individual freedom in the economic realm would in any case have tended to bring about.

3- The first and most obvious result of the technological revolution has been to increase the amount of wealth in the form of material things which can be produced in a given time by a given population. For example, in 1913 there was produced in Great Britain seven billion yards of cotton cloth for export alone. In 1750 the total population of Great Britain, working with the mechanical appliances then available, could have produced only a small fraction of that amount. A second result of the technological revolution is that, as machines are perfected and become more automatic, man power plays a relatively less important part in the production of a given amount of wealth in a given time. Fifty years ago, when all type was set by hand, the labor of several men was required to print, fold, and arrange in piles the signatures of a book. Today machines can do it all, and far more rapidly; little man power is required, except that a mechanic, who may pass the time sitting in a chair, must be present in case anything goes wrong with the machine. And finally, a third result of the technological revolution is that, under the system of private property in the means of production and the price system as a method of distributing wealth, the greater part of the wealth produced, since it is produced by the machines, goes to those who own or control the machines, while those who work the machines receive that part only which can be exacted by selling their services in a market where wages are impersonally adjusted to the necessities of the machine process.

## ACTIVITY

3

After reading this selection, what new information have you learned? Complete Exercise 6 in your Workbook.

## Assignment:

After reading "The Technological Revolution", you may want to add new ideas to the cause-effect essay you wrote in Part Two. Rewrite your essay, adding to its content and improving its structure.

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## Part Five

### ACTIVITY .....

Free write for 5-10 minutes on the means of communication which you favor. Is it the telephone? Is it e-mail? Is it face-to-face communication? Share your writing.

### ACTIVITY .....

Read the selection entitled "Computer Visions" and interact with it. Complete Exercise 8 in your Workbook.

## Part Six

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### ACTIVITY .....

Read the selection again and answer questions on it. Complete Exercise 9 in your Workbook.

### ACTIVITY .....

Scan the selection for a sociological analysis of the topic. In your group, write a summary of how the telephone and the digital revolution have changed society.

### ACTIVITY .....

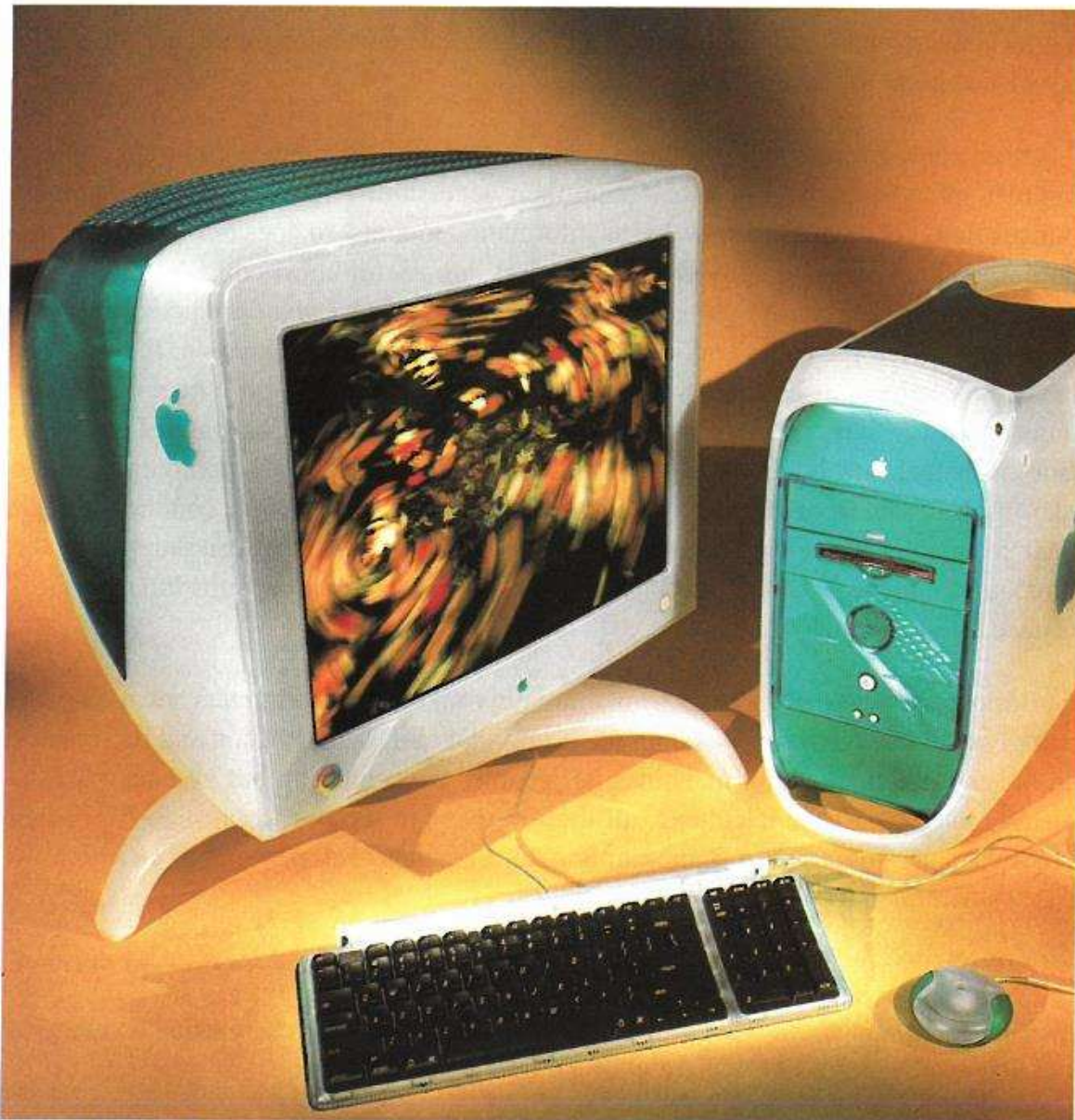
A- Compare your summary with those of the other groups.

B- Discuss, in your group, whether the Lebanese society has been equally affected by the telephone and the digital revolution.

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stand of their impact: We are still in an early phase of the digital revolution, not very different from late-19<sup>th</sup>-century forecasters trying to divine the significance of the telephone. For starters, we don't even know whether our headlong conversion to computer technology has been profitable. Instead, we have only a name for the quandary produced by the seeming absence of benefit: the "productivity paradox." Articles on the uncertain returns from information technology have been a staple of press coverage since May 1986, when *Fortune* broke a cover story that said it all: "The Puny Payoff From Office Computers."

It probably shouldn't be surprising that the economic benefits of computerization remain unclear. In an intriguing article in the 1996 book *Computerization and Controversy*, John Leslie King cites evidence that factory conversion from steam to electric motors from 1870 to 1940 produced its own "productivity paradox." The



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## Part Four

### ACTIVITY

1

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Read the title "Computer Visions", and, with your partner, write a list of questions which you expect to be answered in this selection.

### ACTIVITY

2

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Scan the selection for new words. Complete Exercise 7 in your Workbook.

## COMPUTER VISIONS

The good, the bad, and the unknown

by Jacques Leslie

In the midst of all the Ballyhoo surrounding the digital revolution, we would be well-advised to consider one of its technological predecessors, the telephone. When John Perry Barlow, a cattle rancher who became a noted cybergioneer, proclaimed in a 1995 *Harper's Magazine* article that the development of computer networks was "the most transforming technological event since the capture of fire," he was inadvertently echoing responses to the introduction of the telephone—another revolutionary marvel—more than a century earlier. After a demonstration of the telephone by its inventor, Alexander Graham Bell, the *New York Herald* called the device "almost supernatural," while the *Boston Advertiser* alluded to a "weirdness" never before felt in the Hub City.

Yet for all their fascination with the telephone, early commentators misjudged its possible uses and social impact. One reason is that the prevailing rigidity of the social structure blinded commentators to the telephone's capacity to blur class distinctions; they assumed that the phone would invariably link a superior, whether government authority or boss, to inferiors, mere citizens or workers. Thus, the commentators failed to grasp that what the phone chiefly offered was one-to-one conversation; instead, it was often viewed as a one-to-many broadcast medium, a forerunner of the radio, in which many people might be stationed at their phones to listen to a speech or concert. Another common idea was that it would replace the mechanical bell pulls that were then installed in many homes to summon servants.

Other predictions were laughably pie-in-the-sky. Even Bell himself, though prescient in many ways about the telephone's future, said in 1915 that if it had been developed before the Civil War, it would have forged a profound understanding between North and South, thus averting the conflict.

advantages of electric motors were obvious, and during the latter part of the conversion, from 1900 to 1935, the price of electric power dropped steadily. Yet factory productivity was flat from 1890 to 1920, when the bulk of the conversion took place. King argues that it wasn't until about 1920—50 years into the process—that the benefits finally registered as an increase in productivity.

Like the electric motor, the computer is a versatile general-purpose machine, with thousands of potential applications. As a result, conversion to digital equipment is anything but simple. Not only must new technology be mastered, but new ways of organizing work around it must be devised. At the same time, the new technology is immature: It regularly evolves and mutates, with upgrades sometimes issued every year or two, requiring users to learn new skills over and over again, thereby confounding efforts to establish regular work patterns. Meanwhile, the old technology and its artifacts, everything from analog machinery to reams of paper, must be maintained until digital conversion is total. Considering all that, digital conversion almost certainly will not be complete for several more decades.

Other consequences will be more subtle but conceivably more enduring. As the Internet spreads, many people celebrate their accessibility to unimaginable sums of information. Yet the corollary is that as information mounts, so does our ignorance; we do not yet know how to convert so much data into useful knowledge, let alone wisdom. Far from forging the global village that Marshall McLuhan predicted, the new technology often seems instead to promote fragmentation and alienation. It's true that many people have discovered the pleasure of chatting online with others who share their interest in, say, radio astronomy or biodynamic gardening or David Letterman. But the danger may be that it is becoming too easy to retreat into a community of the like-minded, safe from interests and ideas. Moreover, as more people conduct more of their social intercourse via the computer, to what extent have they been seduced by the illusion of intimacy? Online life is rich and rewarding, but it's no substitute for face-to-face interaction.

Barlow may have been on to something after all. Just as computers seem so menacingly double-edged, fire was both the primordial tool of civilization and its scourge. In the end, the issue is not machines but people: We can't help but go back past the electric motor, past the telephone, all the way back to the first controlled fire, when our awed ancestors tried to figure out how to use a new tool.

## ACTIVITY



.....

Write a paragraph about what you expected to find in this selection using as many of the new words as possible. Share your paragraph with the class.

It turned out, of course, that the telephone's impact was more complex and far-reaching than any forecaster imagined. For example, it helped make the sky-scraper possible, by eliminating the need for messengers whose vast numbers otherwise would have required the buildings to consist chiefly of elevator shafts. Yet the phone did not simply contribute to urban congestion: It also helped produce the opposite effect, in the form of suburban sprawl, by providing an instant communications link between workplace and home. The phone also overcame existing barriers to women's employment, as female telephone operators became the first women to gain white-collar jobs in large numbers. None of these developments were foreseen by early commentators.

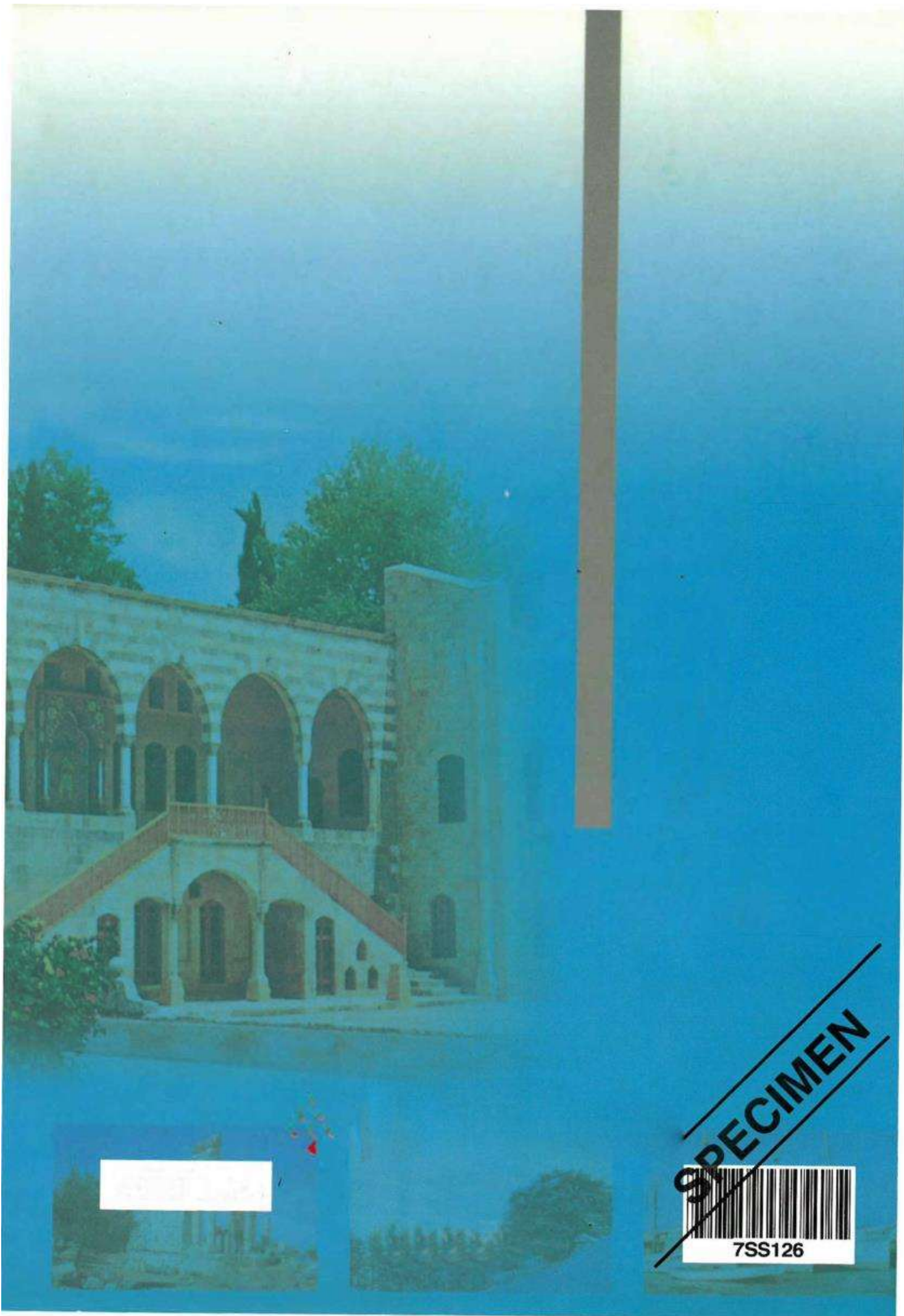


Even more than the telephone, the impact of the digital revolution—encompassing computers, telecommunications networks, databases, satellites, and a vast assortment of electronic devices—is likely to be mind-bogglingly profound and complex. Indeed, it is hard to think of a major field of endeavor that has not been touched by the new technology. For example, digital gear has yielded new applications in virtually every scientific field, from biology (computer-aided drug design) to physics (computer modeling of such phenomena as supernovae and the Big Bang) to medicine (MRI machines and CAT scanners) to the military (computer-guided missiles).

Part of what makes these changes breathtaking is the unprecedented speed with which they're happening. As the Commerce Department's April 1998 report, *The Emerging Digital Economy*, states, radio existed for 38 years before 50 million people tuned in, while television required 13 years to reach the same benchmark. Yet when the internet—the "network of networks" that connects computer-users around the globe—was opened to the general public, it crossed the 50-million-user threshold in a mere four years. By the end of 1997, the report revealed, more than 100 million people were using the Internet, and traffic on it was doubling every 100 days.

Yet for all these dramatic changes, what is equally stunning is how little we under-





**SPECIMEN**



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## Part Seven

### ACTIVITY 1 .....

Scan the selection for an economic analysis of the topic. In your group, write a summary of the impact of the telephone and the digital revolution on the economy.

### ACTIVITY 2 .....

A- Compare your summary to those of the other groups.

B- Discuss, in your group, whether the Lebanese economy has been equally affected by the telephone and the digital revolution.

### ACTIVITY 3 .....

Your discussions about the sociological and economic effects of the telephone and the digital revolution on Lebanon should have prepared you to write on this topic. Jot down the information you have learned from your discussions. Write a preliminary outline for a report on "The sociological and economic effects of the telephone and the digital revolution on Lebanon".

### Assignment:

Find more information on the topic of the sociological and economic effects of the telephone and the digital revolution on Lebanon. Try to get information on future trends and prospects. Revise your preliminary outline if needed. Write a report on this topic.